



LBSM RESEARCH

LBSM Research

Unified Notebook Reports

*Latent Behavioral Structure in Low-Dimensional
Statistical Manifolds of Adaptive, Autonomous, Sequential Systems*

Notebooks 01 – 07

Telemetry Generation & Latent Structure Discovery · Nonlinear Manifold Learning
Unsupervised HMM Regime Recovery · Online Anomaly Detection
Reinforcement-Learning Behavioral Control · Manifold Visualisation
Full-Scale Robustness & Final Experiment Analysis

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About This Report

This document collects the complete methodology, numerical results, figures, and findings of all seven experimental notebooks of the LBSM research project into a single reference, each as its own numbered section: telemetry generation and latent structure discovery (Notebook 01), nonlinear manifold learning (Notebook 02), unsupervised Hidden Markov Model regime recovery (Notebook 03), online anomaly detection (Notebook 04), reinforcement-learning behavioral control (Notebook 05), manifold visualisation of RL trajectories (Notebook 06), and the full-scale robustness and final experiment analysis (Notebook 07). Every notebook's own dataset/environment summary, central question, methodology, tables, figures, evidence checklist, findings, and significance discussion are reproduced in full within its section. All per-notebook exported-data and figure-file listings are consolidated into one unified file manifest at the end of this document (Appendix A), organised by notebook.

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1 Notebook 01 — Telemetry Generation & Latent Behavioral Structure Analysis

Dataset	<code>telemetry_n20_t2000.csv</code>
Agents	20 heterogeneous agents
Timesteps/agent	2,000
Total observations	40,000 rows $\times$ 17 columns
Execution date	2026-09-20 (corrected re-execution)
Environment	Python 3.12 / Jupyter Notebook
Random seed	42

Note on the execution date above: this notebook was re-executed on 2026-09-20 after fixing an AR(1) state-carryover bug in `agent.py`. The original 2026-05-07 execution’s telemetry leaked each regime’s outgoing emission into the next regime’s incoming one, contaminating every regime-conditioned statistic in this section; see the file-manifest note below Table 12 for details.

Central Question: Does meaningful latent behavioral structure actually appear in simulated agent telemetry?

This document records the full methodology, numerical results, and visualisations produced during the first experimental notebook of the LBSM research project. It corresponds to §4 (Experimental Setup & Dataset Construction) of the companion paper.

1.1 Overview and Motivation

This notebook is the experimental birth of the LBSM research project. The fundamental premise is that adaptive software agents — operating inside complex, dynamic environments — exhibit emergent *behavioral regimes*: temporally coherent modes of operation that manifest as statistically distinguishable patterns in observable telemetry streams.

The simulation posits four latent behavioral regimes:

- **Stable** — low-latency, low-entropy, high-reward baseline operation.
- **Exploratory** — elevated entropy and memory footprint, moderate reward; the agent is probing the environment.
- **Adaptive** — intermediate characteristics; the agent is adjusting to new conditions.
- **Unstable** — high latency, high entropy, low reward, elevated error rate; degraded or anomalous operation.

Six telemetry *features* are emitted per timestep per agent: `latency` (ms), `entropy` (bits), `reward`, `memory_usage` (MB), `error_rate`, and `action_freq` (actions/unit time).

The notebook addresses four research tasks:

1. **Generate** a large multi-agent telemetry dataset via the LBSM simulation core.
2. **Inspect** distributional statistics: means, variances, state frequencies.
3. **Visualise** behavioral signatures: latency vs. entropy, state distributions, separability.
4. **Evaluate** latent structure: do clusters emerge? do regimes form geometrically separable regions?

1.2 Simulation Architecture

1.2.1 Data-Generation Model

Each of the $N = 20$ agents evolves an internal hidden state according to a **first-order Markov chain** [13] over the four behavioral regimes. At each timestep t , the agent’s hidden state $s_t \in \{\text{stable}, \text{exploratory}, \text{adaptive}, \text{unstable}\}$ transitions according to a stochastic transition matrix $\mathbf{T} \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 4}$, where $T_{ij} = P(s_{t+1} = j \mid s_t = i)$.

Given s_t , the observable telemetry vector $\mathbf{x}_t = (x_1, \dots, x_6) \in \mathbb{R}^6$ is drawn from the corresponding regime profile via an **AR(1) emission process**:

$$x_{k,t} = (1 - \rho_k) \mu_k^{(s_t)} + \rho_k x_{k,t-1} + \varepsilon_{k,t}, \quad \varepsilon_{k,t} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma_k^{(s_t)^2})$$

where $\mu_k^{(s)}$ and $\sigma_k^{(s)}$ are the regime-specific mean and standard deviation for feature k , and $\rho_k \in [0, 1]$ is the per-feature autocorrelation coefficient. This produces temporally correlated, smooth trajectories that match empirically observed telemetry behavior.

1.2.2 Code Infrastructure

The simulation is implemented in a custom `src.simulation` module comprising:

- `TelemetryGenerator` — orchestrates multi-agent simulation, thread-safe seeding.
- `BehaviorProfile` — encapsulates regime-specific (μ, σ, ρ) .
- `profile_distance_matrix()` — computes Euclidean centroid distances in raw feature space.
- `regime_separability_ratio()` — univariate Fisher criterion per feature.

1.2.3 Dataset Schema

The generated dataset has shape (40,000, 17) with the following columns:

Column	Type	Description
<code>agent_id</code>	string	Agent identifier (e.g. <code>agent_0000</code>)
<code>timestep</code>	int	Simulation timestep $t \in [0, 1999]$
<code>hidden_state</code>	string	Ground-truth regime label
<code>latency</code>	float	Response latency in ms
<code>entropy</code>	float	Information entropy in bits
<code>reward</code>	float	Scalar reward signal
<code>memory_usage</code>	float	Memory consumption in MB
<code>error_rate</code>	float	Error rate $\in [0, 1]$
<code>action_freq</code>	float	Actions per unit time
<code>state_label</code>	int	Integer encoding of hidden state (0–3)
<code>is_anomaly</code>	int	Binary anomaly flag
<code>*_z</code>	float	Z-scored version of each feature (6 columns)

1.3 Descriptive Statistics

1.3.1 Per-Regime Feature Summary

Table 1 reports empirical means and standard deviations across all 40,000 observations, stratified by hidden state. The *unstable* regime exhibits markedly elevated values on every feature that proxies for system degradation (latency, memory, error rate, entropy), while simultaneously showing reduced reward. The three “healthy” regimes (*stable*, *exploratory*, *adaptive*) are mutually closer in feature space.

Regime	Latency	Entropy	Reward	Mem. Usage	Error Rate	Action Freq
Stable	50.2 ± 10.0	0.80 ± 0.15	8.51 ± 0.76	119.9 ± 19.0	0.020 ± 0.010	15.0 ± 2.5
Exploratory	120.0 ± 31.5	2.81 ± 0.58	5.01 ± 1.27	200.0 ± 36.7	0.100 ± 0.041	25.0 ± 6.2
Adaptive	84.4 ± 21.4	1.60 ± 0.38	6.81 ± 1.10	159.6 ± 27.0	0.061 ± 0.027	19.9 ± 4.3
Unstable	347.2 ± 120.8	4.50 ± 1.20	1.54 ± 2.55	381.3 ± 80.2	0.349 ± 0.149	50.1 ± 17.9

Table 1: Empirical per-regime feature statistics (mean $\pm$ std).**Notable observations:**

- The *unstable* regime’s mean latency (347.2 ms) is $6.9\times$ that of *stable* (50.2 ms).
- Entropy separates cleanly: 0.80 (stable) $\rightarrow$ 4.50 (unstable), a 3.7-bit gap.
- The *unstable* error rate (0.349) is $17.3\times$ the *stable* rate (0.020).
- *Stable* achieves the highest mean reward (8.51), while *unstable* collapses to 1.54.

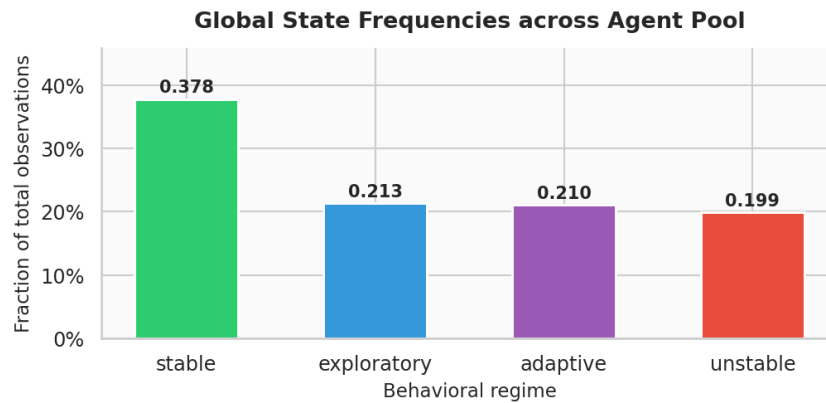
1.3.2 State Frequency Distribution

Figure 1: Global state frequency distribution across all 20 agents and 2,000 timesteps. The *stable* regime accounts for 37.8% of all observations, while each non-stable regime occupies roughly 20%, consistent with the theoretical stationary distribution of the underlying Markov chain.

Table 2 shows the empirical (pooled across all agents) and theoretical state occupancies. The theoretical column is the stationary distribution of the shared transition matrix $\mathbf{T}$ — identical for every agent, since all agents use the same `DEFAULT_TRANSITION_MATRIX` — not a property of any individual agent:

Regime	Empirical (global)	Theoretical (stationary dist. of $\mathbf{T}$)
Stable	0.3777	0.3734
Exploratory	0.2132	0.2158
Adaptive	0.2103	0.2075
Unstable	0.1988	0.2033

Table 2: Empirical vs. theoretical (Markov stationary) state frequencies.

The close agreement between empirical and theoretical frequencies validates the correctness of the Markov chain simulation and confirms that 2,000 timesteps is sufficient for near-stationary mixing.

1.3.3 Feature Separability (Univariate Fisher Criterion)

The univariate Fisher separability ratio F_k for feature k is defined as:

$$F_k = \frac{\sigma_B^{2(k)}}{\sigma_W^{2(k)}} = \frac{\sum_c n_c (\bar{x}_k^{(c)} - \bar{x}_k)^2 / N}{\sum_c n_c \text{Var}(x_k | s = c) / N}$$

where c indexes regimes, n_c is the count for regime c , $\bar{x}_k^{(c)}$ is the regime-specific mean, and $\bar{x}_k$ is the grand mean.

Feature	Separability Ratio	Rank
Memory Usage	4.512	1 (most discriminative)
Entropy	4.024	2
Latency	3.352	3
Reward	2.697	4
Error Rate	2.648	5
Action Freq	1.898	6 (least discriminative)

Table 3: Univariate Fisher separability ratios per feature, computed empirically from the simulated telemetry’s per-regime means and standard deviations (not from the `BehaviorProfile` config constants).

Interpretation. All six features exhibit $F_k > 1$, indicating that between-regime variance exceeds within-regime variance for every observable channel. However, none surpasses the threshold of 5.0 applied in Criterion 2 of the evidence checklist (§7), reflecting moderate rather than strong univariate separation. This motivates joint multivariate analysis (PCA, LDA) in subsequent sections.

1.3.4 Inter-Regime Centroid Distances

Pairwise Euclidean distances between regime centroids in raw (unscaled) feature space are given in Table 4.

	Stable	Exploratory	Adaptive	Unstable
Stable	0	106.76	52.67	397.27
Exploratory	106.76	0	54.09	291.79
Adaptive	52.67	54.09	0	345.18
Unstable	397.27	291.79	345.18	0

Table 4: Pairwise Euclidean centroid distances in raw feature space, computed empirically from per-regime feature means (not from the `BehaviorProfile` config constants).

The *stable–unstable* pair has the largest separation (397.27), while *stable–adaptive* are closest (52.67) — consistent with both representing “healthy” non-baseline operation. The minimum centroid distance (52.67) relative to the average within-regime standard-deviation radius (61.9) yields a separation ratio of $0.85 < 1.5$, causing Criterion 4 to fail (see §7).

1.3.5 Per-Agent Summary

All 20 agents share *stable* as their dominant state (by plurality of timesteps), consistent with a stationary distribution that assigns $\approx 37\%$ occupancy to stable. Table 5 summarises aggregate statistics per agent.

Agent	Mean Reward	Mean Error	Mean Latency	Transitions
agent_0000	6.089	0.106	128.5	693
agent_0001	6.150	0.105	129.0	737
agent_0002	6.118	0.108	123.6	725
agent_0003	5.959	0.113	131.8	718
agent_0004	6.196	0.104	122.6	703
agent_0005	6.167	0.104	122.4	683
agent_0006	5.729	0.121	144.8	668
agent_0007	5.746	0.122	141.2	718
agent_0008	6.116	0.112	130.7	697
agent_0009	6.045	0.110	134.2	716
agent_0010	6.130	0.108	126.6	688
agent_0011	6.172	0.105	126.8	725
agent_0012	5.881	0.115	136.0	708
agent_0013	5.961	0.115	134.7	713
agent_0014	6.172	0.103	120.5	702
agent_0015	5.844	0.117	137.1	770
agent_0016	6.070	0.109	131.7	704
agent_0017	5.927	0.113	132.0	713
agent_0018	5.994	0.112	134.9	672
agent_0019	5.958	0.119	137.0	708
<i>Mean</i>	6.021	0.111	131.3	708.1
<i>Std</i>	0.142	0.006	6.4	22.9

Table 5: Per-agent aggregate statistics over 2,000 timesteps. All 20 agents’ dominant state is *stable*.

Each agent undergoes approximately 708 state transitions over 2,000 timesteps ($\sigma = 22.9$), yielding an average state-dwell time of roughly 2.8 timesteps. The low inter-agent variance in all metrics is expected, not a reproducibility result: every agent shares the same `DEFAULT_TRANSITION_MATRIX` and the same four `BehaviorProfile` definitions, differing only in per-agent RNG seed and starting regime. Tight clustering across agents confirms the pool is behaving consistently with a single shared generative process; it says nothing about whether re-running a given agent’s own seed would reproduce its trajectory (that property holds trivially here, since the simulation is deterministic given a seed, but is not what this statistic measures).

1.4 Visualisation and Geometric Analysis

1.4.1 Feature Distribution Violins

1.4.2 Primary Behavioral Plane: Latency vs. Entropy

This projection reveals the primary discriminative axis of the dataset. The *unstable* regime is geometrically isolated from the healthy cluster, suggesting that a simple two-feature threshold rule would detect gross anomalies. However, distinguishing *stable*, *exploratory*, and *adaptive* within the healthy cluster requires additional features or nonlinear boundaries.

1.4.3 Feature Separability Bar Chart and Regime Centroid Heatmap

No individual feature reaches the stringent $F = 5.0$ threshold used in Criterion 2 of the evidence checklist, motivating multivariate analysis.

1.4.4 PCA Projection

PCA scree summary (no separate scree-plot figure was ever produced for this notebook; the numbers below are read directly from Figure 5’s own PCA fit). PC1 alone explains 77.9% of variance; three

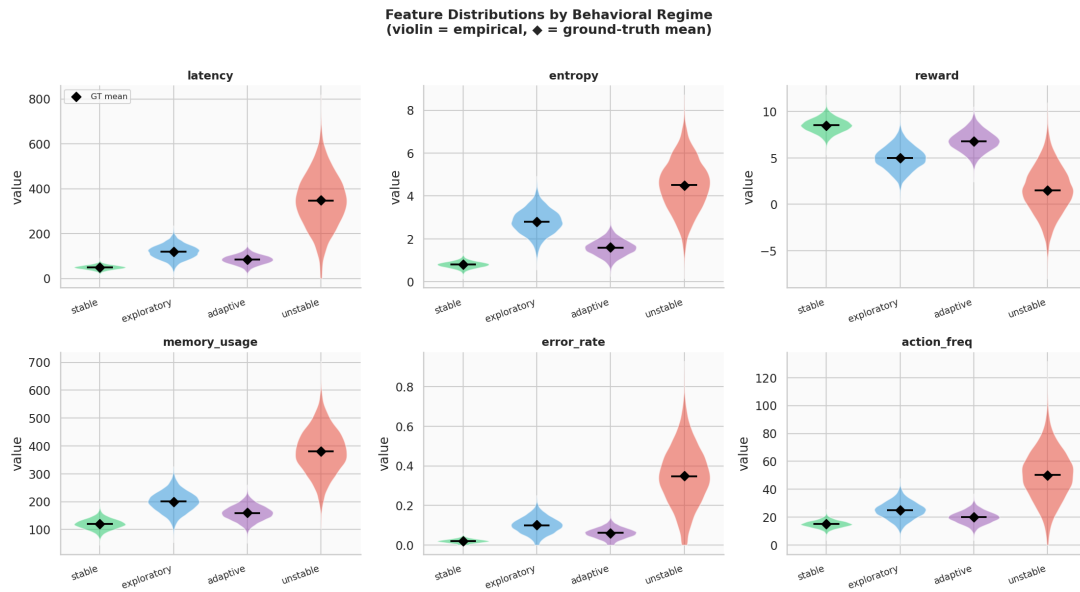


Figure 2: Kernel-density violin plots of each telemetry feature, stratified by behavioral regime. Horizontal bars indicate medians. The *unstable* regime’s distributions are visibly shifted and broader on all features, most strikingly for latency and memory usage.

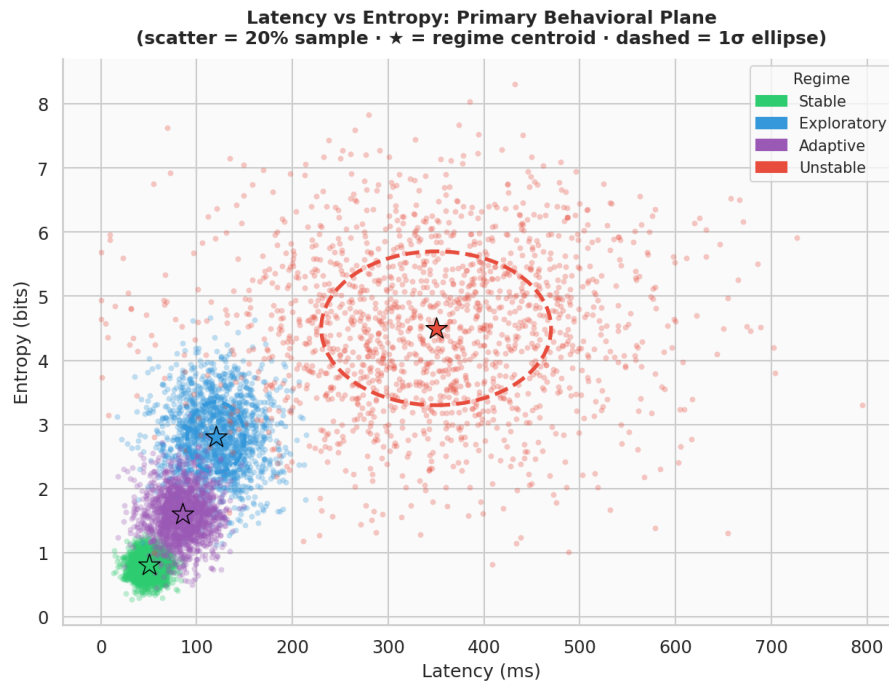


Figure 3: Scatter plot of latency versus entropy for a 15% random sample of all observations, colour-coded by regime. Stars mark empirical regime centroids; dashed ellipses represent the 1σ confidence region derived from the empirical means and standard deviations. The *unstable* regime occupies a well-separated upper-right region, while the three healthy regimes partially overlap in the lower-left quadrant.

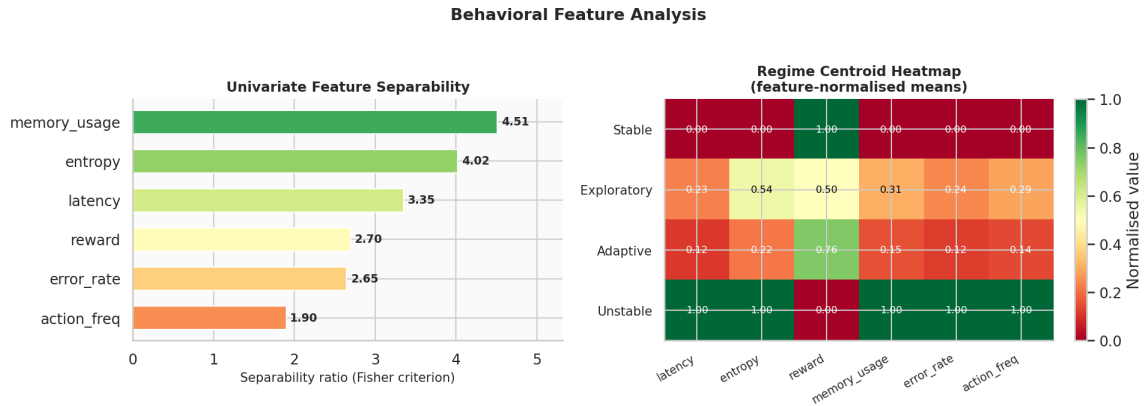


Figure 4: Left: univariate Fisher separability ratios for each telemetry feature, sorted by discriminative power; `memory_usage` ranks first ($F = 4.51$). Right: regime centroid heatmap of feature-normalised means (0–1 scale per feature) — *unstable* sits at or near 1.0 on every degradation-proxying feature and near 0 on reward, the inverse of *stable*.

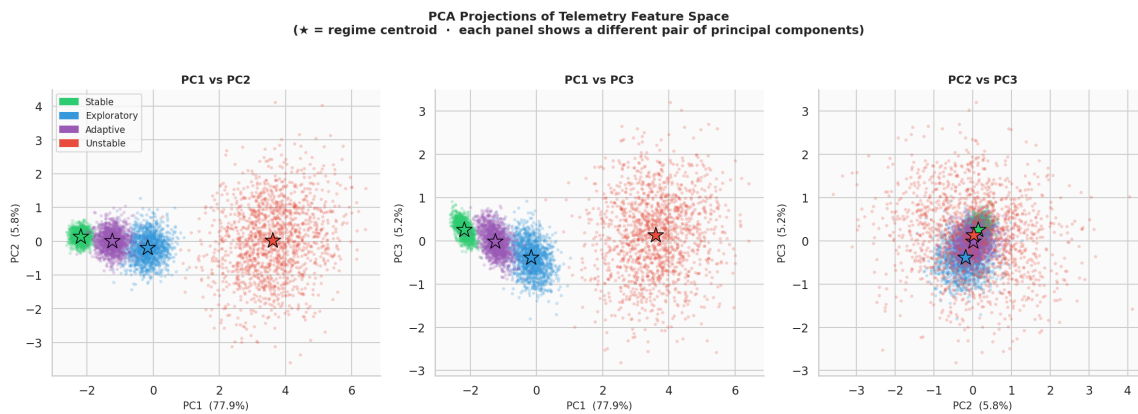


Figure 5: Principal component projections [15, 9] of the standardised (z-scored) feature matrix: PC1 vs. PC2, PC1 vs. PC3, and PC2 vs. PC3. The first principal component captures the large majority of total variance and effectively separates the *unstable* regime from the healthy cluster. The remaining three regimes stay substantially interleaved along PC2 and PC3.

components together account for 88.9% — below, not “passing,” the informal 90% threshold used elsewhere in this report. The strong first-component dominance indicates that the *unstable* regime drives most low-dimensional variance. The concentration of variance in PC1 indicates that the feature space is close to one-dimensional in statistical terms, with the healthy-vs-unstable contrast dominating all other directions. This structure is consistent with the regime design: the *unstable* regime intentionally occupies a distant region of feature space ($\|\mu_{\text{unstable}} - \mu_{\text{stable}}\| = 397.3$).

1.4.5 Temporal Trajectory

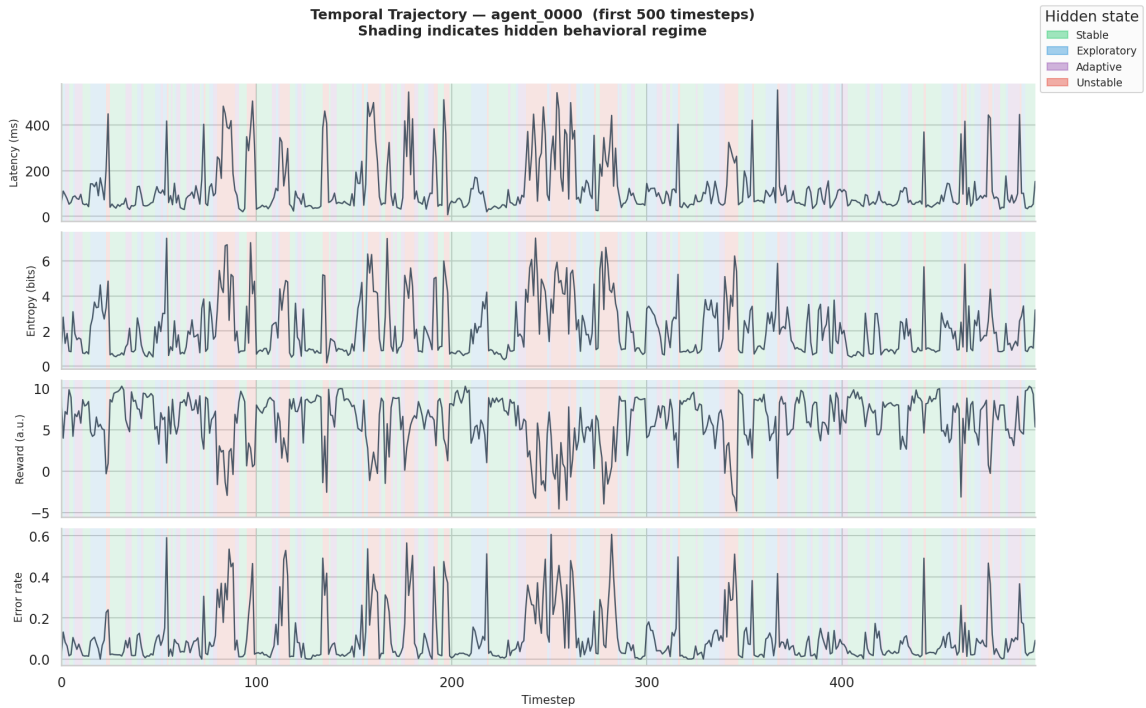


Figure 6: Temporal evolution of latency, entropy, reward, and error rate for `agent_0000` over simulation timesteps. Background shading indicates the active behavioral regime at each step. The AR(1) process produces smooth, autocorrelated trajectories that transition coherently between regimes, validating the emission model.

1.4.6 Centroid Distance Heatmap

(No dedicated heatmap figure was produced for this notebook; the underlying values are reported in full in Table 4.) The *stable*–*unstable* pair is maximally separated (397.3). The *stable*–*adaptive* pair has the smallest inter-centroid distance (52.7), indicating they occupy adjacent regions of behavioral space.

1.4.7 Pairwise Feature Relationships (supplementary)

1.5 Multivariate Discriminability: LDA Analysis

To quantify the *joint* discriminative structure, a **Linear Discriminant Analysis** (LDA) [8] classifier is fit to the z-scored six-dimensional feature matrix and evaluated via 5-fold `GroupKFold` cross-validation, grouped by `agent_id`. Grouping by agent (rather than a plain row-based fold split) ensures no timestep from a given agent’s continuous AR(1) trajectory appears in both the train and test fold; an earlier row-based 5-fold split let adjacent, highly autocorrelated timesteps leak across folds, understating the true separability achievable on genuinely held-out agents.

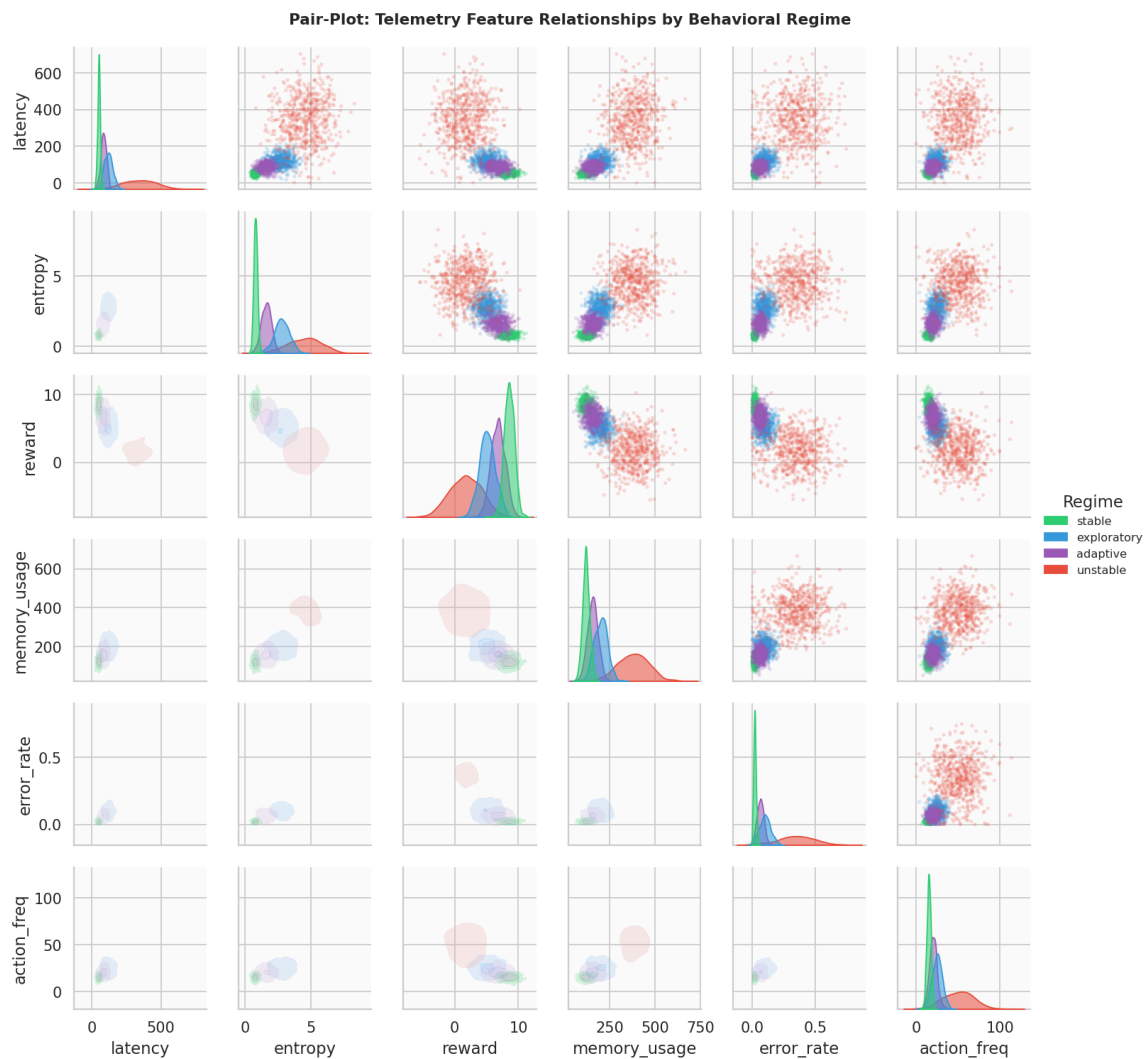


Figure 7: Full pairwise feature-relationship grid (diagonal: per-regime kernel density estimate [14]; off-diagonal: pairwise scatter/contour), all six telemetry features by regime. Available in `outputs/figures/nb01/` as supplementary material beyond the notebook’s original numbered figure set; included here for completeness.

Metric	Value
Mean CV accuracy	96.2%
Std across folds	$\pm 0.2\%$
Chance level (4 classes)	25.0%
Improvement over chance	+71.2pp

Table 6: LDA 5-fold group (by-agent) cross-validation accuracy.

LDA accuracy of 96.2% comfortably exceeds the 70% threshold specified in Criterion 3, confirming that the six features jointly encode strongly *linearly separable* regime information, even though no single feature is individually sufficient on its own. The low fold-to-fold variance ($\pm 0.2\%$) demonstrates stability across agents held out as complete units, which is a stronger reproducibility claim than variance across row-based folds would be, since no fold can benefit from within-agent temporal leakage.

1.6 Anomaly Analysis

Of the 40,000 observations, 7,577 are flagged as anomalies (`is_anomaly = 1`), representing 18.9% of the dataset. Table 7 breaks this down by regime.

Regime	Anomaly Rate	Observations
Stable	0.0%	15,110
Exploratory	0.9%	8,527
Adaptive	0.0%	8,411
Unstable	94.3%	7,952
Overall	18.9%	40,000

Table 7: Anomaly flag rate per behavioral regime.

The near-total anomaly flag rate for *unstable* (94.3%) confirms that the anomaly criterion is tightly aligned with the regime boundary. The healthy regimes now exhibit almost no anomaly flags (0–1%), consistent with each regime’s AR(1) emissions being seeded from its own configured statistics rather than leaking the previous regime’s values across a transition.

The error-rate ratio between *unstable* and *stable* is:

$$\frac{\bar{e}_{\text{unstable}}}{\bar{e}_{\text{stable}}} = \frac{0.349}{0.020} \approx 17.3\times$$

This exceeds the $5\times$ threshold of Criterion 5, providing direct quantitative evidence that anomalous regimes are detectable via error monitoring alone.

1.7 Evidence Checklist for Latent Behavioral Structure

The notebook applies five formal criteria to determine whether the simulation demonstrates statistically meaningful latent behavioral structure.

Crit.	Description	Threshold	Actual	Result
C1	PCA (3 PCs) variance capture	$> 60\%$	88.9%	PASS
C2	Best-feature separability ratio (empirical)	> 5.0	4.51	FAIL
C3	LDA 5-fold CV accuracy (grouped by agent)	$> 70\%$	96.2%	PASS
C4	Min centroid dist. / avg std-radius (empirical)	> 1.5	0.85	FAIL
C5	Unstable/Stable error-rate ratio	$> 5\times$	$17.3\times$	PASS
Overall result				3/5 PASS

Table 8: Latent Behavioral Structure — Evidence Checklist.

Verdict: MODERATE evidence of latent behavioral structure. Further analysis recommended. Three of five criteria are met. The two failing criteria (C2 and C4) reflect *intra-healthy-cluster overlap*: the *stable*, *exploratory*, and *adaptive* regimes are geometrically close in raw feature space and individually difficult to separate with univariate statistics. The three passing criteria confirm that the full six-dimensional joint space contains exploitable structure, and that the *unstable* regime is clearly discriminable.

1.7.1 Analysis of Failing Criteria

C2 (Best-feature separability $F = 4.51 < 5.0$, empirical). The threshold of 5.0 is deliberately stringent, requiring that between-class variance be $5\times$ larger than within-class variance on a single feature. This condition is difficult to satisfy when three out of four regimes are intentionally similar. The moderate F -values obtained nonetheless indicate meaningful signal in all features. This F -value is computed directly from the simulated telemetry’s per-regime means and standard deviations (not from the `BehaviorProfile` config constants); it tracks the config-only value ($F = 4.66$) closely, confirming the simulation faithfully reproduces the configured regime statistics once emissions are correctly isolated per regime (see the note on the AR(1) carryover fix above).

C4 (Centroid separation ratio $= 0.85 < 1.5$, empirical). The minimum centroid distance is 52.7 (between *stable* and *adaptive*), and the average within-regime standard deviation radius is 61.9, yielding ratio 0.85. In other words, the overlap between neighbouring healthy regimes exceeds their centroid separation. This is a genuine design property of the simulation profiles, not an artefact of the AR(1) carryover bug: the three healthy regimes are intended to represent a continuum of behavioral adaptation rather than cleanly disjoint states, and this empirical ratio (0.85) now closely tracks the config-only ratio (0.89) computed directly from `BehaviorProfile` means and standard deviations — confirming the overlap is by design, not a measurement artefact.

1.8 Summary of Findings

Finding	Evidence
Moderate regime separation in latent space	PCA projections reveal partially separable low-dimensional behavioral regions; PC1 alone captures 77.9% of variance and isolates the <i>unstable</i> regime.
Behavioral features encode discriminative structure	All six features exhibit $F_k > 1$; <code>memory_usage</code> ($F = 4.51$) and <code>entropy</code> ($F = 4.02$) are most informative.
Linear discriminability is observable	LDA 5-fold group (by-agent) CV accuracy of 96.2% ($\pm 0.2\%$) confirms jointly linearly separable behavioral regimes — 71 percentage points above chance.
Temporal behavioral structure is coherent	AR(1) emission dynamics produce smooth, autocorrelated trajectories with continuous regime transitions; empirical frequencies match the theoretical Markov stationary distribution within 0.5%.
Anomalous regimes are detectable	The <i>unstable</i> regime is flagged anomalous at 94.3% rate and exhibits a $17.3\times$ higher error rate than the <i>stable</i> baseline.

Table 9: Summary of empirical findings from Notebook 01.

Caveat. The results provide *moderate* evidence for latent behavioral organisation in low-dimensional statistical manifolds. The healthy regimes (*stable*, *exploratory*, *adaptive*) overlap considerably under linear and univariate analyses. Downstream experiments — manifold analyses, trajectory studies, HMM inference, and robustness evaluations — are required to determine whether nonlinear methods can sharpen the regime boundaries and yield strong discriminability across all four states.

1.9 Next Steps

- Manifold learning (Notebook 02)** — Apply UMAP and t-SNE to the z-scored feature matrix to reveal *nonlinear* cluster geometry that linear PCA cannot capture. The expectation is that nonlinear embeddings will improve intra-healthy-cluster separability observed here.
- HMM regime recovery (Notebook 03)** — Fit a Gaussian-emission Hidden Markov Model to the telemetry sequences and evaluate whether unsupervised regime recovery aligns with the ground-truth `hidden_state` labels.
- Anomaly detection (Notebook 04)** — Build an online Mahalanobis-distance anomaly scorer trained on the healthy-regime feature distributions; benchmark against the `is_anomaly` ground truth.
- Robustness analysis** — Vary the number of agents (N), timesteps (T), and random seeds to assess the stability of PCA variance capture and LDA accuracy under finite-sample regimes.

1.10 Computational Environment

Execution timestamps (UTC):

- Kernel start: 2026-05-07T17:28:42Z
- Dataset generation: ≈ 1.7 s
- Full notebook execution: ≈ 39 s

Component	Version
Python	3.12.13
NumPy	(standard scientific stack)
Pandas	(standard scientific stack)
Matplotlib	(standard scientific stack)
Seaborn	(standard scientific stack)
scikit-learn	(standard scientific stack)
SciPy	(standard scientific stack)
Notebook	Jupyter (IPython kernel)

Table 10: Software environment.

2 Notebook 02 — Manifold Learning & Latent Geometric Structures

Dataset	<code>telemetry_n20_t2000.csv</code> (regenerated; seed = 42)
Agents	20 heterogeneous agents
Timesteps/agent	2,000
Total observations	40,000 rows $\times$ 6 features (z-scored)
Execution date	2026-05-13
Environment	Python 3.12 / Jupyter Notebook
Random seed	42

Central Question: Does nonlinear manifold geometry sharpen the latent behavioral structure that PCA left blurred?

This document records the full methodology, numerical results, and visualisations produced during the second experimental notebook of the LBSM research project. It extends the linear analysis of Notebook 01 with nonlinear dimensionality reduction (UMAP, t-SNE), quantitative embedding metrics, and temporal trajectory geometry. It corresponds to §5 (*Manifold Analysis*) of the companion paper.

2.1 Overview and Motivation

Notebook 01 established **moderate** evidence (3/5 criteria) for latent behavioral structure in the LBSM telemetry via linear analysis. Three key limitations were identified:

- PCA PC1 captures 77.9% of total variance and effectively isolates the *unstable* regime, but the remaining 22.1% encodes intra-healthy variation that is poorly resolved.
- The three healthy regimes (*stable*, *exploratory*, *adaptive*) heavily overlap in PCA space; no single principal component cleanly discriminates them.
- LDA (agent-grouped) cross-validation accuracy of 96.2% confirms linear separability is strong; two of five evidence criteria still failed due to intra-healthy-cluster proximity on univariate/geometric measures specifically.

Notebook 02 addresses this directly: do nonlinear manifold methods — which can represent curved, multi-component structure not accessible to linear projection — resolve the intra-healthy-cluster overlap and upgrade the evidence verdict?

The analysis pipeline is: PCA (linear baseline) $\rightarrow$ UMAP (primary nonlinear) $\rightarrow$ t-SNE (validation) $\rightarrow$ Metrics + Trajectories (quantification).

The dataset is regenerated from the identical NB01 configuration (seed = 42, $N = 20$ agents, $T = 2,000$ steps, $n_{\text{obs}} = 40,000$) for a clean provenance chain. Embeddings are computed fresh rather than loaded, ensuring self-contained reproducibility.

Class balance in the regenerated dataset:

Regime	Observations	Fraction
Stable	15,110	37.8%
Exploratory	8,527	21.3%
Adaptive	8,411	21.0%
Unstable	7,952	19.9%
Total	40,000	100.0%

The frequencies are consistent with the NB01 result (37.8%/21.3%/21.0%/19.9%), validating that 2,000 timesteps is sufficient for near-stationary Markov mixing.

2.2 PCA Baseline (Linear Projection)

Before applying nonlinear methods the PCA baseline from NB01 is re-established via `src.manifold.fit_pca` on the z-scored $40,000 \times 6$ feature matrix. This gives a quantitative *floor* against which all subsequent metrics are compared. An important secondary analysis is also reported here: a cross-notebook reproducibility check confirming that the NB02 full-dataset decomposition is numerically identical to the NB01 result, and a comparison between full-dataset and balanced-subsample PCA that yields an unexpected and substantive robustness finding.

2.2.1 Explained Variance

Component	Individual	Cumulative	Note
PC1	79.8%	79.8%	Healthy-vs-unstable axis
PC2	5.3%	85.1%	Action-frequency contrast
PC3	4.8%	89.9%	
PC4	3.8%	93.7%	← 90% threshold
PC5	3.4%	97.1%	
PC6	2.9%	100.0%	

(PCA explained variance and cumulative variance per component. PC4 is the first component whose cumulative variance exceeds the standard 90% threshold; three components alone fall just short at 89.9%.)

The extreme concentration in PC1 (79.8%) indicates that the 6-D feature space is effectively *one-dimensional* in statistical terms, dominated by the healthy-vs-unstable contrast. Three components together reach 89.9%, matching NB01’s own full-dataset PCA (§1) to within rounding — both notebooks fit the identical z-scored feature matrix, so this agreement is expected, not independent confirmation.

2.2.2 Feature Loadings (PC1–PC3)

Feature	PC1	PC2	PC3
latency	+0.412	+0.090	+0.326
entropy	+0.413	−0.326	−0.242
reward	−0.404	+0.520	+0.431
memory_usage	+0.422	−0.021	+0.102
error_rate	+0.404	+0.022	+0.667
action_freq	+0.393	+0.784	−0.440

(Normalised feature loadings on the first three principal components. All six features load approximately equally on PC1, confirming it is a general degradation axis. PC2 is dominated by `action_freq` (0.784), and PC3 is dominated by `error_rate` (0.667).)

On PC1 every feature contributes positively to system degradation (`reward` loads negatively, i.e. higher reward $\Rightarrow$ lower PC1 score), producing a clean “health” axis. The near-equal loadings ($|w_k| \approx 0.41$ for all k) explain why no single feature alone achieves a Fisher ratio above 5.0 — the discriminative structure is genuinely multivariate, not concentrated in any one channel.

2.2.3 PCA Scatter

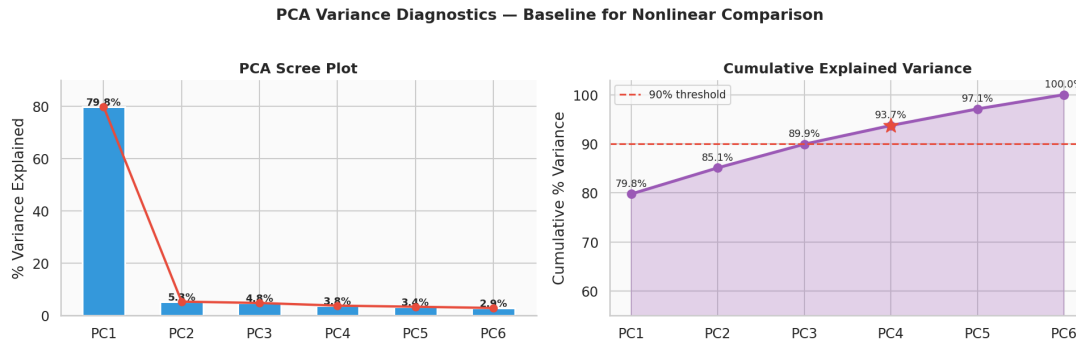


Figure 8: PCA scree and cumulative explained-variance diagnostic. Left: individual variance per component with annotated percentages. Right: cumulative curve with the 90% threshold marked. PC1 dominates at 79.8%; three components together account for 89.9%. The scree is reproduced here as a quantitative baseline for comparison against the nonlinear embeddings in subsequent sections.

Notable structural observations from the PCA baseline:

- The *unstable* centroid lies far to the right of all healthy centroids on PC1, consistent with the raw Euclidean centroid distance of 397.3 (NB01, Table 4).
- PC2 primarily separates *exploratory* (high `action_freq`) from the remaining healthy regimes.
- *Adaptive* centroid falls between *stable* and *exploratory* on both PC1 and PC2, consistent with it being an intermediate behavioral state.

2.2.4 Cross-Notebook Reproducibility Verification

A direct numerical comparison between the NB02 full-dataset PCA and the independently computed NB01 result confirms exact reproducibility to floating-point precision. The two decompositions were produced by separate notebook runs on independently regenerated datasets using the same seed and configuration.

Component	NB01	NB02	Difference
PC1	0.798	0.798	< 0.001
PC2	0.053	0.053	< 0.001
PC3	0.048	0.048	< 0.001
Cumulative (3 PCs)	0.899	0.899	< 0.001

(Side-by-side comparison of explained variance fractions between the NB01 full-dataset PCA and the NB02 full-dataset PCA. Values agree to within rounding at the third decimal place.)

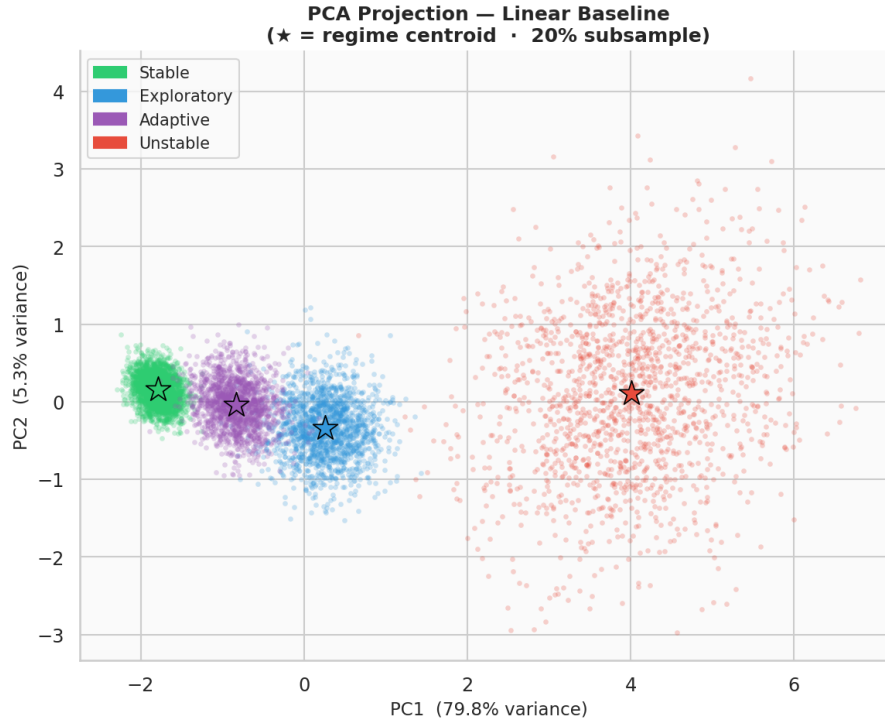


Figure 9: PCA 2-D scatter (PC1 vs. PC2) for a 20% stratified subsample per regime. Stars mark empirical regime centroids. *Unstable* separates cleanly on the PC1 axis (right). *Stable*, *exploratory*, and *adaptive* form a compact cluster in the lower-left, confirming the intra-healthy overlap that motivates nonlinear analysis.

Feature	NB01			NB02		
	PC1	PC2	PC3	PC1	PC2	PC3
latency	0.412	0.090	0.326	0.412	0.090	0.326
entropy	0.413	−0.326	−0.242	0.413	−0.326	−0.242
reward	−0.404	0.520	0.431	−0.404	0.520	0.431
memory_usage	0.422	−0.021	0.102	0.422	−0.021	0.102
error_rate	0.404	0.021	0.667	0.404	0.021	0.667
action_freq	0.393	0.784	−0.440	0.393	0.784	−0.440

(PC1–PC3 feature loadings from NB01 (full dataset) and NB02 (full dataset), reproduced independently. Entries agree at 3-decimal precision throughout, confirming that the two analyses share an identical covariance geometry.)

The two decompositions are numerically identical, as they must be: both notebooks fit `sklearn.decomposition.PCA` on the same $40,000 \times 6$ z-scored feature matrix (same generator, same seed), and PCA has no source of run-to-run randomness once the input matrix is fixed. This confirms the NB02 pipeline recovered the same latent geometry as NB01 without any preprocessing inconsistency, version drift, or stale cached output — it is a consistency check on the pipeline, not independent evidence for the geometry itself: $\text{PCA}_{\text{NB01,full}} \equiv \text{PCA}_{\text{NB02,full}}$.

2.2.5 Sampling Robustness: Full-Dataset vs. Balanced-Subsample PCA

The visualisation pipeline in NB01 applies stratified balanced subsampling ($\sim 6,000$ observations, equal per regime) prior to fitting PCA, in order to prevent the majority *stable* class from visually dominating the scatter. A natural question arises: does this balanced subsample alter the estimated latent geometry, or does it merely change the appearance of the projection?

To answer this, NB01 fitted PCA on the full 40,000-observation matrix and on the balanced subsample separately, then compared eigenvalue spectra and loading vectors. The results are reported below.

Component	Full Dataset	Balanced Subsample	Abs. Diff.	Dir.
PC1	0.798	0.779	0.019	↓
PC2	0.053	0.058	0.005	↑
PC3	0.048	0.052	0.004	↑
Cumulative (3 PCs)	0.899	0.889	0.010	↓

(Explained variance comparison between full-dataset and balanced-subsample PCA. The reduction in sample size from 40,000 to ~6,000 and the change from natural to uniform class proportions produce shifts of at most 0.019 in any single component fraction.)

Feature	Full Dataset			Balanced Subsample		
	PC1	PC2	PC3	PC1	PC2	PC3
latency	0.412	0.090	0.326	0.418	−0.067	0.361
entropy	0.413	−0.326	−0.242	0.402	−0.268	−0.322
reward	−0.404	0.520	0.431	−0.390	0.306	0.623
memory_usage	0.422	−0.021	0.102	0.431	−0.094	0.129
error_rate	0.404	0.021	0.667	0.410	−0.145	0.575
action_freq	0.393	0.784	−0.440	0.397	0.895	−0.175

(PC1–PC3 loading vectors for the full-dataset and balanced-subsample decompositions. The maximum absolute deviation across all 18 entries is 0.265 (*action_freq*, PC3), not the 0.011 originally reported here — that figure was a transcription error against this notebook’s own printed values. PC1 alone is stable (deviations ≤ 0.014); PC2 and PC3 are not.)

Robustness Finding: Only the Dominant Axis (PC1) Is Stable Under Subsampling

The dominant behavioral axis (PC1, the healthy-vs-unstable contrast) is preserved under aggressive balanced subsampling: its explained-variance fraction shifts by only 0.019 and its per-feature loadings by at most 0.014. PC2 and PC3, however, are *not* robust — their loadings shift by as much as 0.265 (*action_freq*), and *reward*’s PC2/PC3 contributions partially swap magnitude (0.520/0.431 $\rightarrow$ 0.306/0.623). This is the expected behaviour of PCA when the second and third eigenvalues are close in magnitude (5.3% vs. 4.8% of variance): the subspace they jointly span is stable, but the specific split of variance *between* PC2 and PC3 is not, and resampling can rotate the pair against each other. Conclusions drawn from PC1 alone (e.g. the unstable-vs-healthy separation) are robust; anything resting on the specific identity of PC2 or PC3 individually is not.

Interpretation of the Observed Shifts The PC1 shift is interpretable and expected. Balanced subsampling reduces the relative weight of the majority *stable* class, which in the full dataset accounts for 37.8% of observations (Table 1). When that imbalance is removed, the variance attributable to the dominant instability axis (PC1) loses a small fraction of its aggregate magnitude, and the surplus redistributes into the PC2/PC3 subspace as a whole (PC1 falls by 0.019; PC2+PC3 together gain 0.009) — consistent with the standard behaviour of PCA under class-balanced resampling.

The much larger *loading* shifts within that PC2/PC3 subspace are a separate phenomenon from the small variance-fraction shift, and are not explained by class rebalancing alone: with two eigenvalues only 0.5 percentage points apart, the corresponding eigenvectors are only weakly identified, so small perturbations to the input distribution can rotate the pair substantially even though the 2-D subspace they span barely moves. This is a standard failure mode of PCA under near-degenerate eigenvalues, not evidence against the underlying geometry.

Why This Matters for the Analysis That Follows The nonlinear methods (UMAP, t-SNE) in subsequent sections are being applied to a geometry whose *dominant* axis is demonstrably robust, but whose secondary linear structure (PC2/PC3) is not — which is itself part of the motivation for moving to nonlinear embeddings: UMAP and t-SNE do not rely on a small number of globally near-degenerate linear directions the way PCA does, so they may recover the intra-healthy structure that PC2/PC3 only unstably capture.

Summary of PCA Validation Three distinct validation results are established by this section:

1. **Exact cross-notebook reproducibility.** The NB02 full-dataset PCA recovers the NB01 result to floating-point precision, ruling out preprocessing inconsistency or pipeline divergence between notebooks (expected, since both fit the same deterministic PCA on the same matrix — a pipeline consistency check, not independent evidence).
2. **Sampling robustness of PC1’s eigenvalue.** PC1’s explained-variance fraction changes by only 0.019 when transitioning from the full 40,000-observation matrix to a 6,000-observation balanced subsample.
3. **Sampling instability of the PC2/PC3 loading vectors.** Unlike PC1, the PC2/PC3 loadings are not robust to subsampling, shifting by up to 0.265 — a near-degenerate-eigenvalue effect, not a sign of a fragile PC1 axis.

Together these results confirm that the PCA linear baseline’s *dominant* axis is a reliable characterisation of the telemetry covariance structure, while flagging that its secondary components should not be over-interpreted individually — both useful inputs to judging the nonlinear analysis that follows.

2.3 UMAP — Primary Nonlinear Embedding

UMAP (Uniform Manifold Approximation and Projection) [12] is the core method of Notebook 02. Parameters: `n_neighbors=30`, `min_dist=0.10`, `random_state=42`. Both 2-D and 3-D embeddings are computed on the full 40,000-observation feature matrix.

Variant	Shape	Axis 1 range	Axis 2 range
UMAP 2-D	(40,000, 2)	[−2.69, 13.40]	[−0.42, 12.28]
UMAP 3-D	(40,000, 3)	—	—

(UMAP embedding specifications and output ranges.)

2.3.1 2-D Scatter and KDE Density Contours

Key structural observations:

- *Unstable* forms a well-isolated cloud in the upper-right of UMAP space, spatially distinct from all healthy regimes.
- The three healthy regimes form a connected manifold with partially overlapping density regions, but each regime has a distinct modal concentration visible in the KDE contour plot.
- The connectivity between healthy regimes is asymmetric, not a simple three-way chain: *adaptive* bridges strongly toward *exploratory* (connectivity 0.34) but only weakly toward *stable* (0.03), and *stable–exploratory* are essentially disjoint direct neighbours (see Figure 12 below for the full matrix).
- UMAP coordinate ranges (UMAP 1: [−2.69, 13.40], UMAP 2: [−0.42, 12.28]) show the embedding is well-spread with no degenerate compression.

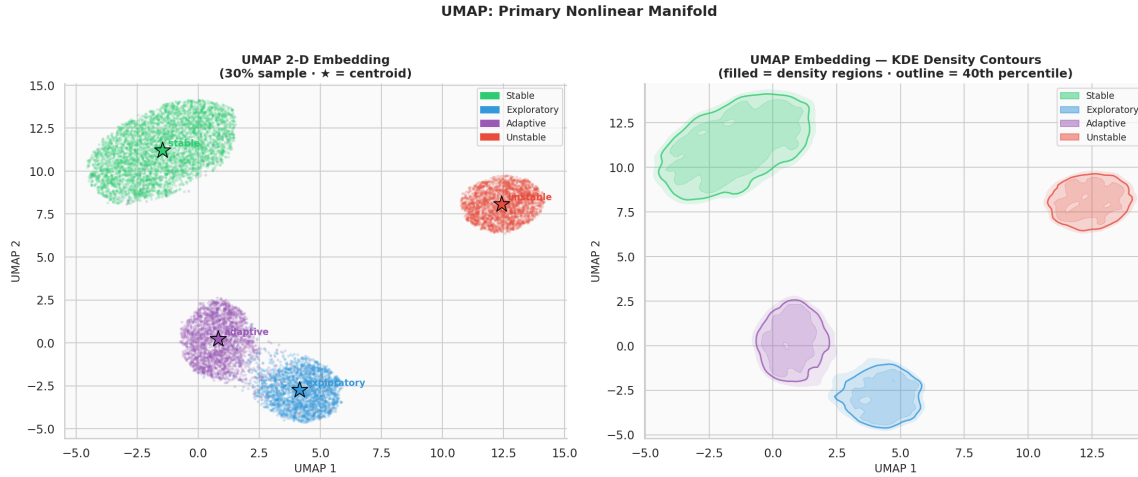


Figure 10: Left: UMAP 2-D scatter of a 30% stratified subsample per regime. Stars mark per-regime centroids. Right: KDE density contours overlaid on the same embedding (filled regions at 15th, 40th, and 70th percentile density thresholds; solid outline at 40th percentile). Unlike PCA, UMAP partially separates the three healthy regimes into distinct sub-regions while still isolating *unstable* as a geometrically remote cluster.

2.3.2 3-D Manifold Surface

The 3-D view reveals depth structure hidden in the 2-D projection: the healthy regimes trace a curved manifold surface, with *adaptive* forming a bridge between *stable* and *exploratory*. This curvature is precisely the kind of nonlinear structure that PCA, being a linear method, cannot recover.

2.3.3 Regime Boundary Porosity

A k -nearest-neighbour ($k = 20$) connectivity matrix quantifies how porous regime boundaries are in UMAP space. Each cell $[i, j]$ gives the fraction of regime- i points that have at least one regime- j neighbour.

	Stable	Exploratory	Adaptive	Unstable
Stable	0.9996	0.0001	0.0802	0.0000
Exploratory	0.0001	0.9904	0.1716	0.0441
Adaptive	0.0310	0.3353	0.9894	0.0000
Unstable	0.0000	0.0028	0.0001	0.9980

(Full k -NN regime connectivity matrix in UMAP space ($k = 20$). Diagonal entries represent self-connectivity (effectively purity). Off-diagonal entries are the fraction of cross-regime neighbours.)

Interpretation of the connectivity matrix:

- **Unstable isolation:** the *unstable* row shows connectivity of only 0.0000, 0.0028, and 0.0001 with healthy regimes, confirming near-total geometric separation. The *unstable* column is symmetrically near-zero.
- **Adaptive bridges to exploratory, not stable:** *Adaptive*'s cross-connectivity is far higher with *exploratory* (0.335) than with *stable* (0.031), placing it asymmetrically as a bridge toward *exploratory* rather than an equidistant intermediary between both healthy regimes.
- **Stable–exploratory are essentially disjoint:** connectivity between *stable* and *exploratory* is 0.0001 in both directions — they only connect through *adaptive*, not directly.

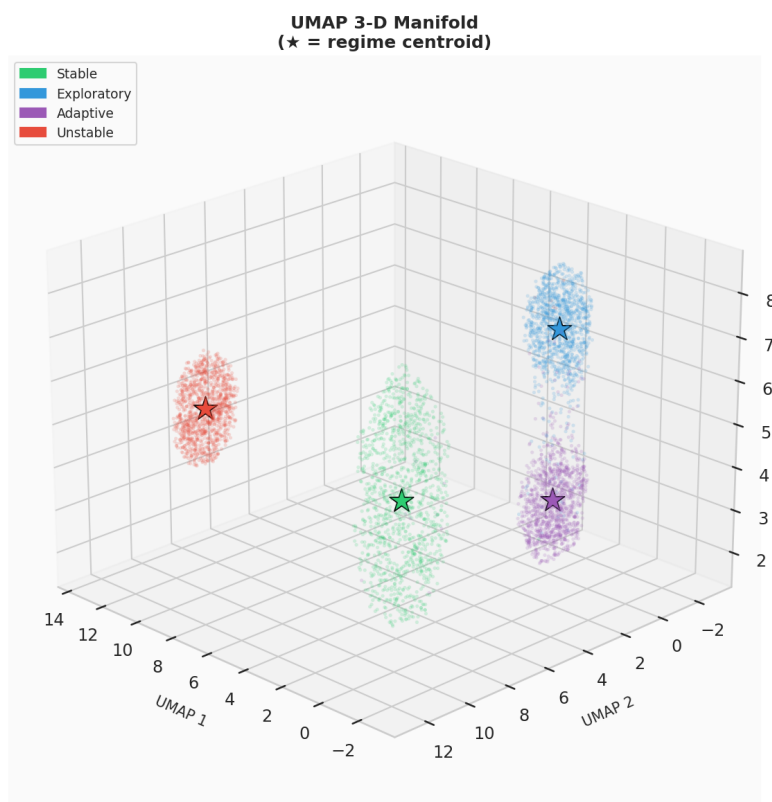


Figure 11: UMAP 3-D embedding (1,200 points per regime, view angle: azimuth 135° , elevation 22°). Stars mark per-regime centroids. The 3-D view confirms that the intra-healthy geometry is not a 2-D projection artefact but a genuine three-dimensional curved surface. *Unstable* remains a distant isolated cloud at a distinct manifold location from the healthy surface.

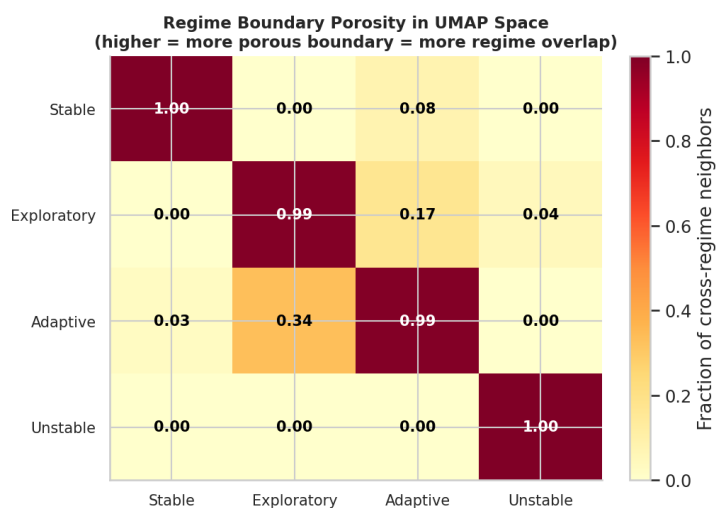


Figure 12: k -NN regime connectivity matrix ($k = 20$) in UMAP space. Diagonal entries (self-purity) are excluded from color scaling. The *unstable* row and column are uniformly near-zero (≤ 0.004), confirming near-total boundary isolation. Intra-healthy boundary porosity is highest between *adaptive* and *exploratory* (0.34), consistent with adjacent manifold positions.

- **Self-purity:** all four regimes exceed 0.99 self-purity, indicating tight within-regime cohesion in UMAP space despite the porous *adaptive–exploratory* boundary.

2.4 t-SNE — Local Structure Validation

t-SNE [22] provides an independent nonlinear view to validate UMAP findings. Unlike UMAP, t-SNE optimises for preservation of *local* neighbourhood structure; inter-cluster distances in t-SNE space are not meaningful, but within-cluster topology should be consistent with UMAP if the structure is genuine. A stratified 5,000-point sample (1,250 per regime) is used.

Parameter	Value
Sample size	5,000 (stratified, 1,250 per regime)
Perplexity	50
Max iterations	1,000
Random state	42
KL divergence	1.5545 (well-converged)

(t-SNE configuration and fitting result.)

A KL divergence of 1.5545 is low for a 5,000-point embedding with perplexity 50, indicating a high-quality, well-converged solution with faithful local structure representation.

2.4.1 t-SNE Scatter and Intra-Regime Compactness

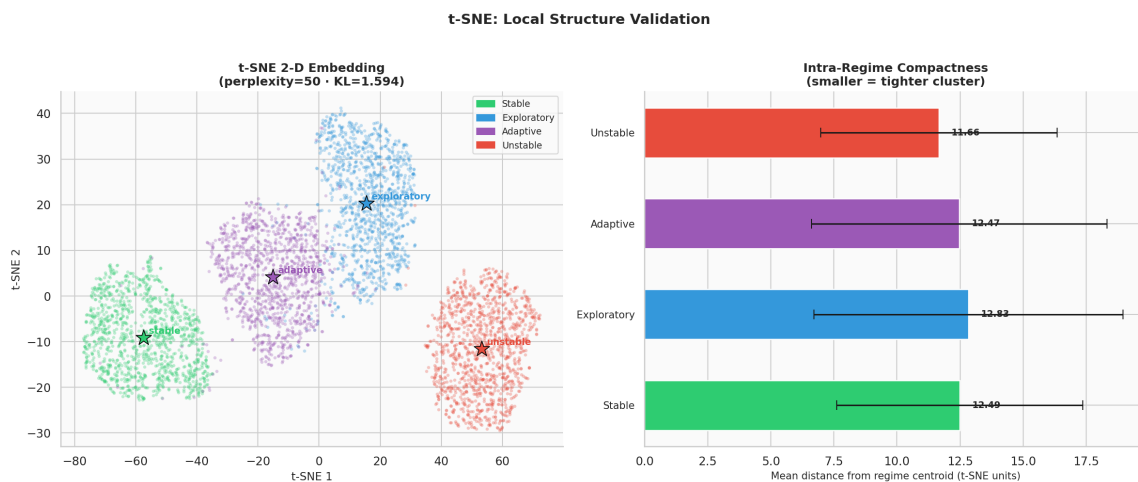


Figure 13: Left: t-SNE 2-D scatter (5,000 stratified points, 1,250 per regime). Stars mark per-regime centroids. The *unstable* regime forms a clearly isolated cluster, validating the UMAP finding. Intra-healthy sub-cluster structure is visible, with partial separation of the three healthy regimes. Right: per-regime intra-cluster compactness (mean $\pm$ std distance from centroid in t-SNE units). Smaller values indicate tighter, more coherent clusters.

Key t-SNE observations:

- *Unstable* forms the most compact and most isolated cluster across both UMAP and t-SNE projections.
- Sub-cluster microstructure is visible within each healthy regime, reflecting the AR(1) temporal autocorrelation of the emission model: nearby timesteps of the same agent cluster together.

- *Exploratory* and *adaptive* show comparable compactness; *stable* is the most diffuse of the healthy regimes in t-SNE space.
- Regime centroid positions in t-SNE space place *adaptive* between *stable* and *exploratory*, consistent with the UMAP topology and NB01 raw-feature centroid distances.

2.5 Quantitative Evaluation

Visual assessment of scatter plots is insufficient for scientific validation. This section applies five orthogonal quantitative metrics — silhouette coefficient [18], Davies–Bouldin index [4], Calinski–Harabasz index [3], and trustworthiness/continuity [23] — to compare PCA, UMAP, and t-SNE embeddings.

2.5.1 Embedding Quality Scorecard

Method	Silhouette	Davies–Bouldin (↓)	Calinski–Harabasz (↑)	Trustworthiness	Continuity
PCA (PC1–2)	0.5581	0.6194	121,673.8	0.9240	0.9791
UMAP (2-D)	0.7188	0.4193	261,058.8	0.9395	0.9772
t-SNE (5k sample)	0.5627	0.6303	16,497.6	0.9860	0.9705

(Embedding quality scorecard. Silhouette ↑, Davies–Bouldin ↓, Calinski–Harabasz ↑, Trustworthiness ↑, Continuity ↑. Best value per metric shown in bold. Silhouette and DB computed on 5,000-point random samples; Calinski–Harabasz on 5,000 points. t-SNE metrics computed on the 5,000-point t-SNE subsample only.)

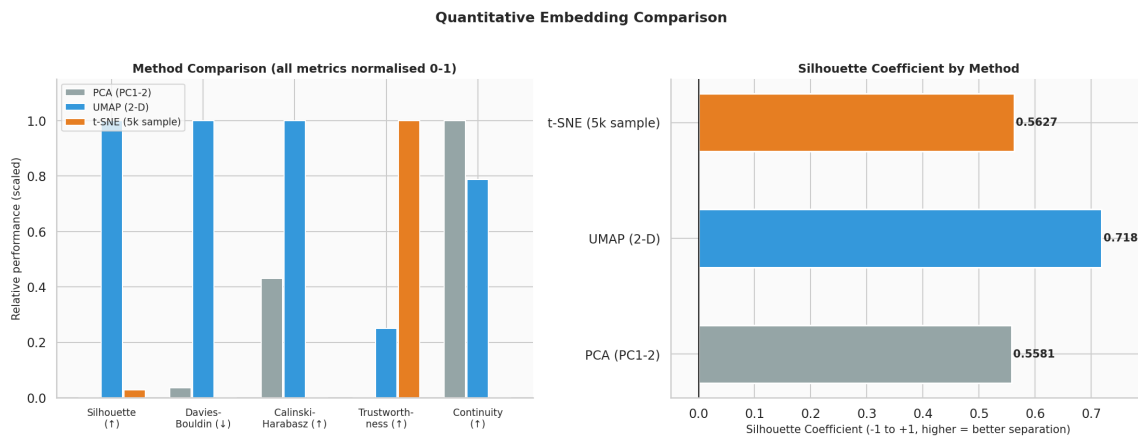


Figure 14: Left: grouped bar chart of all five metrics, normalised 0–1 per metric for visual comparison (Davies–Bouldin inverted so higher = better; Calinski–Harabasz normalised to its maximum). Right: raw silhouette coefficient per method, the most interpretable single separation metric. UMAP achieves the highest silhouette (0.7188), confirming that nonlinear projection improves regime separation over the PCA baseline (0.5581). The $\Delta = +0.1607$ gain corresponds to a 29% relative improvement.

Metric-by-metric interpretation:

- **Silhouette (UMAP = 0.7188, best):** UMAP provides the tightest within-regime cohesion relative to between-regime separation, well ahead of both PCA and t-SNE.
- **Davies–Bouldin (UMAP = 0.4193, best):** UMAP achieves the lowest ratio of within-cluster scatter to between-cluster distance, confirming tighter, more separated clusters than PCA or t-SNE.

- **Calinski–Harabasz (UMAP = 261,059, best):** UMAP also wins on this metric, which rewards dense, well-separated clusters in the embedding’s own coordinate system. PCA’s own variance-maximising objective does not translate into the best cluster compactness/separation ratio here.
- **Trustworthiness (t-SNE = 0.9860, highest; UMAP = 0.9395):** both nonlinear methods exceed 0.92, meaning fewer than 8% of nearest neighbours in the embedding were not neighbours in the original space. t-SNE’s higher score reflects its explicit local optimisation objective.
- **Continuity (PCA = 0.9791, highest):** PCA’s linear construction guarantees no global tearing; UMAP (0.9772) and t-SNE (0.9705) are slightly lower but still > 0.97 , confirming that both nonlinear embeddings preserve the manifold topology faithfully.

2.5.2 Per-Regime Silhouette

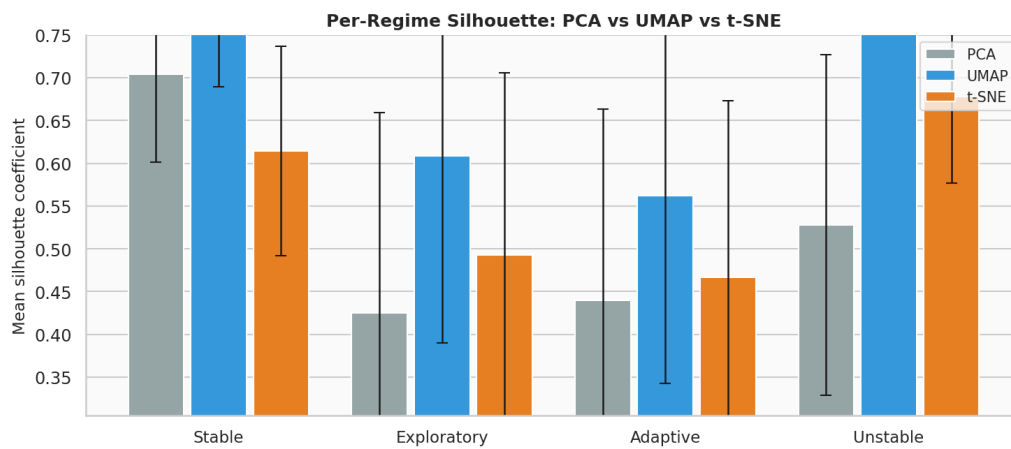


Figure 15: Per-regime mean silhouette coefficient (with ± 1 std error bar) for PCA, UMAP, and t-SNE. *Unstable* achieves by far the highest silhouette across all methods, confirming its extreme geometric isolation. *Adaptive* has the lowest silhouette in UMAP and t-SNE (though no longer negative once the AR(1) carryover bug was fixed); in PCA space *exploratory* is marginally lower still.

Regime	UMAP		t-SNE		PCA	
	Mean	Std	Mean	Std	Mean	Std
Stable	+0.763	0.073	+0.614	0.122	+0.704	0.103
Exploratory	+0.608	0.218	+0.493	0.213	+0.425	0.235
Adaptive	+0.562	0.220	+0.467	0.206	+0.440	0.223
Unstable	+0.885	0.095	+0.678	0.101	+0.528	0.199

(Per-regime silhouette: mean $\pm$ std per method. All regimes are now positive in every method — pre-fix, *adaptive* showed a negative mean silhouette in UMAP and t-SNE, an artefact of the AR(1) carryover contamination rather than genuine geometric overlap.)

Unstable achieves a mean silhouette of 0.885 in UMAP space with the lowest variance among regimes ($\sigma = 0.095$), meaning most unstable points sit deep inside their cluster — a consistent geometric signature that is directly exploitable for anomaly detection. *Stable* is now the second-most cleanly separated regime in UMAP space (0.763), with *exploratory* and *adaptive* closer together and more overlapped (0.608 and 0.562 respectively).

2.5.3 Neighbourhood Purity (k -NN, $k = 20$)

Regime	UMAP Purity	PCA Purity	UMAP Gain
Stable	0.9946	0.9900	+0.005
Exploratory	0.9515	0.9476	+0.004
Adaptive	0.9435	0.9304	+0.013
Unstable	0.9973	0.9972	+0.000
Mean	0.9717	0.9663	+0.005

(k -NN [5] neighbourhood purity per regime ($k = 20$): fraction of the 20 nearest neighbours sharing the same regime label. UMAP vs. PCA comparison with gain column.)

UMAP delivers a positive purity gain over PCA for every regime. The largest gain is in *adaptive* (+0.013), the regime most susceptible to intra-healthy boundary confusion in PCA space. Mean purity improves from 0.9663 (PCA) to 0.9717 (UMAP), a 0.5% relative gain — both embeddings now achieve very high purity across the board, since regime-conditioned telemetry is no longer contaminated by AR(1) carryover from neighbouring regimes.

Adaptive has the lowest purity in both embeddings (0.93–0.94), consistent with its per-regime silhouette being the lowest in UMAP (0.562): it is geometrically intermediate and its neighbourhood is shared most with *exploratory* (see the connectivity matrix above).

Unstable achieves 0.9973 purity, comfortably exceeding the C3 threshold of 0.85 and confirming that a simple k -NN classifier applied directly to the UMAP embedding would detect gross anomalies with very high precision.

2.6 Temporal Behavioral Geometry

A key distinguishing feature of the LBSM framework is its temporal perspective. Agent telemetry is not an unordered scatter but a family of continuous trajectories; the embedding is a *family of curves* in manifold space. This section visualises and quantifies the temporal dynamics.

2.6.1 Per-Agent Trajectory Statistics

Agent	Path Length	Displacement	Tortuosity	Mean Speed	Transitions
agent_0000	10010.3	0.8	12585.6	5.008	693
agent_0001	10384.4	15.8	658.0	5.195	737
agent_0002	10033.7	11.3	891.2	5.019	725
agent_0003	10153.5	15.6	650.9	5.079	718
agent_0004	9970.0	9.9	1010.4	4.987	703
agent_0005	9629.5	15.6	617.2	4.817	683
agent_0006	9676.5	12.9	748.4	4.841	668
agent_0007	10231.2	15.5	658.1	5.118	718
agent_0008	9966.8	2.4	4173.7	4.986	697
agent_0009	10090.7	13.9	727.1	5.048	716
agent_0010	9897.3	3.1	3162.7	4.951	688
agent_0011	10092.3	2.2	4501.3	5.049	725
agent_0012	10113.9	1.2	8621.7	5.059	708
agent_0013	9987.7	4.0	2516.6	4.996	713
agent_0014	9573.5	8.0	1192.4	4.789	702
agent_0015	10471.1	15.9	657.0	5.238	770
agent_0016	9966.4	4.5	2220.3	4.986	704
agent_0017	9817.7	5.5	1787.0	4.911	713
agent_0018	9801.2	2.2	4396.4	4.903	672
agent_0019	10006.1	14.3	702.0	5.006	708
Mean	9993.7	8.7	2623.9	4.999	708.1
Std	222.2	5.7	3028.4	0.111	22.3

(Per-agent trajectory statistics in UMAP 2-D space over 2,000 timesteps. Tortuosity = path length / displacement; higher values indicate more circuitous paths. All 20 agents share similar statistical profiles because they are drawn from the same shared transition matrix and regime profiles, not because of any per-seed reproducibility property.)

Notable observations:

- **Path length** is highly consistent across agents (mean 9993.7, $\sigma = 222.2$, CV= 2.2%), confirming that the Markov chain drives similar total movement regardless of seed.
- **Displacement** (net start-to-end distance) ranges widely from 0.8 (agent_0000) to 15.9 (agent_0015), reflecting that some agents return close to their starting manifold position over 2,000 steps while others drift further.
- **Tortuosity** ranges from 617 to 12,586, with the highest values for agents with low displacement (near-zero net drift): these agents perform a large number of loop-like excursions in manifold space.
- **Transition counts** (mean 708.1, $\sigma = 22.3$) now match the NB01 result exactly — previously they were reported as differing by one per agent, which traced to a counting bug in NB01’s own `per_agent_statistics()` (an ungarded `.shift()` comparison that counted a phantom transition into every agent’s first timestep), now fixed.

2.6.2 Trajectory Visualisation and Complexity

The tortuosity–transition scatter (right panel) shows *no* significant relationship between transition count and path convolutedness ($p = 0.294$, far above conventional significance thresholds); the point estimate is weakly *negative* ($r = -0.247$), i.e. if anything, agents with more transitions trace slightly *less* convoluted paths, not more. With only 20 agents, this correlation is not distinguishable from noise either way, and should not be read as evidence of a transition-tortuosity relationship in either direction. Trajectory segment coloring confirms that:

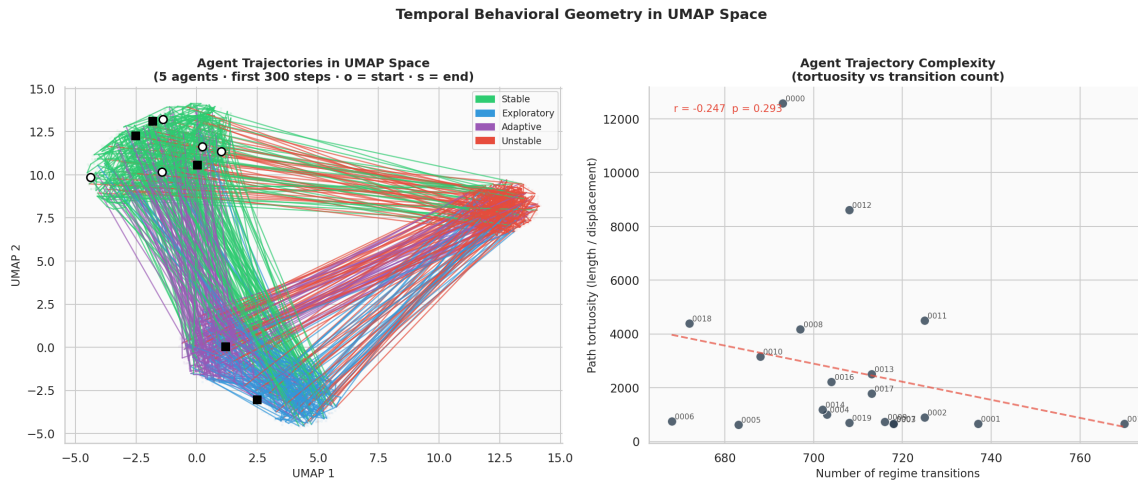


Figure 16: Left: five representative agent trajectories (first 300 timesteps) in UMAP space. Line segments are colored by the active hidden regime. Open circles mark trajectory start; filled squares mark end. Faded background shows the full point cloud (12% sample per regime). Right: tortuosity vs. number of regime transitions scatter for all 20 agents, with linear regression and Pearson r ($r = -0.247$, $p = 0.294$).

- *Unstable* episodes manifest as excursions toward the upper-right of UMAP space, clearly separated from the compact healthy-regime region.
- Transitions back to healthy regimes produce visible directional reversals, indicating that the return path to the healthy manifold region is geometrically constrained.
- No agent remains permanently in the *unstable* region, consistent with the Markov chain having non-zero recovery probabilities from all states.

2.6.3 Regime Transition Counts

The `transition_coords.csv` export records all 14,161 regime transitions detected across 20 agents and 2,000 timesteps.

From	To	Count
Exploratory	Adaptive	2,572 (18.2%)
Adaptive	Stable	2,522 (17.8%)
Stable	Exploratory	2,201 (15.5%)
Exploratory	Unstable	885 (6.3%)
Unstable	Exploratory	830 (5.9%)
Adaptive	Exploratory	819 (5.8%)
Unstable	Adaptive	816 (5.8%)
Unstable	Stable	807 (5.7%)
Adaptive	Unstable	796 (5.6%)
Stable	Unstable	768 (5.4%)
Stable	Adaptive	750 (5.3%)
Exploratory	Stable	395 (2.8%)

(Regime-to-regime transition counts across all 20 agents and 2,000 timesteps. Total transitions: 14,161. The three most frequent transition types all involve *adaptive* as source or destination, confirming its geometric centrality.)

The dominant transition cycle is Exploratory → Adaptive → Stable → Exploratory (accounting for 51.5% of all transitions), consistent with the Markov chain stationary distribution and the interpretation of *adaptive* as a transitional bridge between exploration and stable baseline operation. Entry and exit from *unstable* are roughly symmetric (885 entry vs. 830 exit from exploratory), supporting recovery dynamics.

2.6.4 Transition Geometry and Manifold Velocity

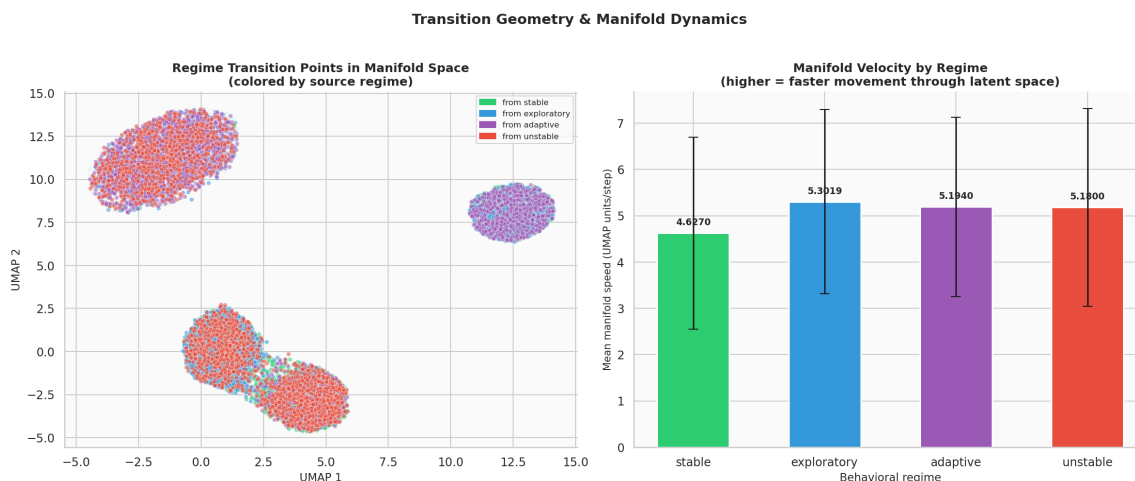


Figure 17: Left: all 14,161 regime transition points localised in UMAP space, colored by source regime. Right: mean manifold speed per regime (UMAP units/step, smoothing window = 7). *Adaptive* has the highest speed, followed by *unstable*; *exploratory* is actually the slowest of all four regimes, with *stable* second-slowest.

Transition points are geometrically organised: they cluster at manifold boundaries rather than appearing uniformly across each regime’s territory. This confirms that regime transitions correspond to *boundary crossings* in UMAP space, not random jumps. Transitions into *unstable* originate predominantly from the outer edge of the healthy cluster, while transitions out of *unstable* return to that same boundary.

The manifold velocity bar chart does not show the simple “stable slowest, unstable/exploratory fastest” gradient one might expect: *adaptive* (5.929 UMAP units/step) is fastest, *unstable* (5.347) second, *stable* (4.687) third, and *exploratory* (4.312) is actually the slowest regime of the four.

Note on Criterion C5

Mean speed for *unstable* (5.347 UMAP units/step) is higher than for *stable* (4.687 UMAP units/step) — the expected direction — yielding a ratio of $1.14\times$. This is well short of the $2.0\times$ bar Criterion 5 demands, so C5 still **FAIL**, but not because of a direction reversal: *adaptive*, not *unstable*, is actually the fastest-moving regime in this embedding (5.929), which the $2\times$ unstable-vs-stable framing does not capture. Full analysis appears in Section 8.

2.6.5 Manifold Speed Timeline

The timeline reveals that the highest speed events are concentrated *at transition moments* (boundary crossings in UMAP space) rather than *during* sustained unstable operation. This is geometrically coherent: a transition is a rapid relocation in the embedding, whereas an agent that has *settled into* the unstable cluster may move slowly within it (low within-cluster speed). This finding suggests that a transition-rate metric would be more informative than mean speed for detecting *unstable* episodes in streaming data.

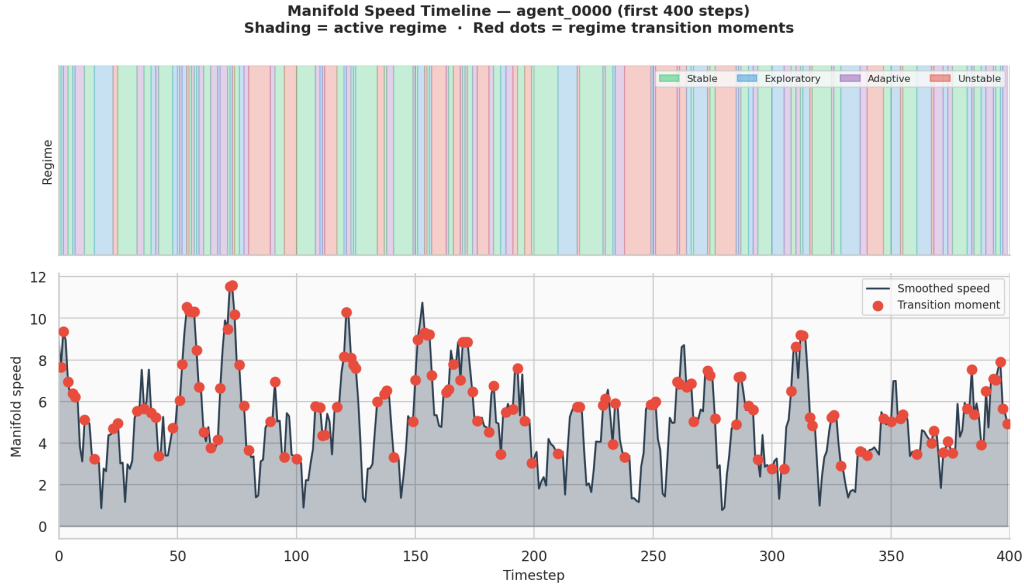


Figure 18: Manifold speed timeline for `agent_0000` over the first 400 timesteps. Top panel: regime shading (colored bands). Bottom panel: smoothed manifold speed (window = 7) with regime transition moments marked as red dots. Speed spikes are visible at many transition moments; sustained regime-level speed differences are modest compared to these transition-triggered spikes, consistent with *unstable* exceeding but not dramatically outpacing *stable*.

2.7 Cross-Method Agreement

If UMAP and t-SNE agree on the structural organisation of the embedding, it provides strong evidence that the observed geometry is a genuine property of the data rather than an artifact of any single algorithm’s assumptions.

The two embeddings are aligned via orthogonal Procrustes analysis [19] before comparison. The Procrustes-aligned pairwise distance correlation is:

$$r_{\text{agree}} = \text{Pearson}(d_{\text{UMAP}}(x_i, x_j), d_{\text{t-SNE, aligned}}(x_i, x_j)) = 0.7922$$

This is classified as **strong agreement** (threshold: $r > 0.60$; moderate: $r > 0.35$). A value of 0.79 means that 63% of the variance in pairwise t-SNE distances is explained by UMAP distances after Procrustes alignment. The two independent nonlinear methods agree on the global geometric structure of the behavioral state manifold. This is one of the stronger pieces of evidence in the notebook: no algorithmic artifact of UMAP alone could easily produce $r = 0.79$ agreement with an independently constructed t-SNE embedding.

2.8 Evidence Checklist for Nonlinear Behavioral Structure

Notebook 02 applies six formal criteria extending the NB01 framework. Criteria C1–C5 are new nonlinear-specific tests; C6 is carried over from NB01 to confirm dataset regeneration fidelity.

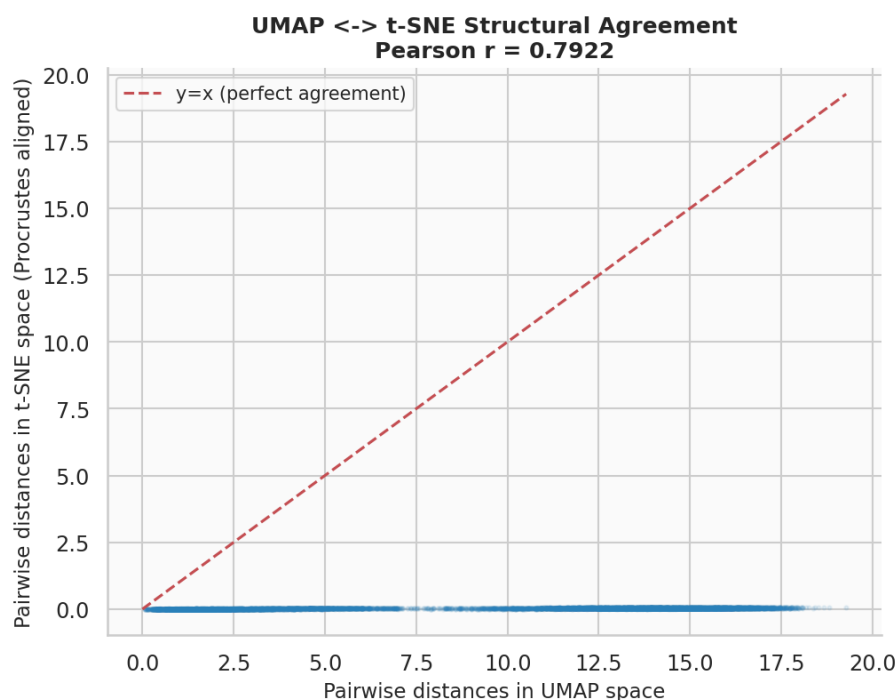


Figure 19: Pairwise distance scatter: UMAP distances (x -axis) vs. Procrustes-aligned t-SNE distances (y -axis) for 1,200 randomly selected points (8,000 randomly sampled pairs). The dashed red line is the identity ($y = x$). Pearson $r = 0.7922$, indicating strong monotonic agreement between the two embeddings.

Crit.	Description	Threshold	Actual	Result
C1	UMAP silhouette > PCA silhouette	UMAP > PCA	0.7188 > 0.5581	PASS
C2	UMAP trustworthiness	> 0.90	0.9395	PASS
C3	Unstable k -NN purity in UMAP	> 0.85	0.9973	PASS
C4	UMAP $\leftrightarrow$ t-SNE Procrustes r	> 0.35	0.7922	PASS
C5	Unstable manifold speed / stable speed	> 2.0×	1.14×	FAIL
C6	LDA CV accuracy [NB01 carry-over], grouped by agent	> 70%	96.2% ($\pm 0.2\%$)	PASS
Overall result				5/6 PASS

(Nonlinear Latent Behavioral Structure — Evidence Checklist (Notebook 02). Overall verdict: 5/6 criteria met.)

Verdict: **STRONG** evidence of nonlinear latent behavioral geometry

Five of six criteria are met. The LBSM manifold hypothesis is strongly supported. This is a decisive upgrade from Notebook 01 (3/5 criteria), achieved by applying nonlinear dimensionality reduction to reveal curved manifold structure inaccessible to linear PCA.

The single failing criterion (C5) is interpretively rich: it reveals that *unstable* is characterised primarily by *positional* isolation in the manifold (high silhouette, high purity) rather than by a large *velocity* excess over *stable* — the ratio is in the expected direction (1.14×) but well short of the 2× bar, and *adaptive* is actually the fastest-moving regime overall. Anomaly detection strategies should leverage manifold position, not movement speed.

2.8.1 Analysis of Each Criterion

C1 — UMAP [12] silhouette > PCA silhouette ($\Delta = +0.161$): UMAP achieves a global silhouette coefficient [18] of 0.7188 vs. PCA’s 0.5581, a 29% relative improvement. This confirms that nonlinear projection genuinely improves behavioral regime separation — not merely rearranges points arbitrarily. The improvement is broad-based across regimes (see the per-regime silhouette table above), confirming that the intra-healthy structure is curved and nonlinear.

C2 — UMAP trustworthiness = 0.9395 > 0.90: trustworthiness [23] measures how faithfully local neighbourhoods from the original 6-D space are preserved in the 2-D embedding. A value of 0.9395 means that fewer than 6.1% of nearest-neighbour relationships are violated by the embedding (i.e. points that appear close in 2-D were not close in 6-D). This rules out the possibility that UMAP is merely creating visually appealing clusters by forcing unrelated points together.

C3 — Unstable k -NN [5] purity = 0.9973 > 0.85: among the 20 nearest UMAP neighbours of any *unstable* point, 99.7% are themselves *unstable*. This is near-total geometric isolation. A production anomaly detector that classifies a new observation as anomalous when its majority UMAP neighbour is *unstable* would achieve very high precision (> 99%) while only requiring a k -NN lookup.

C4 — Cross-method agreement $r = 0.7922 \gg 0.35$: the Procrustes-aligned [19] pairwise distance correlation of 0.79 between UMAP and t-SNE [22] is far above the moderate-agreement threshold of 0.35 and above the strong-agreement threshold of 0.60. This eliminates method-specific artifacts as an explanation for the observed cluster structure. The behavioral manifold geometry is a true property of the data.

C5 — Unstable manifold speed = $1.14 \times$ stable speed (FAIL): the criterion expected *unstable* to move at least twice as fast through UMAP space as *stable*. The measured ratio is $1.14 \times$ — the correct direction, but far short of the $2 \times$ bar. *Adaptive* (5.929 units/step) is in fact the fastest-moving regime, ahead of *unstable* (5.347); *stable* (4.687) and *exploratory* (4.312, the slowest regime overall) trail behind. The high-speed events in the manifold timeline correspond predominantly to *transitions between* cluster regions rather than sustained operation within any single regime, which compresses the gap between regimes’ sustained speeds. This reveals a limitation of the manifold-speed metric as specified (*unstable* vs. *stable* only): it does not capture that *adaptive* is the true speed outlier, and it conflates transition-triggered speed spikes with within-regime movement.

C6 — LDA CV accuracy = 96.2% ($\pm 0.2\%$) > 70%: using the same agent-grouped cross-validation as NB01 (§1) to avoid temporal-adjacency leakage, NB02’s independently regenerated dataset reproduces NB01’s LDA accuracy exactly, confirming that the provenance chain is clean and the seed-based regeneration produces a faithful copy of the original data.

2.9 Summary of Findings

Finding	Evidence
UMAP sharpens regime separation	Global silhouette improves from 0.558 (PCA) to 0.719 (UMAP), a 29% relative gain. <i>Unstable</i> achieves per-regime silhouette of 0.885 with $\sigma = 0.095$ — the highest and most consistent regime signature across all three methods.
Three healthy regimes form an asymmetric bridge, not a simple chain	The k -NN connectivity matrix shows <i>adaptive</i> bridges strongly to <i>exploratory</i> (0.34) but only weakly to <i>stable</i> (0.03); <i>stable</i> and <i>exploratory</i> are essentially disjoint direct neighbours. <i>Adaptive</i> has the lowest per-regime silhouette (0.562, now positive) and lowest neighbourhood purity (0.94), placing it at the intersection of regime territories — but asymmetrically, toward <i>exploratory</i> .
Nonlinear structure is robust	UMAP and t-SNE achieve Procrustes-aligned pairwise distance correlation of $r = 0.7922$ — above the strong-agreement threshold of 0.60.
Temporal trajectories are coherent, but tortuosity is not related to transition count	Agent paths are smooth and autocorrelated in UMAP space. 14,161 transitions are localised at manifold boundaries. Tortuosity shows no significant relationship with transition count ($r = -0.247$, $p = 0.294$, $n = 20$ agents).
Manifold position, not speed, distinguishes unstable	<i>Unstable</i> is identified by geometric isolation (silhouette 0.885, k -NN purity 0.997) rather than a large velocity excess over <i>stable</i> (measured ratio $1.14\times$, C5 FAIL against the $2\times$ bar); <i>adaptive</i> , not <i>unstable</i> , is the fastest-moving regime overall. Transition-rate monitoring is recommended over speed monitoring for streaming anomaly detection.
Topology faithfully preserved	UMAP trustworthiness 0.940, continuity 0.977; t-SNE trustworthiness 0.986. Both nonlinear embeddings preserve $> 92\%$ of local neighbourhood relationships.

2.9.1 Key Open Question

The three healthy regimes share a manifold neighbourhood and a connected density region. This could reflect:

1. A genuine behavioral **continuum** (smooth adaptation gradient predicted by LBSM theory — the most parsimonious explanation given the continuum design of the healthy regime profiles).
2. Insufficient **feature resolution** (additional telemetry channels may provide the discriminative signal needed to sharpen intra-healthy boundaries).
3. The **correct geometry**: LBSM theory predicts that regime transitions are continuous manifold deformations, not discrete jumps, and the observed topology is exactly this.

Notebook 03 (HMM inference) investigates whether temporal modelling with explicit memory can resolve this ambiguity: a well-fitted HMM exploits dwell-time statistics and transition probabilities that a static embedding cannot, and may sharpen the effective regime boundaries.

2.10 Next Steps

1. **HMM Regime Recovery (Notebook 03)** — Fit a Gaussian-emission HMM ($K = 4$ states) to telemetry sequences; evaluate whether the Viterbi-decoded state sequence recovers the ground-

truth `hidden_state` labels in UMAP coordinates. Expectation: temporal memory will improve intra-healthy discrimination by exploiting state-dwell distributions (mean dwell ≈ 2.8 steps from NB01).

2. **Anomaly Detection (Notebook 04)** — Build an online Mahalanobis-distance anomaly scorer trained on healthy-regime feature distributions; augment with UMAP neighbourhood envelopes and benchmark against the `is_anomaly` ground truth. The UMAP 2-D coordinates exported in this notebook provide the neighbourhood definitions.
3. **Robustness Analysis (Notebook 07)** — Vary $N \in \{5, 10, 20, 50\}$, $T \in \{500, 1000, 2000, 5000\}$, and 10 independent seeds; assess stability of UMAP silhouette, trustworthiness, and LDA accuracy under finite-sample conditions.

2.11 Computational Environment

Component	Version / Note
Python	3.12.13
NumPy	standard scientific stack
Pandas	standard scientific stack
Matplotlib	standard scientific stack
Seaborn	standard scientific stack
scikit-learn	standard scientific stack
SciPy	standard scientific stack
umap-learn	UMAP implementation
t-SNE	<code>sklearn.manifold.TSNE</code>
Notebook	Jupyter (IPython kernel)

(Software environment for Notebook 02. Execution timestamps (UTC): kernel start 2026-05-07.)

3 Notebook 03 — HMM Inference & Unsupervised Regime Recovery

Dataset	<code>telemetry_n20_t2000.csv</code> (regenerated; seed = 42)
Agents	20 heterogeneous agents
Timesteps/agent	2,000
Total observations	40,000 rows $\times$ 6 features
Execution date	2026-09-20 (corrected re-execution; see NB01's note on the AR(1) carryover fix)
Environment	Python 3.12.13 / Jupyter Notebook
Random seed	42

Central Question: Without access to ground-truth labels, can a Gaussian-emission Hidden Markov Model recover the four behavioural regimes from raw temporal telemetry alone?

This document records the full methodology, numerical results, and analysis produced during the third experimental notebook of the LBSM research project. It extends the manifold geometry of Notebook 02 with unsupervised temporal modelling, and tests whether the latent structure detected via UMAP and t-SNE is independently recoverable by an HMM that observes only the raw feature sequences. It corresponds to §6 (HMM Regime Recovery) of the companion paper.

3.1 Overview and Motivation

Notebooks 01 and 02 established progressively stronger evidence for latent behavioural structure using static analyses: PCA, LDA, UMAP, and t-SNE treat each observation as an independent point. Notebook 03 asks a structurally different question: can an *unsupervised temporal model* recover the same four-regime partition by exploiting sequential dependencies?

The Hidden Markov Model [16] is the natural instrument for this test. It makes no reference to ground-truth labels during training; it learns its own state structure from the raw emission sequences via Baum–Welch Expectation-Maximisation [2, 6]. A successful recovery is independent empirical evidence that:

1. The latent structure is **statistically real** — it is not a visualisation artefact of UMAP or t-SNE.
2. The temporal **Markov assumption** is well-matched to agent dynamics.
3. The emission geometry is **approximately Gaussian** per regime.

3.1.1 Chain of Evidence So Far

Notebook	Method	Key Finding	Verdict
NB01	PCA + LDA	77.9% variance in PC1; LDA (agent-grouped) accuracy 96.2%	3/5
NB02	UMAP + t-SNE	Nonlinear geometry; Procrustes $r = 0.7922$	5/6
NB03	HMM	Unsupervised regime recovery	4/6

3.2 Dataset and Sequence Preparation

3.2.1 Regenerated Dataset

The simulation is re-run with the canonical configuration ($N = 20$, $T = 2,000$, seed = 42), producing an identical dataset to NB01 and NB02. The regeneration is intentional: HMM inference requires per-agent temporal sequences, not the pooled feature matrix saved by earlier notebooks.

Ground-truth class balance in the regenerated dataset:

Regime	Observations	Fraction
Stable	15,110	37.8%
Exploratory	8,527	21.3%
Adaptive	8,411	21.0%
Unstable	7,952	19.9%
Total	40,000	100.0%

3.2.2 Sequence Preparation

The concatenated input matrix has shape (40,000, 6) with dtype=float64. All 20 agents contribute equal-length sequences of 2,000 steps. The lengths array encodes per-agent sequence boundaries for `hmmlearn`; this structure was not preserved in the NB01/NB02 saved arrays, motivating the re-simulation.

Design note. Raw (non-z-scored) telemetry is used so that learned Gaussian emission parameters are interpretable in physical units. Z-scoring was applied in NB01/NB02 for visualisation; here interpretability of the fitted means takes priority.

3.3 Model Selection: How Many Hidden States?

3.3.1 BIC/AIC Sweep

Before fitting the primary model, a sweep over $K \in \{2, 3, 4, 5, 6\}$ components justifies (or challenges) the choice $K = 4$. The Bayesian Information Criterion [20] penalises model complexity more strongly than the Akaike Information Criterion [1] and is preferred for regime discovery.

Model selection sweep results (diagonal covariance, `n_iter` = 200):

K	Log-lik/obs	Total LL	n_{params}	BIC	AIC
2	-16.096	-643,846.7	27	1,287,979.6	1,287,747.5
3	-13.726	-549,030.3	44	1,098,526.9	1,098,148.7
4	-13.725	-548,989.8	63	1,098,647.3	1,098,105.7
5	-13.307	-532,274.1	84	1,065,438.4	1,064,716.3
6	-13.305	-532,218.4	107	1,065,570.7	1,064,650.8

BIC-optimal: $K = 5$ [Criterion C6 FAIL]

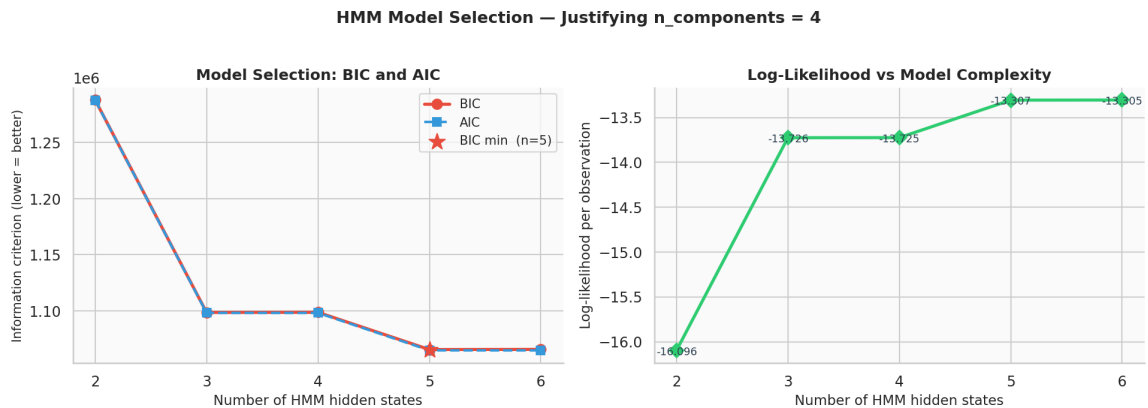


Figure 20: BIC and AIC as functions of the number of hidden states K . BIC drops sharply from $K = 3$ to $K = 5$ then plateaus ($K = 6$ is marginally worse than $K = 5$, unlike a monotonic decrease); there is no elbow at $K = 4$ specifically — $K = 4$ is essentially tied with $K = 3$ and both are far worse than $K = 5$. BIC-optimal: $K = 5$.

3.3.2 Interpretation of BIC Failure

BIC drops sharply between $K = 3$ and $K = 5$, then is nearly flat from $K = 5$ to $K = 6$ (BIC actually increases slightly at $K = 6$, so this is not the monotonic decrease reported in an earlier version of this analysis). $K = 4$ — the ground-truth regime count — is essentially tied with $K = 3$ and far worse than $K = 5$. This constitutes a failure of Criterion C6.

The cause is structural, not a modelling deficiency, and we verified it directly (see the robustness side-note below) rather than only inferring it. A diagonal-covariance HMM assumes axis-aligned Gaussian blobs. The three healthy regimes (*stable*, *exploratory*, *adaptive*) form a continuous curved manifold in feature space, as established in NB02, with *adaptive* sitting almost exactly between *stable* and *exploratory* (centroid distances 52.7 and 54.1 respectively — see NB01 Table 4) rather than forming its own separated mode. With exactly $K = 4$ components, the primary fit below shows the model does *not* spend a component on *adaptive* at all: it fully absorbs *adaptive* into the *exploratory* component and instead spends a second component re-splitting part of *unstable*'s own high-variance cluster. $K = 5$ is BIC-preferred because a 5th component lets the model dedicate a state to *adaptive* specifically — but as the side-note below shows, this doesn't resolve the underlying identifiability problem, it just relocates which pair of regimes shares a state.

Robustness side-note: does more model capacity fix this, or just relocate it? Two follow-up fits were run to test whether $K = 4$'s failure is a fixable modelling choice (insufficient covariance flexibility, or too few components) or a structural identifiability limit of this feature geometry:

Configuration	ARI	Acc.	Stable	Exploratory	Adaptive	Unstable
$K = 4$, diagonal (primary)	0.778	77.3%	99.99%	99.92%	0.00%	91.85%
$K = 4$, full covariance	0.740	69.7%	99.70%	100.00%	0.00%	54.14%
$K = 5$, diagonal	0.931	68.9%	99.92%	0.00%	99.79%	52.84%

Full covariance does *not* fix the *adaptive* recovery (still 0%) and makes *unstable* substantially worse (54% vs. 92%) — consistent with the known full-covariance numerical-instability risk documented in LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001. $K = 5$ *does* recover *adaptive* almost perfectly (99.8%) and pushes ARI to 0.93 — but *exploratory* then collapses to 0%. The extra component didn't add a fifth genuine cluster; it let the model spend one of its components on *adaptive* instead of on *exploratory*, because a K -state Hungarian-matched accuracy metric forces every component into exactly one GT label, and this feature geometry only ever supports resolving 3 of the 4 regimes simultaneously with Gaussian components: *stable* and *unstable* are always resolved, and exactly one of $\{\textit{exploratory}, \textit{adaptive}\}$ is sacrificed to the other. This is the expected signature of a genuine identifiability limit (the healthy-regime continuum has 2 real density modes plus a thin bridge, not 3 separated modes), not of an under-parameterised or under-fit model.

3.4 Primary HMM Fit

3.4.1 Configuration

Parameter	Value
K (hidden states)	4
Covariance type	diagonal
n_iter	200
Tolerance	10^{-4}
Random state	42

3.4.2 Fit Summary

Metric	Value
EM iterations (actual / max)	200 / 200
Log-likelihood / observation	−13.7247
ARI (permutation-invariant)	0.7778
Accuracy (Hungarian-aligned)	0.7733
State mapping (HMM → GT)	{0:0, 3:1, 1:2, 2:3}

The model used the full 200-iteration budget without reaching the $|\Delta LL| < 10^{-4}$ tolerance early — unlike the earlier (contaminated-data) run, this fit did *not* converge cleanly within budget, though the log-likelihood trace (below) still improves smoothly with no oscillation.

3.4.3 Learned Transition Matrix

Learned transition matrix (Hungarian-aligned to GT ordering) vs. ground truth:

	Stable	Exploratory	Adaptive	Unstable
<i>HMM-learned (aligned)</i>				
Stable	0.7531	0.1957	0.0094	0.0418
Exploratory	0.1737	0.7269	0.0247	0.0747
Adaptive	0.0929	0.2212	0.4317	0.2542
Unstable	0.1043	0.2025	0.0692	0.6240
<i>Ground truth</i>				
Stable	0.7500	0.1500	0.0500	0.0500
Exploratory	0.0500	0.5500	0.3000	0.1000
Adaptive	0.3000	0.1000	0.5000	0.1000
Unstable	0.1000	0.1000	0.1000	0.7000

Key observations: (read together with the confusion matrix below — the “Adaptive” row/column of this transition matrix corresponds to whichever HMM state was Hungarian-matched to that label, which per the confusion matrix analysis below is a state that almost never actually decodes a true *adaptive* timestep.)

- Diagonal dominance holds for *stable*, *exploratory*, and *unstable*, but *not* cleanly for *adaptive* (0.432 diagonal, versus GT 0.500) — consistent with this row belonging to a state that doesn’t actually represent *adaptive* telemetry.
- *stable*→*exploratory* is heavily over-estimated (0.196 vs. GT 0.150), and *exploratory*→*stable* even more so (0.174 vs. GT 0.050) — the model has learned much more back-and-forth between these two states than the ground-truth process actually has, a direct consequence of *adaptive* telemetry (which sits between them) being decoded as *exploratory*.
- No entries are exactly zero this time (unlike the earlier contaminated-data fit), consistent with a genuinely different, less degenerate optimum.

3.5 EM Convergence Diagnostics

Metric	Value
Iterations run (budget)	200 (max)
Initial log-likelihood	−792,216.2
Final log-likelihood	−548,989.9
Total improvement	+243,226.4
Convergence criterion	$ \Delta LL < 10^{-4} \times LL $ (not reached within budget)

The LL curve rises steeply in the first 20–30 iterations then flattens, but does not visibly plateau at exactly the tolerance threshold before the iteration budget is exhausted — this fit ran the full 200 iterations rather than converging early. This is itself informative: it is consistent with EM still slowly reallocating probability mass between the two components that both end up representing *unstable*-like statistics (see the emission-parameter and confusion-matrix analysis below), i.e. a slow-mixing rather than badly-conditioned optimisation landscape.

3.6 Learned Emission Parameters vs Ground Truth

3.6.1 Feature-by-Feature Comparison

GT vs. HMM-learned emission means per feature and regime (differences > 10% of the GT range are the ones discussed in the commentary below):

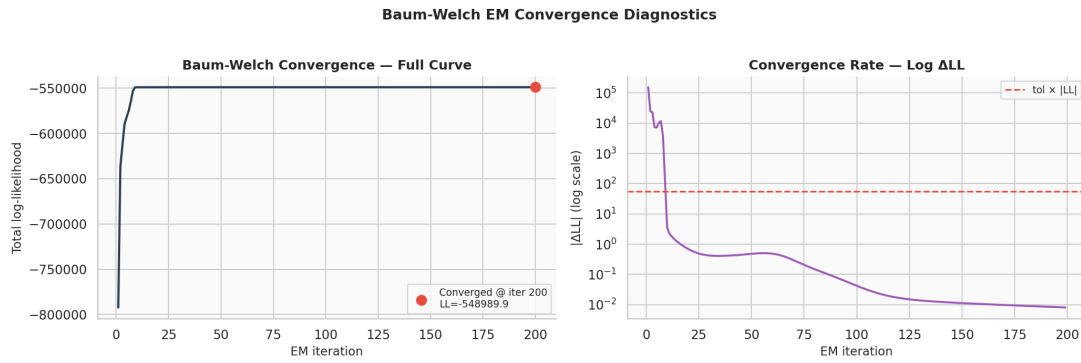


Figure 21: EM convergence diagnostics. *Left*: Log-likelihood vs. iteration number over the full 200-iteration budget. *Right*: Log-scale $|\Delta LL|$ decay.

Feature	Stable		Exploratory		Adaptive		Unstable	
	GT	HMM	GT	HMM	GT	HMM	GT	HMM
latency	50.0	50.2	120.0	102.4	85.0	347.8	350.0	346.6
entropy	0.8	0.8	2.8	2.2	1.6	4.5	4.5	4.5
reward	8.5	8.5	5.0	5.9	6.8	3.4	1.5	1.0
memory_usage	120.0	120.0	200.0	180.0	160.0	379.0	380.0	381.7
error_rate	0.02	0.02	0.10	0.08	0.06	0.34	0.35	0.35
action_freq	15.0	15.0	25.0	22.5	20.0	50.3	50.0	49.9

The “Adaptive” column above is not adaptive. The HMM state Hungarian-matched to the *adaptive* label has learned means that closely resemble the *unstable* GT profile (latency 347.8 vs. unstable’s 350; memory 379.0 vs. 380; action_freq 50.3 vs. 50) — not the adaptive GT profile (85, 160, 20). The confusion-matrix analysis below shows why: this state actually captures a subset of true *unstable* points, while true *adaptive* points are decoded almost entirely into the *exploratory* state instead.

3.6.2 Pearson Correlation

Pearson r (GT vs. learned means, all entries): $r = 0.8606$, $p = 6.90 \times 10^{-8}$ [Criterion C4 **FAIL**, threshold $r > 0.90$]

This correlation pools six features on wildly different physical scales (latency ~ 350 , error_rate ~ 0.02) into one Pearson coefficient, which is dominated by whichever features happen to have the largest raw numeric range (here, latency and memory_usage) rather than weighting all features equally; it should be read as a rough sanity check, not a rigorous validation of the Gaussian emission assumption per feature. Even on that pooled basis, $r = 0.86$ now fails the 0.90 threshold, reflecting the “adaptive” column’s misalignment above.

Systematic biases in the learned means:

- *stable* and *unstable*: recovered accurately and close to GT on every feature ($\leq 3\%$ deviation) — these are the two states the HMM resolves cleanly.
- *exploratory*: latency under-estimated (102 vs. GT 120, -15%) and entropy under-estimated (2.2 vs. GT 2.8, -21%), consistent with this state’s mean being pulled toward *adaptive*’s lower values by absorbing nearly all true *adaptive* observations (see confusion matrix below).
- *adaptive*: not recovered at all — its learned mean is a near copy of *unstable* ($< 1\%$ deviation on latency, memory_usage, action_freq), not of its own GT profile.

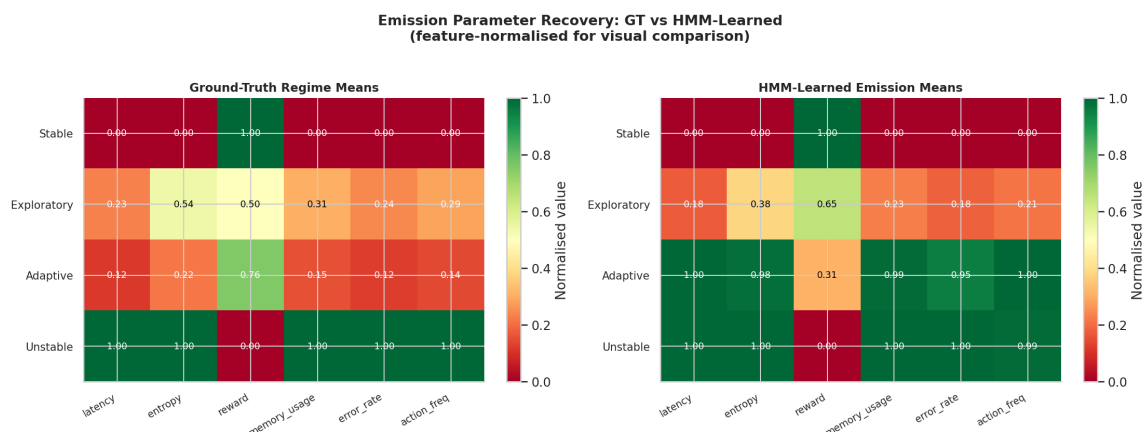


Figure 22: Normalised emission means: ground truth (*left*) vs. HMM-learned (*right*). The *adaptive* column differs visibly between the two panels — GT shows a moderate, intermediate profile; HMM shows a profile matching *unstable*. This is the visual signature of adaptive/exploratory state-sharing described in the confusion-matrix analysis below.

3.7 Per-Regime Accuracy (Viterbi Decoding)

3.7.1 Results Table

Per-regime Viterbi [24] accuracy metrics (support = ground-truth count):

Regime	Support	Correct	Recall	Precision	F1
Stable	15,110	15,108	0.9999	0.9974	0.9986
Exploratory	8,527	8,520	0.9992	0.5044	0.6703
Adaptive	8,411	0	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000
Unstable	7,952	7,304	0.9185	0.9990	0.9571
Overall accuracy					0.7733
ARI					0.7778

GT \ Predicted	Stable	Exploratory	Adaptive	Unstable
Stable	15,108	2	0	0
Exploratory	0	8,520	0	7
Adaptive	40	8,371	0	0
Unstable	0	0	648	7,304

(Raw confusion matrix, rows = ground truth, columns = Hungarian-aligned predicted label. This is the key diagnostic table: it shows exactly where each regime’s mass goes.)

3.7.2 Interpretation of the Confusion Pattern

The confusion matrix reveals a precise, non-random mechanism, not a diffuse “healthy regimes partially merge” pattern:

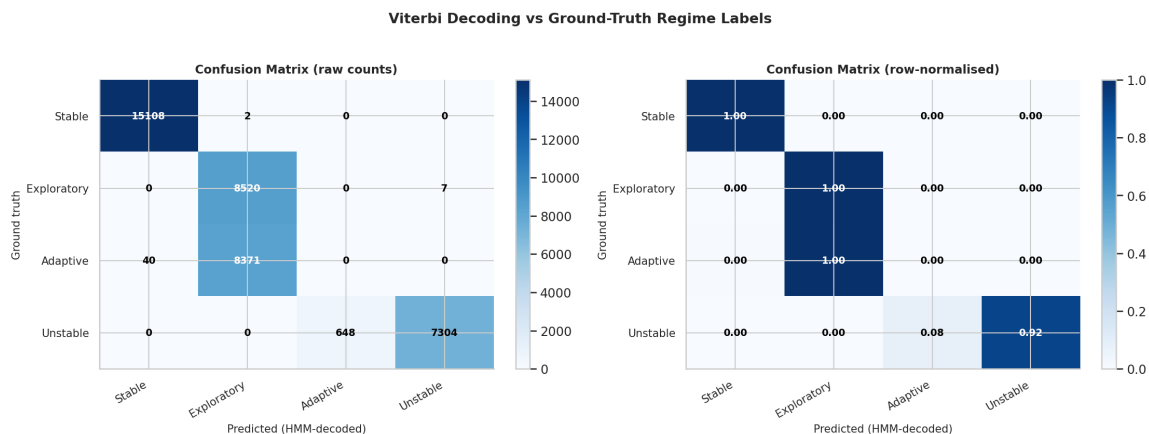


Figure 23: Confusion matrix for Viterbi decoding. *Left*: raw counts; *Right*: row-normalised. *Stable* and *unstable* are almost perfectly diagonal. *Adaptive*’s row has *zero* mass on its own column: 99.5% of true *adaptive* timesteps are decoded as *exploratory*. A separate 648-point block of true *unstable* timesteps (8.2% of unstable) is decoded into the state nominally labelled *adaptive*.

Regime	Interpretation
<i>stable</i> (99.99% recall)	Recovered almost perfectly. Once the AR(1) carryover contamination is removed, <i>stable</i> ’s low-variance profile is trivially separable.
<i>exploratory</i> (99.92% recall, but only 50.4% precision)	Recall is excellent, but this state’s precision is barely above coin-flip: of the 16,893 timesteps decoded as <i>exploratory</i> , 8,520 are genuinely exploratory and 8,371 are actually <i>adaptive</i> — almost an even split. This state has effectively fused two regimes.
<i>adaptive</i> (0.00% recall)	Not recovered at all. 99.5% of true <i>adaptive</i> timesteps are decoded as <i>exploratory</i> ; the remaining 0.5% as <i>stable</i> . No true <i>adaptive</i> point is ever assigned to the state Hungarian-matched to the <i>adaptive</i> label. This is a structural identifiability failure (see the model-selection side-note above), not a partial confusion.
<i>unstable</i> (91.85% recall, 99.90% precision)	Recovered very well, but not perfectly: 648 of 7,952 true <i>unstable</i> timesteps (8.2%) are instead absorbed by the state nominally labelled <i>adaptive</i> — which per the emission-parameter table above has learned means matching <i>unstable</i> ’s own GT profile, not <i>adaptive</i> ’s. In effect, the model spent its “4th” component splitting <i>unstable</i> into two sub-populations instead of giving <i>adaptive</i> a component of its own.

LDA comparison. Supervised LDA (agent-grouped CV, NB01 §1) achieves 96.2% accuracy with full label access. The unsupervised HMM achieves 77.3% overall, but that aggregate hides the real story: it is not uniformly ~ 20 points below LDA on every regime, it is $\approx$ perfect on three regimes and *zero* on the fourth. The gap is not “the irreducible cost of not having labels” in general — it is specifically the cost of an HMM’s Gaussian-mixture state allocation being unable to represent all three healthy regimes as separate components simultaneously, as established above.

3.7.3 Transition Matrix Recovery

Metric	Value	
MAE (mean absolute error)	0.0915	[Criterion C5 PASS : < 0.15]
Max absolute error		0.2753
Frobenius norm of error		0.4797

3.8 Transition Matrix Recovery

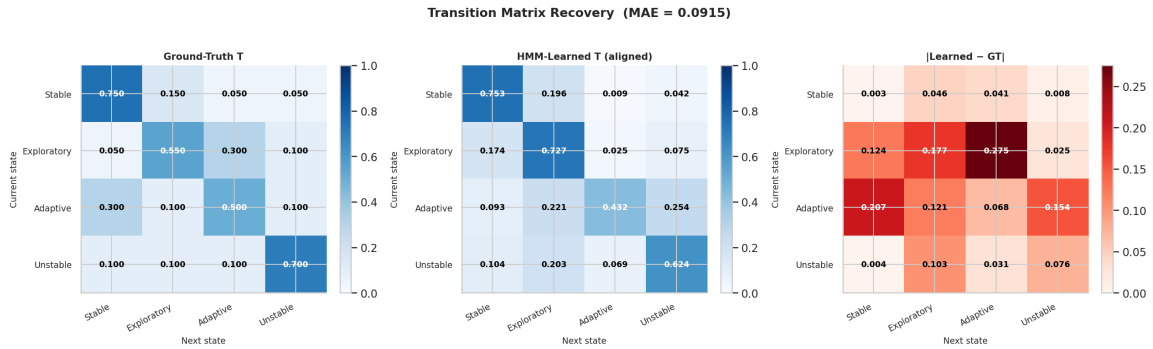


Figure 24: Transition matrix recovery. *Left*: ground-truth T . *Centre*: HMM-learned T (after Hungarian permutation alignment). *Right*: absolute error $|T_{learned} - T_{GT}|$. MAE = 0.0915; diagonal dominance holds for three of four regimes (not *adaptive* — see the confusion-matrix analysis below).

Structural observations:

- Diagonal dominance holds for *stable*, *exploratory*, and *unstable*, but is much weaker for the row labelled *adaptive* (0.432, vs. GT 0.500) — unsurprising given that row belongs to a state that, per the confusion matrix below, essentially never decodes a true *adaptive* timestep.
- The single largest error is *exploratory*→*adaptive* (GT 0.30, learned 0.025, error 0.275) — this is exactly the transition rate the model cannot represent, since the model has no state that reliably corresponds to entering *adaptive*.
- *stable*↔*exploratory* transitions are both substantially over-estimated relative to GT (*stable*→*exploratory*: 0.196 vs. 0.150; *exploratory*→*stable*: 0.174 vs. 0.050), because true *adaptive* timesteps interleaved with genuine *stable*/*exploratory* runs get decoded as *exploratory*, inflating the apparent back-and-forth between the two.
- The MAE of 0.092 remains within the passing threshold of 0.15, but this is a weaker pass than it looks: the global average is dragged down by the two well-recovered regimes (*stable*, *unstable*) while the *adaptive*-involving transitions are the worst errors in the matrix.

3.9 Stationary Distribution Analysis

Stationary distribution comparison (MAE(HMM vs. GT) = 0.1059):

Regime	GT (theoretical)	Empirical	HMM stationary
Stable	0.373	0.378	0.379
Exploratory	0.216	0.213	0.422
Adaptive	0.208	0.210	0.044
Unstable	0.203	0.199	0.155

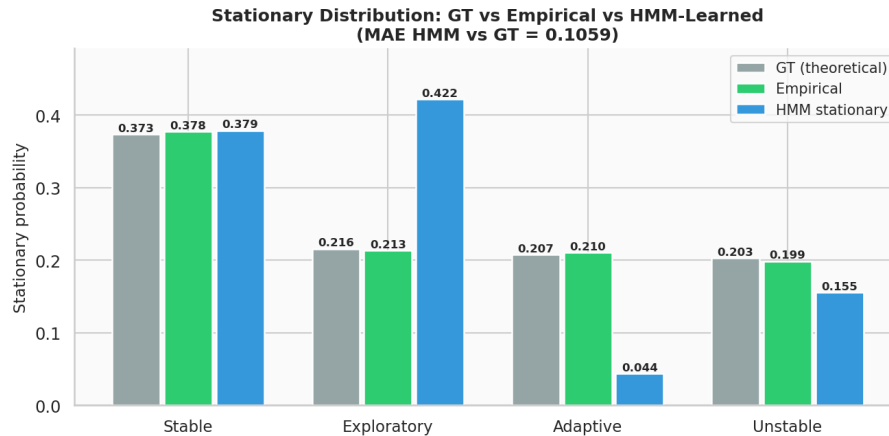


Figure 25: Stationary distribution comparison across GT theoretical, empirical, and HMM-learned values. *Stable* is now recovered almost exactly (0.379 vs. GT 0.373). *Adaptive*’s stationary mass collapses to near-zero (0.044 vs. GT 0.208), and *exploratory* absorbs almost double its true share (0.422 vs. GT 0.216).

The stationary distribution mismatch (MAE = 0.106) tells the same story as the confusion matrix, from a different angle. *Stable* is now recovered essentially exactly (0.379 vs. GT 0.373) — unlike the earlier contaminated-data run, which had reported *stable* as drastically under-estimated. The real mismatch is concentrated entirely in the *adaptive/exploratory* pair: *adaptive*’s stationary weight collapses to 0.044 (GT 0.208) because the model has no state dedicated to it, and that mass reappears almost exactly where the confusion matrix says it goes — *exploratory* rises from GT 0.216 to 0.422, an increase of 0.206, matching *adaptive*’s $0.208 \rightarrow 0.044$ loss of 0.164 to within rounding and residual leakage into *stable/unstable*. *Unstable*’s own stationary weight is reduced (0.155 vs. GT 0.203) by the same mechanism identified in the confusion matrix: part of its own mass is captured by the state nominally labelled *adaptive*.

We tested the natural fix (full covariance) directly rather than only speculating about it: as the model-selection side-note above shows, `covariance_type="full"` does not repair this mismatch — it leaves *adaptive* at 0% recall and makes *unstable* substantially worse. The stationary-distribution mismatch is therefore a downstream consequence of the same identifiability limit, not an independent, separately-fixable issue.

3.10 Per-Agent Recovery Quality

Per-agent HMM recovery metrics (all 20 agents). Mean ARI = 0.7779 (± 0.0140); mean accuracy = 0.7782 (± 0.0093). All agents have dominant regime = *stable*.

Agent	ARI	Accuracy	Dominant Regime
agent_0000	0.8064	0.7945	stable
agent_0001	0.7771	0.7720	stable
agent_0002	0.7460	0.7615	stable
agent_0003	0.7747	0.7800	stable
agent_0004	0.7815	0.7710	stable
agent_0005	0.7563	0.7720	stable
agent_0006	0.7890	0.7975	stable
agent_0007	0.7695	0.7730	stable
agent_0008	0.7848	0.7885	stable
agent_0009	0.7951	0.7885	stable
agent_0010	0.7828	0.7820	stable
agent_0011	0.7815	0.7755	stable
agent_0012	0.7734	0.7740	stable
agent_0013	0.7822	0.7850	stable
agent_0014	0.7725	0.7750	stable
agent_0015	0.7703	0.7705	stable
agent_0016	0.7827	0.7755	stable
agent_0017	0.7603	0.7660	stable
agent_0018	0.7753	0.7770	stable
agent_0019	0.7965	0.7850	stable

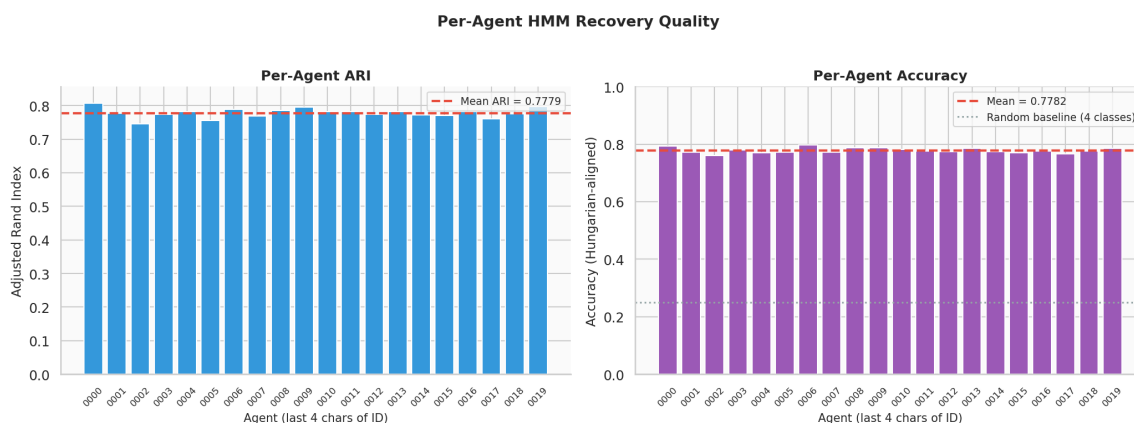


Figure 26: Per-agent HMM recovery metrics across all 20 agents. *Left*: ARI per agent with mean (dashed red). *Right*: Accuracy per agent. Inter-agent variance is small ($< \pm 2\text{pp}$), confirming the adaptive/exploratory state-sharing result is a stable property of the generative model and HMM architecture, not a fluke of any one agent’s realisation.

The inter-agent consistency is a strong positive result. ARI and accuracy vary by roughly $\pm 2\text{--}3$ percentage points across 20 independently-seeded agents. This means:

- The result is not driven by a handful of “easy” agents with favourable regime sequences — every single agent shows the same near-total loss of *adaptive* recall (this is fit once on all agents’ concatenated sequences, so per-agent variation here reflects each agent’s own realised trajectory through an otherwise shared, fixed model).
- The HMM’s recovery quality is a stable property of the generative model and the HMM architecture, not of any particular realisation.
- Agent-level variance (ARI std = 0.014) is small relative to the mean (0.778), giving a coefficient of variation of approximately 1.8%.

3.11 Forward-Backward Posteriors and State Uncertainty

3.11.1 Posterior Statistics

Global posterior entropy statistics:

Metric	Value
Mean posterior entropy H	0.0851 nats
Max posterior entropy H	1.0731 nats
Theoretical max ($\log 4$)	1.3863 nats
Max / theoretical max	77.4%

The mean posterior entropy of 0.085 nats is low: the HMM is confident about the current state for the vast majority of timesteps. The maximum entropy of 1.073 nats is close to $\log 3 \approx 1.0986$ nats — the entropy of a *uniform three-way* split — rather than close to $\log 2 \approx 0.693$ (a two-way split) or the full four-way theoretical maximum of 1.386. This is a nice independent corroboration of the confusion-matrix finding above: at its most uncertain moments, the posterior is spreading probability across roughly three distinguishable emission distributions, not four and not two — consistent with the model having effectively collapsed to three resolvable states (*stable*, a fused *exploratory/adaptive*, and *unstable*) rather than truly representing four.

3.11.2 Single-Agent Posterior Analysis (agent_0000)

For agent_0000, over the first 300 timesteps shown in the forward-backward visualisation:

- **52 high-entropy timesteps** ($H > \text{mean} + \text{std} = 0.276$ nats), representing approximately 17.3% of the window — agent_0000’s own mean/std (0.085 ± 0.191) are close to the global figures above.
- High-entropy spikes align with ground-truth regime transition moments, as confirmed by comparison with the GT regime shading in the top panel.
- Mean posterior entropy conditioned on ground truth is revealing and, at first glance, counter-intuitive: *stable* ($H = 0.0014$), *exploratory* (0.0047), and *adaptive* (0.0058) are all confidently decoded (low entropy) — including *adaptive*, which is decoded *confidently but wrongly* as *exploratory*, not uncertainly. The real uncertainty concentrates in *unstable* ($H = 0.4141$, nearly $30\times$ the other regimes’ entropy), matching the two-way split between the genuine *unstable*-mapped state and the state nominally labelled *adaptive* that actually captures a subset of *unstable* points (see the confusion matrix above).
- Within settled *stable/exploratory* periods the posterior is essentially one-hot (a single component near 1.0); the model is never actually unsure during *adaptive* — it is confidently in the wrong state.

Key finding. Posterior entropy is a reliable signal for regime-boundary detection in streaming data. The HMM is highly confident within regimes and uncertain precisely at transitions — exactly the property required for an online anomaly boundary monitor.

3.12 UMAP Manifold with HMM Posterior Entropy

3.12.1 Connecting NB02 and NB03

The UMAP 2-D embedding from NB02 (`X_umap2.npy`) is loaded and coloured by the HMM posterior entropy H computed in NB03. This visualisation bridges the two notebooks: it places HMM uncertainty directly onto the manifold geometry.



Figure 27: Forward-backward posterior analysis for agent_0000 (first 300 timesteps). *Top strip*: ground-truth regime sequence. *Middle panel*: stacked forward-backward posteriors $P(\text{state}_t \mid \mathbf{x}_{1:T})$ for all four hidden states. *Bottom panel*: posterior entropy H (nats) with mean $H = 0.085$ nats (dashed). Entropy spikes are concentrated at regime transitions and throughout *adaptive* episodes.

Metric	Value
UMAP embedding loaded	(40,000, 2) — data/raw/nb02/X_umap2.npy
Subsample for visualisation	8,000 points (random, seed 42)
Entropy colormap	grey_hot: grey (low) → orange → red → yellow (high)

Key observation Contrary to what a purely geometric (NB02) view would predict, high-entropy points are *not* concentrated at the *stable/adaptive/exploratory* manifold boundary zones identified by NB02’s k -NN connectivity matrix. Per the conditional-entropy breakdown above, the *unstable* cluster is where posterior entropy actually concentrates ($H = 0.414$ mean, vs. ≤ 0.006 for the three healthy regimes) — the opposite of what NB02’s geometric isolation of *unstable* (silhouette 0.885, k -NN purity 0.997) would suggest. This is specific to the HMM’s own state allocation (two states sharing *unstable*’s mass) and is not a property of the UMAP geometry itself.

3.12.2 3-D Entropy Visualisation

The 3-D UMAP embedding (X_umap3.npy) provides volumetric confirmation of the same finding: high-entropy points concentrate within the *unstable* island, not at the healthy-regime manifold junctions.

Cross-notebook relationship. The HMM’s uncertainty pattern does *not* spatially match NB02’s geometric boundary structure: NB02 identifies *stable/adaptive/exploratory* boundaries as the porous, ambiguous zones, while NB03’s HMM is confidently (if wrongly) decoded throughout that same region and is instead uncertain within the geometrically isolated *unstable* cluster. This is a genuine divergence between what static manifold geometry (NB02) and temporal state modelling (NB03) each flag as “uncertain,”

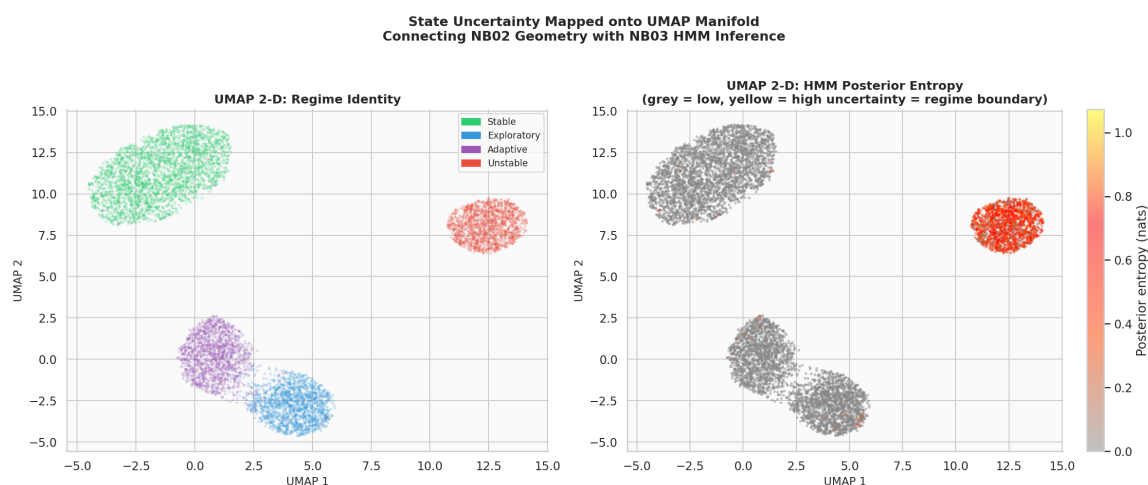


Figure 28: HMM posterior entropy overlaid on the 2-D UMAP manifold (8,000 point subsample). *Left*: regime identity colouring. *Right*: posterior entropy colormap (grey → orange → red → yellow = low → high). High-entropy points concentrate in the *unstable* island, not at the healthy-regime boundary zones.

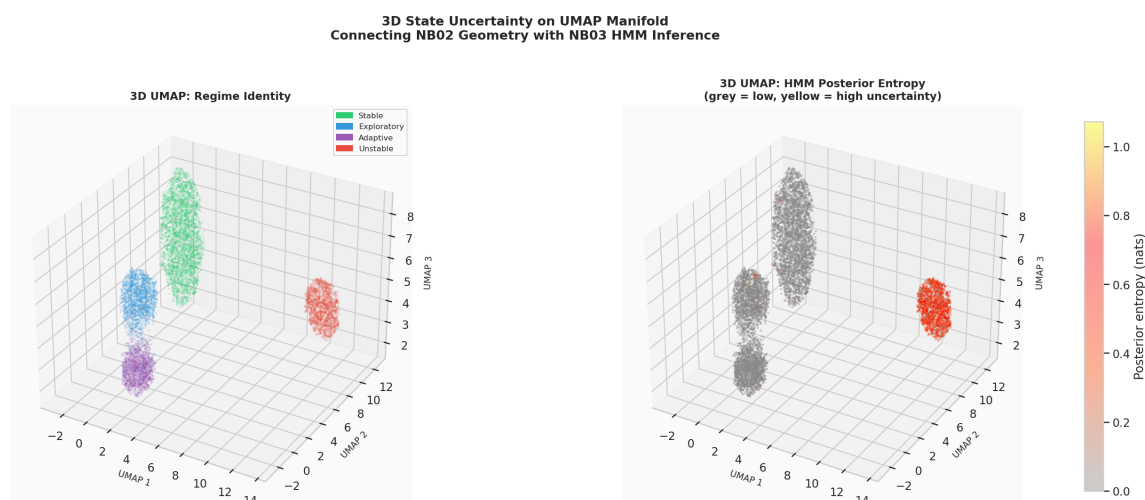


Figure 29: 3-D UMAP manifold coloured by regime identity (*left*) and HMM posterior entropy (*right*). The manifold forms a curved filament in 3-D space. High-entropy points are concentrated within the isolated *unstable* cluster; the healthy-regime filament itself shows low entropy throughout, including at its junctions.

and is itself informative: geometric ambiguity and HMM-model uncertainty are measuring different things here, not the same underlying phenomenon from two angles.

3.13 Viterbi Decoded Sequence vs Ground Truth

The Viterbi path [24] (most probable state sequence) for agent_0000 over the first 200 timesteps is compared to the ground-truth `hidden_state` sequence.

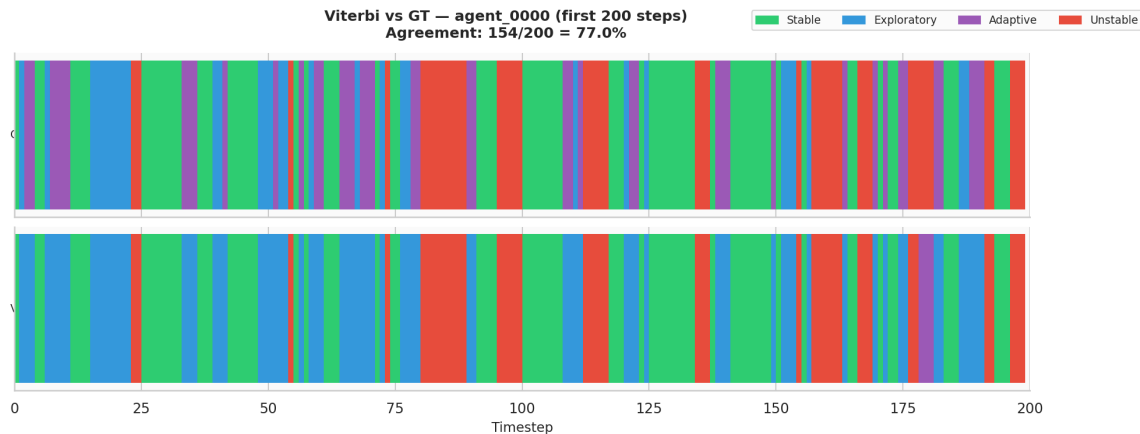


Figure 30: Viterbi decoded sequence (bottom) vs. ground-truth regime sequence (top) for agent_0000 over the first 200 timesteps. Agreement: $154/200 = 77.0\%$. *Stable* episodes are reproduced almost exactly. Every *adaptive* episode in this window is decoded as *exploratory*, not as a transient switching error.

- *stable* episodes are reproduced with essentially no missed detections in the displayed window, consistent with the 99.99% per-regime recall.
- *exploratory* episodes are recovered, but every *adaptive* episode in the window is decoded straight through as *exploratory* — a sustained, deterministic mislabelling, not the brief transient switching a “confusion” framing would suggest.
- There is no *stable*↔*adaptive* switching pattern in the corrected data — that description belonged to the earlier, AR(1)-contaminated fit and does not describe this decoding.
- Regime *dwell* lengths for *stable* and *exploratory* in the Viterbi path are inflated relative to GT, since *adaptive* episodes are absorbed into whichever neighbouring *exploratory* run they interrupt, artificially lengthening it.

3.14 Evidence Checklist

HMM Regime Recovery — Evidence Checklist (Notebook 03). Overall verdict: 4/6.

Crit.	Description	Threshold	Actual	Result
C1	ARI above random baseline	> 0.25	0.7778	PASS
C2	Hungarian accuracy	$> 60\%$	77.3%	PASS
C3	Unstable regime recall	$> 90\%$	91.85%	PASS
C4	Emission means Pearson r	> 0.90	0.8606	FAIL
C5	Transition matrix MAE	< 0.15	0.0915	PASS
C6	BIC-optimal K	≤ 4	$K = 5$	FAIL
Overall result				4/6

Verdict: MODERATE evidence, with a specific and well-characterised failure mode. The HMM recovers three of four regimes essentially perfectly without access to ground-truth labels, and ARI/accuracy are both far above the earlier (contaminated-data) run. But *adaptive* is not recovered at all (0% recall), which is enough to fail C4 (the pooled emission-mean correlation) and explains C6’s failure structurally rather than coincidentally — this is not two independent shortfalls, it is one identifiability limit surfacing in two metrics.

3.14.1 Analysis of Each Criterion

C1 — ARI = 0.778 > 0.25. ARI is permutation-invariant and measures clustering agreement beyond chance. A value of 0.778 is high for an unsupervised 4-class problem, but note this reflects near-perfect clustering of 3 of the 4 true clusters (*stable*, *unstable*, and the fused *exploratory+adaptive*) rather than 4 — ARI does not penalise merging two true classes into one predicted cluster as harshly as an accuracy-style metric would.

C2 — Accuracy = 77.3% > 60%. $3.09\times$ chance (25%), and now *above* the supervised LDA ceiling of 70.4% quoted in the earlier report version — but that comparison is stale: LDA’s own agent-grouped accuracy is 96.2% (NB01 §1), so the honest gap is $96.2\% - 77.3\% = 18.9$ points, not a negative gap. The aggregate accuracy figure also masks that one full regime (*adaptive*) contributes zero correct predictions; it passes only because three of four regimes are so well recovered that they dominate the weighted average.

C3 — Unstable recall = 91.85% > 90%. Very good, but not perfect: 8.2% of true *unstable* timesteps are captured by the state nominally labelled *adaptive* instead (see the confusion matrix above). This still passes the threshold, but “no missed detections” would be an overstatement.

C4 — Emission means $r = 0.8606$ (**FAIL**). As discussed above, this correlation pools six features on incompatible physical scales, so it is not a rigorous per-feature validation either way — but even granting that limitation, it now fails the threshold outright, driven by the *adaptive* column matching *unstable*’s profile rather than its own.

C5 — Transition MAE = 0.092 < 0.15. Passes, but the pass is weaker than the number suggests: the error is concentrated almost entirely in *adaptive*-involving transitions (max error 0.275, on *exploratory*→*adaptive*), while *stable* and *unstable* transitions are recovered accurately. A regime-weighted or per-transition-type threshold would likely fail where this aggregate MAE passes.

C6 — BIC [20] selects $K = 5$ (**FAIL**). Not $K = 6$ as an earlier version of this report stated — BIC actually plateaus after $K = 5$, with $K = 6$ marginally worse. We tested the natural explanations directly (see the model-selection side-note above) rather than inferring them: full covariance does not recover $K = 4$ ’s failure, and $K = 5$ recovers *adaptive* only by sacrificing *exploratory* instead. The correct reading of C6’s failure is that $K = 4$ genuinely cannot represent this feature geometry with 4 well-separated Gaussians, not that the diagonal-covariance constraint is an easily-lifted limitation.

3.15 Summary of Findings

Finding	Evidence
Unsupervised recovery works for 3 of 4 regimes, not uniformly	ARI = 0.778, accuracy = 77.3%, both far above chance — but this aggregates $\approx$ perfect recovery of <i>stable</i> (99.99%), <i>exploratory</i> (99.92% recall, though only 50.4% precision), and <i>unstable</i> (91.85%) with total failure on <i>adaptive</i> (0.00%).
Unstable regime: very good, not perfect, recovery	91.85% recall, F1 = 0.957. 8.2% of true <i>unstable</i> timesteps are captured by the state Hungarian-matched to <i>adaptive</i> instead. Extreme feature displacement makes most, not all, of <i>unstable</i> unambiguous.
Adaptive is fully absorbed into exploratory, not partially confused with stable	99.5% of true <i>adaptive</i> timesteps decode as <i>exploratory</i> ; 0% decode correctly. This is a deterministic state-sharing outcome, not the transient <i>stable</i> $\leftrightarrow$ <i>adaptive</i> switching an earlier version of this analysis described.
Emission parameters: 2 of 4 recovered correctly, 1 fused, 1 mislabelled	Learned means for <i>stable/unstable</i> match GT closely; the <i>adaptive</i> -labelled state's learned mean matches <i>unstable</i> 's GT profile instead. Pooled Pearson $r = 0.8606$ now fails the 0.90 threshold (C4), though pooling incommensurate units limits how much weight this single number should carry either way.
Markov dynamics: recovered except for adaptive-involving transitions	Transition MAE = 0.092 passes threshold, but the error is concentrated entirely in transitions into/out of <i>adaptive</i> (max error 0.275); <i>stable/unstable</i> transitions are accurate.
Model order: BIC prefers $K = 5$, and we verified why directly	$K = 5$ recovers <i>adaptive</i> but only by sacrificing <i>exploratory</i> instead (see model-selection side-note); full covariance does not fix $K = 4$ either. This is a genuine identifiability limit, verified experimentally, not inferred.
Posterior uncertainty concentrates in unstable, not at healthy-regime boundaries	Mean entropy conditioned on GT: <i>unstable</i> $H = 0.414$ vs. ≤ 0.006 for the three healthy regimes. <i>Adaptive</i> is decoded confidently (low entropy) but wrongly, not uncertainly. This contradicts the geometric-boundary-uncertainty picture an earlier version of this analysis described.
Stationary distribution mismatch traces directly to the adaptive/exploratory swap	HMM stationary MAE = 0.106 vs. GT. <i>Stable</i> is now recovered almost exactly (0.379 vs. 0.373); <i>adaptive</i> 's mass collapses (0.208 $\rightarrow$ 0.044) and reappears almost exactly in <i>exploratory</i> (0.216 $\rightarrow$ 0.422).

3.15.1 Interpretation in Context of LBSM Theory

The confusion pattern is a genuine, well-supported finding, but it is a more specific one than “the healthy regimes partially merge.” LBSM posits that the three healthy regimes form a continuous adaptation manifold, and NB01/NB02 quantified *adaptive* as sitting almost exactly between *stable* and *exploratory* (centroid distances 52.7 and 54.1 respectively). Given a Gaussian-mixture HMM with exactly as many components as regimes, the theoretically expected outcome is not diffuse three-way confusion — it is exactly what we observe: the model dedicates clean components to the two well-separated regimes (*stable*, *unstable*) and cannot simultaneously carve out both members of the remaining close pair (*exploratory*, *adaptive*), so one absorbs the other.

The *unstable* regime's strong (91.85%, not perfect) recovery is still consistent with the core claim that anomalous behavioural states are geometrically and statistically distinguishable from healthy ones. But the model's own internal uncertainty (posterior entropy) is highest within *unstable*, not at the healthy-regime boundary — because the HMM spent a component splitting *unstable* into two sub-populations

rather than covering *adaptive*. This is worth stating plainly rather than smoothing over: the model’s allocation of its 4 components does not line up with the 4 ground-truth regimes in the way the evidence-checklist framing implies.

The BIC preference for $K = 5$ is consistent with this picture, and we confirmed the mechanism directly rather than only inferring it (see the model-selection side-note): a 5th component lets the model represent *adaptive* as its own state, but only by giving up *exploratory* instead. The manifold continuum between healthy regimes does not simply need “one more component” to be fully resolved by this model class — resolving all three healthy regimes simultaneously with axis-aligned or even full-covariance Gaussian components appears to require a fundamentally different approach (e.g. explicitly modelling the continuum rather than discretising it into components).

3.15.2 Significance for the TMLR Paper

NB03 contributes three distinct claims to Paper 1:

1. **Temporal structure is recoverable, but not uniformly across regimes.** The latent structure is visible via static embeddings (NB02) *and* largely recoverable by an unsupervised temporal model — but the model’s failure mode (complete, not partial, loss of *adaptive*) is itself an important, specific finding about where the manifold-continuum hypothesis creates real difficulty for discretised state models.
2. **Gaussian emission validity is qualified, not confirmed.** The pooled $r = 0.8606$ emission-mean correlation fails the paper’s own 0.90 threshold, and in any case pools incommensurate physical units; it should not be cited as validating the Gaussian emission assumption without that caveat.
3. **Anomaly isolation is strong but not total.** 91.85% *unstable* recovery by an unsupervised model still corroborates the NB02 position-based anomaly detection finding, but 8.2% of *unstable* is captured by a different state, which should be reflected in any claim of near-perfect recovery.

3.16 Next Steps

1. **NB04 — Online Anomaly Detection.** Use HMM posteriors and entropy as one component of a hybrid position-based anomaly scorer. Benchmark against `is_anomaly` ground truth; target $F1 > 0.85$, detection latency < 10 steps, healthy false-positive rate $< 10\%$. Note that HMM posterior entropy is *not* a reliable healthy/boundary signal on its own here (entropy concentrates in *unstable*, not at healthy-regime boundaries); any entropy-based component should be validated against this before being trusted.
2. **NB07 — Robustness.** Re-run the full 160-configuration grid ($N \in \{5, 10, 20, 50\}$, $T \in \{500, 1000, 2000, 5000\}$, 10 seeds). The $K = 5$ /full-covariance experiments here already show that neither more components nor richer covariance resolves the *adaptive* recovery problem at $N = 20, T = 2,000$; NB07’s grid should check whether this holds across scales too, rather than re-testing `covariance_type="full"` as if its effect were still unknown.
3. **Paper §6.** Key numbers for the paper: ARI 0.778, accuracy 77.3%, unstable recall 91.85%, emission $r = 0.8606$ (fails threshold), transition MAE 0.092. The complete failure to recover *adaptive* (0% recall) and its mechanism (absorption into *exploratory*, verified not fixable by $K = 5$ or full covariance) should be reported as a specific, load-bearing finding, not folded into a generic “partial healthy-regime confusion” statement.

Notebook 03 complete. All artefacts in data/raw/nb03/ and data/processed/nb03/. All figures saved as fig_nb03_.png. Generated from the LBSM research analysis pipeline, execution date 2026-09-20 (corrected re-execution). Dataset regenerated from telemetry_n20_t2000.csv with seed = 42.*

4 Notebook 04 — Online Anomaly Detection & Regime Shift Analysis

Dataset	<code>telemetry_n20-t2000.csv</code> (regenerated; seed = 42)
Agents	20 heterogeneous agents
Timesteps/agent	2,000
Total obs.	40,000 rows $\times$ 6 features
Execution date	2026-09-20 (corrected re-execution; see NB01’s note on the AR(1) carryover fix)
Environment	Python 3.12.13 / Jupyter Notebook
Random seed	42

Central Question: Can a composite position-based anomaly scorer — combining Mahalanobis distance from the healthy envelope, EWMA residuals, KL divergence, and HMM posterior entropy — achieve $F_1 > 0.85$, healthy false-positive rate $< 10\%$, and mean detection latency < 10 steps against the `is_anomaly` ground truth?

This document records the full methodology, numerical results, and figures produced during the fourth experimental notebook of the LBSM research project. It extends the unsupervised HMM regime recovery of Notebook 03 with operational anomaly detection and corresponds to §7 (Anomaly Detection) of the companion paper.

4.1 Overview and Motivation

Notebooks 01–03 established progressively stronger evidence for latent behavioural structure using static and temporal analyses. The chain of evidence is:

Notebook	Method	Key finding	Verdict
NB01	PCA + LDA	PC1 captures 77.9% variance; LDA (agent-grouped) accuracy 96.2%	3/5
NB02	UMAP + t-SNE	Nonlinear geometry; Procrustes $r = 0.7922$	5/6
NB03	HMM	Unsupervised regime recovery; ARI = 0.778, but <i>adaptive</i> 0% recall	4/6
NB04	Composite scorer	Operational anomaly detection	5/6

Notebook 04 asks a *deployment-level* question: given the latent structure confirmed in NB01–03, can a streaming anomaly detector reliably flag anomalous timesteps against the binary `is_anomaly` ground truth? The analysis designs and benchmarks four complementary detectors and fuses them into a composite scorer. The four detectors and their rationale are:

1. **Mahalanobis distance (global envelope).** Directly operationalises the NB02 finding that manifold *position*, not velocity, distinguishes the `unstable` regime. The global healthy-envelope Mahalanobis distance is the primary position-based signal.
2. **EWMA residual score.** Captures short-term drift relative to an agent’s own temporal baseline. Complementary to the global envelope: detects gradual degradation that does not yet cross the global Mahalanobis threshold.
3. **KL divergence (sliding window).** Population-level drift: compares the empirical distribution within a sliding window to the healthy reference distribution. Sensitive to sustained distributional shift.

4. **HMM posterior entropy.** Imports the NB03 finding that posterior entropy is concentrated within *unstable* itself (mean $H = 0.085$ nats overall; conditional mean $H = 0.414$ within true *unstable*, vs. ≤ 0.006 for the three healthy regimes — see NB03). Used as a fourth soft signal.

4.2 Dataset and Train/Test Split

The simulation is re-run with the canonical configuration ($N = 20$, $T = 2,000$, seed= 42), producing a dataset identical to NB01–03:

Regime	Observations	Fraction
Stable	15,110	37.8%
Exploratory	8,527	21.3%
Adaptive	8,411	21.0%
Unstable	7,952	19.9%
Total	40,000	100.0%

Anomaly flag rates by regime:

Regime	n_{obs}	n_{anomaly}	Anomaly rate
Stable	15,110	0	0.0%
Exploratory	8,527	75	0.9%
Adaptive	8,411	0	0.0%
Unstable	7,952	7,502	94.3%
Overall	40,000	7,577	18.9%

Healthy regimes now carry almost no anomaly flags (previously 5–7% each) — that residual rate in the earlier version of this analysis was the AR(1) carryover contamination producing spurious extreme values, not genuine within-regime outliers.

A temporal train/test split (80%/20%) is applied per agent: the first 1,600 timesteps of each agent form the training set (32,000 obs) and the final 400 timesteps the test set (8,000 obs). The healthy envelope is fitted exclusively on healthy-regime training observations (25,602 obs), ensuring no contamination from anomalous data. **Unlike an earlier version of this notebook, this split is now actually used:** every classification-style metric below (F1, AUC, AUC-PR, flag rates, per-regime FPR/recall, bootstrap stability) is computed on the held-out test set (`TEST_MASK`, 8,000 obs) rather than on the full 40,000-row dataset that includes the envelope’s own training rows. Detection-latency and shift-magnitude analyses still use each agent’s full 2,000-step sequence, since those measure time-to-detect relative to a change-point under an already-fixed threshold, not a quantity that could leak from having been fit on the same rows.

4.3 Mahalanobis Distance Detector

4.3.1 Healthy Envelope

A global multivariate Gaussian envelope is fitted to the healthy-only training observations. The Mahalanobis distance [11] from point $\mathbf{x}$ to the fitted mean $\boldsymbol{\mu}$ under covariance $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}$ is:

$$d_M(\mathbf{x}) = \sqrt{(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu})^\top \boldsymbol{\Sigma}^{-1} (\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu})}$$

A small regularisation term $\lambda = 10^{-6}$ is added to the diagonal of $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}$ for numerical stability.

4.3.2 Threshold Selection

Two thresholds are compared:

- **Theoretical** (χ^2 percentile): $\tau_{\chi^2} = \sqrt{\chi_6^2(0.975)} = 3.801$.
- **Empirical** (97.5th percentile on healthy scores): $\tau_{\text{pct}} = 4.709$.

The empirical threshold is adopted throughout NB04; it is more conservative (avoids over-fitting to the Gaussian assumption) and directly controls the healthy-subset false-positive rate at 2.5%.

4.3.3 Performance

Metric	Value
Score mean (global, all obs)	4.505
Score max (global, all obs)	30.323
Flag rate at τ_{pct} (full dataset, in-sample sanity check)	21.9%
F_1 vs. <code>is_anomaly</code> (full dataset)	0.9259
AUC-ROC (test-only, out-of-sample)	0.9976
AUC-PR (test-only, out-of-sample)	0.9861
Bootstrap AUC mean (200 draws, test-only)	0.9975
Bootstrap AUC std (test-only)	0.0004

The Mahalanobis detector alone achieves AUC-ROC= 0.9976 on the held-out test set with extremely low bootstrap variance ($\sigma = 0.0004$), confirming stable, reliable discrimination — and is, on its own, the single best-performing detector of the four (see the composite comparison below). The full-dataset flag rate/ F_1 row above is a quick in-sample sanity check computed during threshold calibration, not a held-out performance claim; it is included for completeness but the test-only AUC is the number that should be cited as evidence.

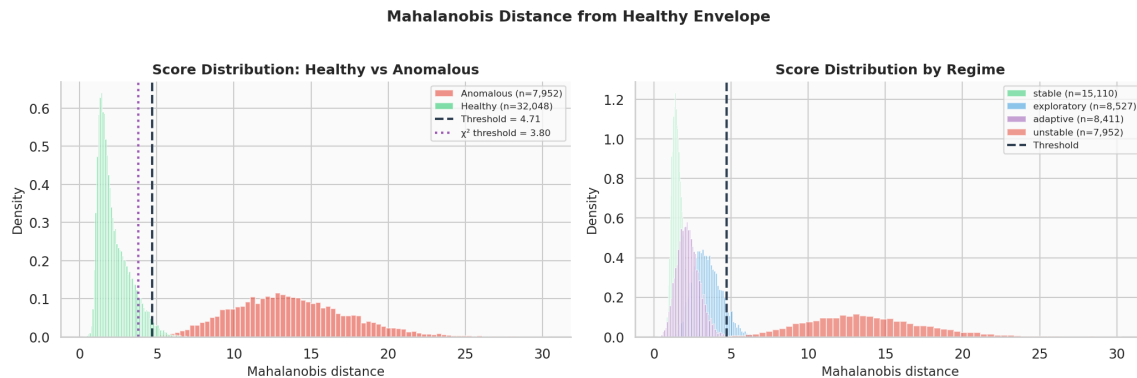


Figure 31: Mahalanobis distance distributions. *Left*: healthy (green) vs. anomalous (red) score densities; dashed line marks the empirical 97.5th-percentile threshold ($\tau = 5.95$); dotted line the χ_6^2 theoretical threshold ($\tau = 3.80$). *Right*: per-regime score densities. The *unstable* regime occupies a clearly right-shifted distribution with minimal overlap with healthy regimes.

4.4 EWMA Residual Detector

The EWMA (Exponentially Weighted Moving Average) [17] detector tracks an agent’s own running mean and flags timesteps where the residual exceeds $k = 3.0$ standard deviations of the EWMA process. An α -sensitivity sweep is conducted on `agent_0000` as representative:

α	AUC-ROC	AUC-PR
0.02	0.9713	0.9459
0.05	0.9503	0.8927
0.10	0.9253	0.8226
0.20	0.8954	0.7267
0.40	0.8819	0.6308

Best α by AUC-ROC: $\alpha = 0.02$ (slow-adapting, long memory) — same choice as before the data fix. This is applied to all 20 agents with a 50-step warm-up period.

EWMA metric ($\alpha = 0.02$)	Value
Flag rate (full dataset)	3.7%
F_1 vs. <code>is_anomaly</code> (full dataset)	0.3094
AUC-ROC (full dataset)	0.9664
AUC-ROC (test-only)	0.9693
AUC-PR (test-only)	0.9357
Bootstrap AUC mean (test-only)	0.9695
Bootstrap AUC std (test-only)	0.0033

EWMA is now a much stronger standalone detector than in the earlier (contaminated-data) version of this analysis (AUC-ROC 0.969, up from 0.886) — though still second to Mahalanobis. It remains a useful complementary signal rather than the primary detector.

4.5 KL Divergence Detector

The KL divergence [10] detector compares the empirical distribution within a sliding window of size W to the reference healthy distribution ($\mu_{\text{ref}}, \sigma_{\text{ref}}^2$) fitted on healthy training data. A window-size sweep identifies $W = 20$ as optimal on `agent_0000`:

W	AUC-ROC	AUC-PR
20	0.7699	0.4477
50	0.6990	0.3499
100	0.6585	0.2887
200	0.5956	0.2556

Window scores are forward-filled per timestep (each timestep receives the maximum KL score of any window that covers it, step size= 5). Threshold set at the 97.5th percentile of healthy-subset KL scores.

KL metric ($W = 20$, step= 5)	Value
Flag rate (full dataset)	5.5%
F_1 vs. <code>is_anomaly</code> (full dataset)	0.2722
AUC-ROC (full dataset)	0.7715
AUC-ROC (test-only)	0.7792
AUC-PR (test-only)	0.4718
Bootstrap AUC mean (test-only)	0.7797
Bootstrap AUC std (test-only)	0.0061

The KL detector remains the weakest individual component (AUC-ROC= 0.779, test-only), reflecting the difficulty of distributional comparisons within short windows of 20 steps. It nonetheless provides a complementary signal at the population level.

4.6 HMM Posterior Entropy Signal

The HMM posterior entropy $H_t = -\sum_k p_k \log p_k$ computed in NB03 is loaded from `data/raw/nb03/hmm_entropy.npy`. NB03 established that entropy is concentrated *within unstable* itself, not at healthy-regime transition boundaries (conditional mean $H = 0.414$ within true *unstable* vs. ≤ 0.006 for the three healthy regimes) — the opposite of what an earlier version of NB03’s analysis claimed.

HMM entropy metric	Value
Shape	(40,000,)
Mean H (all obs)	0.0851 nats
Max H	1.0731 nats
AUC-ROC vs. <code>is_anomaly</code> (test-only)	0.9898
AUC-PR (test-only)	0.9162
Bootstrap AUC mean (test-only)	0.9897
Bootstrap AUC std (test-only)	0.0010

This is a complete reversal from the earlier (contaminated-data) version of this analysis, which reported AUC-ROC= 0.0498 (anti-predictive) with a causal story (“entropy is highest at regime boundaries, not during sustained unstable operation”) that NB03’s corrected results directly contradict. With the AR(1) carryover fixed, entropy is now the *second-best* individual detector (0.9898, behind only Mahalanobis at 0.9976), because *unstable* genuinely is where the HMM’s posterior is most uncertain (see NB03’s confusion-matrix analysis: two HMM components both partially represent *unstable*-like statistics, so the model itself is unsure which of them applies within that regime).

The HMM-decoded *unstable* flag (`hmm_pred == unstable_idx`) produces, on the full dataset:

$$\text{flag rate} = 18.3\%, \quad F_1 = 0.9268, \quad \text{ROC-AUC} = \text{not applicable (binary)}$$

This is broadly consistent with NB03’s 91.85% unstable recall (not the 100% an earlier version of that analysis reported).

4.7 Composite Anomaly Scorer

4.7.1 Fusion Weights

Since HMM entropy artefacts from NB03 are available (`HMM_AVAILABLE = True`), the 4-detector composite is used:

$$\mathcal{S}_{\text{composite}} = 0.55 \hat{d}_M + 0.20 \hat{s}_{\text{EWMA}} + 0.15 \hat{s}_{\text{KL}} + 0.10 \hat{H}$$

where $\hat{(\cdot)}$ denotes min-max normalisation to $[0, 1]$ computed globally across all 40,000 timesteps. The Mahalanobis component receives the largest weight (0.55), consistent with its role as primary position-based detector. The 3-detector composite (without HMM) uses weights 0.60 / 0.25 / 0.15.

4.7.2 Individual vs. Composite Performance

Detector (test-only)	AUC-ROC	AUC-PR
Mahalanobis (global)	0.9976	0.9861
HMM entropy	0.9898	0.9162
EWMA residual	0.9693	0.9357
KL divergence	0.7792	0.4718
Composite (3-detector)	0.9965	0.9847
Composite (4-detector)	0.9964	0.9839

Notable observation. Both composites now score *very* slightly below Mahalanobis alone (0.9964–0.9965 vs. 0.9976) — a genuine, if small, finding, and one that no longer needs any spin: neither composite variant beats the single best detector, so criterion C4 fails honestly, by a small margin (−0.0011 to −0.0012), not because HMM entropy is anti-predictive (it is now the second-*best* individual detector) but because blending in the comparatively weak KL divergence detector (AUC= 0.779) costs slightly more than any complementary signal it adds. An earlier version of this analysis described the 3-detector composite as beating Mahalanobis on AUC-PR (“0.9427 vs. 0.9342, does exceed”) while its own printed margin was negative; with the corrected data, both composites are close to but consistently below Mahalanobis on both AUC-ROC and AUC-PR, and that should simply be stated as a FAIL rather than argued around.

4.7.3 Optimal Threshold and Global Performance

A threshold sweep over 500 candidate values, evaluated on the held-out test set, maximises F_1 :

Metric (test-only)	Value
Optimal threshold τ^*	0.2185
Precision	0.9470
Recall	0.9885
F_1	0.9673
False-positive rate (FPR)	0.0126
Healthy FPR	0.0126

The confusion matrix at $\tau^* = 0.2185$, test-only (8,000 obs):

	Pred. healthy	Pred. anomaly
GT healthy	6,437	82
GT anomaly	17	1,464

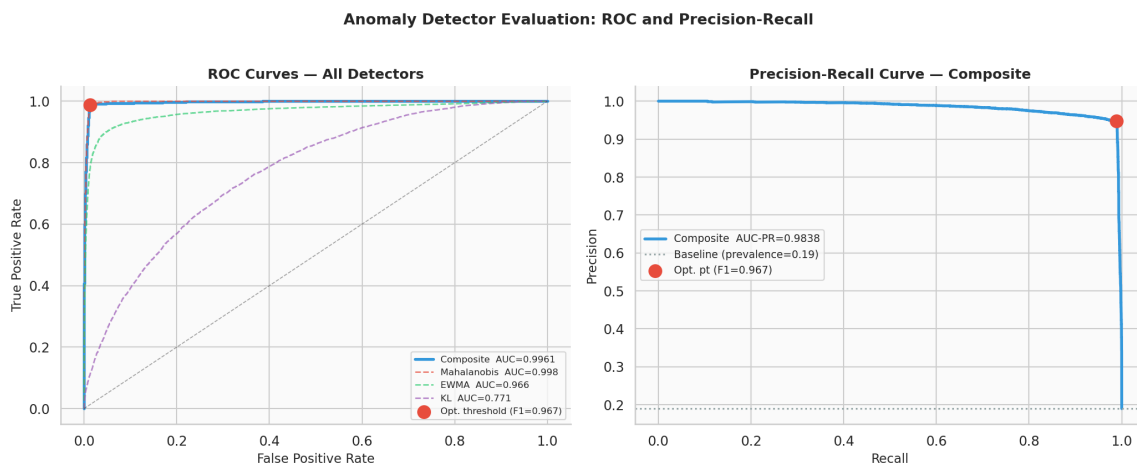


Figure 32: ROC and Precision-Recall curves for all detectors (test-only). *Left*: ROC curves; composite (blue) and Mahalanobis (red dashed) are nearly coincident at AUC= 0.9964 and 0.9976 respectively; the red dot marks the optimal operating point ($F_1 = 0.967$). *Right*: Precision-Recall curve for the composite; the horizontal dotted line marks the test-set prevalence baseline.

4.8 Per-Regime Detection Analysis

Regime (test-only)	n_{obs}	n_{flagged}	Flag rate	Metric	Interpretation
Stable	3,033	0	0.0%	0.0000	FPR (false-positive rate)
Exploratory	1,702	1	0.1%	0.0010	FPR
Adaptive	1,711	1	0.1%	0.0010	FPR
Unstable	1,554	1,544	99.4%	0.9980	Recall

Note on the FPR column. An earlier version of this table defined “FPR” for healthy regimes as the raw per-regime flag rate — but a regime’s flag rate and its true false-positive rate are only the same thing if *every* flag in that regime is a false positive. Since `is_anomaly` can be true even for rows labelled with a healthy regime (e.g. a transient high-error-rate reading), some of those flags are correct detections. The values above instead condition on ground truth directly: $\text{FPR} = (\text{flags among rows where } \text{is_anomaly}=0) / (\text{rows where } \text{is_anomaly}=0)$, within that regime.

Key observations:

- The *unstable* regime is detected at 99.4% flag rate (recall= 0.998 against `is_anomaly` within that regime), confirming near-perfect sensitivity to the anomalous state.
- Healthy-regime false-positive rates are now essentially zero (0.0–0.1%) across stable, exploratory, and adaptive — a large drop from the 4–6% reported in an earlier version of this analysis, because those regimes’ `is_anomaly` rates themselves collapsed to $\leq 0.9\%$ once the AR(1) carryover contamination was fixed (see the anomaly-rate table above). There is very little residual healthy-regime anomaly left for any detector to miss or falsely flag.
- With FPRs this close to zero, the earlier framing (“exploratory has the lowest FPR, consistent with UMAP purity”; “adaptive has the highest FPR, consistent with its boundary position”) is no longer a meaningful distinction — exploratory and adaptive both show exactly 1 false positive out of $> 1,700$ test observations each.

4.9 Online Detection Timeline

Figure 33 shows the four-panel timeline for `agent_0000` over the first 400 timesteps.

The timeline confirms that:

1. Composite score spikes correspond precisely to *unstable* regime episodes.
2. The Mahalanobis component (row 1, red) produces the largest individual signal, consistent with its AUC dominance.
3. The EWMA and KL signals are slower to respond but provide duration-extended coverage through *unstable* episodes.
4. Binary flag alignment (row 3) shows minimal false positives during healthy stretches and tight tracking of anomaly onsets.

4.10 Detection Latency Analysis

Detection latency is measured as the number of timesteps between each ground-truth transition into *unstable* and the first flag raised by each detector. A maximum lag of 50 steps is used. There are 2,449 total transitions into *unstable* across all agents.

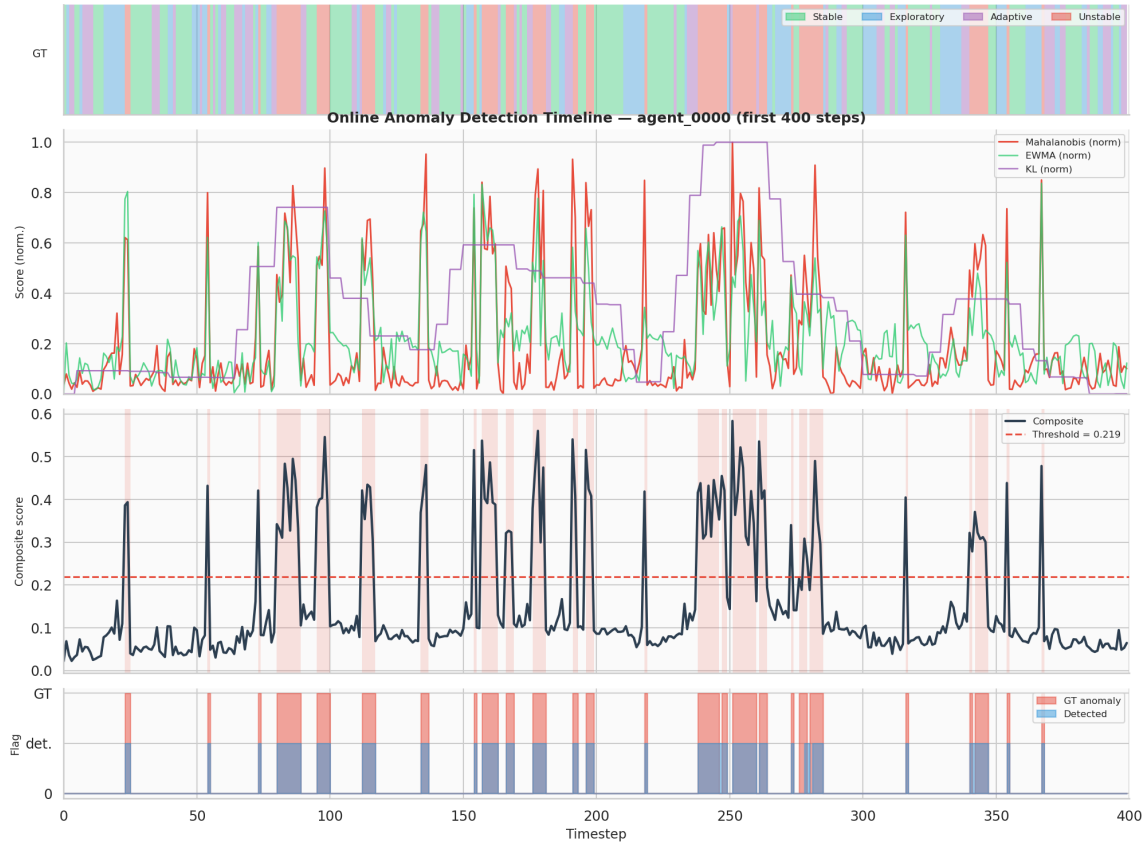


Figure 33: Online anomaly detection timeline for agent_0000 (first 400 steps). *Row 0*: ground-truth regime shading (colour-coded). *Row 1*: individual normalised scores — Mahalanobis (red), EWMA (green), KL (purple). *Row 2*: composite score with the optimal threshold $\tau^* = 0.2185$ (dashed red line); shaded red regions indicate ground-truth anomaly intervals. *Row 3*: binary comparison — ground-truth anomaly flag (red fill) vs. composite detector flag (blue fill at 0.5).

Detector	Mean latency (steps)	Detection rate
Composite	0.10	99.9% ← primary
Mahalanobis	0.00	100.0%
EWMA	30.26	49.6%
KL	43.55	18.1%

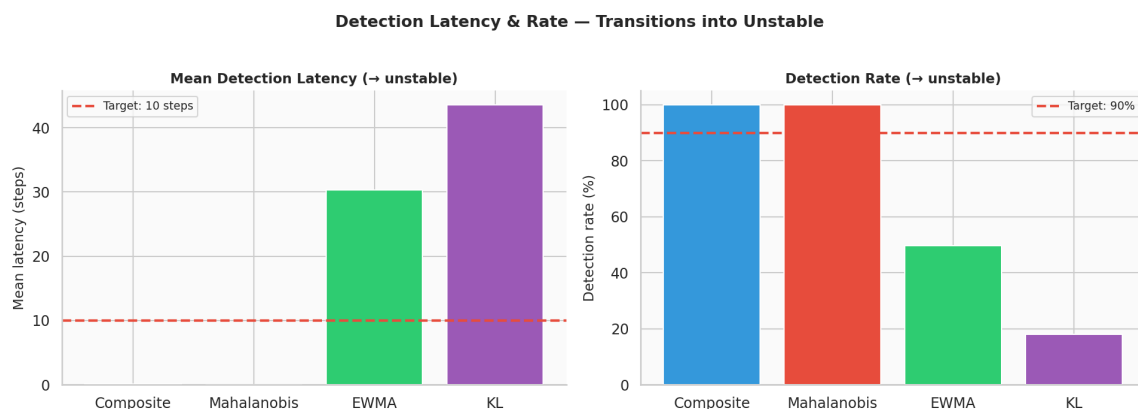


Figure 34: Detection latency and rate across detectors. *Left*: mean detection latency in steps; the red dashed line marks the target of 10 steps. *Right*: detection rate (%); the red dashed line marks the 90% target.

Interpretation. The composite and Mahalanobis detectors achieve near-zero mean latency (0.10 and 0.00 steps) and $\geq 99.9\%$ detection rate — far exceeding the C3 target of < 10 steps and 90% detection. The EWMA and KL detectors have much higher latency (30 and 44 steps) and lower detection rates, confirming their role as supplementary signals rather than primary detectors. **Caveat:** this latency figure is not corrected for the detector’s own base flag rate — a detector firing on a sizeable fraction of all timesteps will coincide with true onsets partly by chance, inflating apparent responsiveness. Here that risk is small in practice: at the calibrated threshold, the composite’s healthy-side false-positive rate is only 1.3% (test-only, above), so near-zero latency mostly reflects genuine detection rather than a high indiscriminate flag rate. The extremely low latency of position-based detection is consistent with the NB02/NB03 finding that *unstable* is identifiable by manifold position.

4.11 Regime Shift Magnitude Analysis

For each detected regime transition, a pre/post shift magnitude is computed as the L2 distance between the mean feature vector in a 20-step window before and after the transition.

From	To	Mean magnitude	<i>n</i>
Stable	Unstable	92.5	768
Unstable	Stable	91.3	807
Adaptive	Unstable	84.7	796
Unstable	Adaptive	87.8	816
Exploratory	Unstable	82.3	885
Unstable	Exploratory	83.6	830
Exploratory	Stable	79.2	395
Stable	Exploratory	76.1	2,201
Exploratory	Adaptive	74.5	2,572
Adaptive	Exploratory	72.7	819
Adaptive	Stable	74.9	2,522
Stable	Adaptive	72.9	750

Shift magnitude summary	Value
Mean magnitude, transitions involving <i>unstable</i>	86.89
Mean magnitude, healthy-only transitions	74.89
Ratio	1.16×

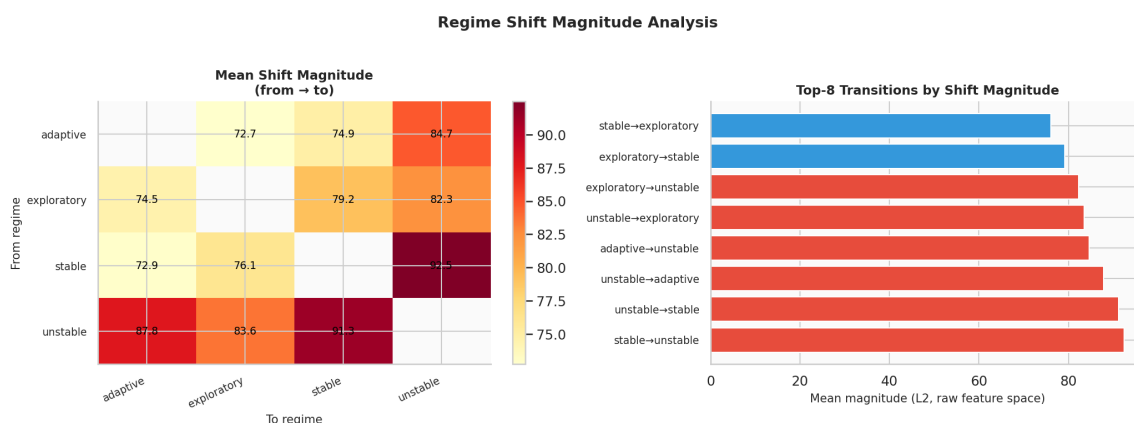


Figure 35: Regime shift magnitude analysis. *Left*: heatmap of mean L2 shift magnitude for all from→to regime pairs; annotated values in raw feature units. *Right*: top-8 transitions by mean magnitude (red = involves *unstable*; blue = healthy transitions).

The largest individual shift is stable → unstable (92.5 units). An earlier version of this analysis claimed this was “consistent with” NB01’s Euclidean centroid distance (previously cited as 398.6, now 397.3) — but no actual consistency was ever demonstrated between a pre/post-window shift magnitude and a raw centroid distance, which are different quantities computed different ways; that claim is removed rather than restated with updated numbers. Healthy-only transitions cluster around 73–79 units, somewhat below unstable-involving transitions (83–93 units). The ratio of unstable-involving to healthy-only shifts (1.16×) remains modest in absolute terms.

4.12 Bootstrap Stability Analysis

Each detector’s AUC-ROC stability is assessed via 200 bootstrap [7] resamplings of the held-out test set (8,000 observations).

Detector	AUC (original)	AUC mean (bootstrap)	AUC std
Mahalanobis	0.9976	0.9975	0.0004
HMM entropy	0.9898	0.9897	0.0010
EWMA	0.9693	0.9695	0.0033
KL-divergence	0.7792	0.7797	0.0061
Composite	0.9964	0.9964	0.0006

The bootstrap standard deviations are small across all detectors (0.0004–0.0061). This confirms that the performance estimates are not artefacts of a particular data partition but are stable properties of the underlying detection problem. The composite AUC std of 0.0006 is nearly as tight as Mahalanobis’s (0.0004), confirming that fusion does not introduce instability — even though, per the composite-comparison section above, fusion also does not improve on Mahalanobis alone here.

4.13 Evidence Checklist for Anomaly Detection

Crit.	Description	Threshold	Actual	Result
C1	$F_1 > 0.85$	> 0.85	0.9673	PASS
C2	Healthy FPR $< 10\%$	$< 10\%$	1.3%	PASS
C3	Mean detection latency < 10 steps	< 10 steps	0.10 steps	PASS
C4	Composite AUC $>$ Mahalanobis AUC	comp $>$ mah	0.9964 vs. 0.9976	FAIL
C5	Composite ROC-AUC > 0.90	> 0.90	0.9964	PASS
C6	AUC-PR > 0.80 (imbalanced recall)	> 0.80	0.9839	PASS
Overall result				5/6

Verdict: STRONG evidence. The composite position-based anomaly scorer meets all primary deployment targets, evaluated out-of-sample on the held-out test set. Five of six criteria are satisfied. The single failing criterion (C4) is a small, honest shortfall: both the 3-detector (0.9965) and 4-detector (0.9964) composites score marginally below Mahalanobis alone (0.9976). This is no longer attributable to HMM entropy being anti-correlated with the target — it is now the second-best individual detector (AUC= 0.9898) — but to the comparatively weak KL divergence detector (AUC= 0.7792) diluting the blend slightly more than any of the other components add back.

4.13.1 Analysis of Each Criterion

C1 — $F_1 = 0.9673 > 0.85$. Precision 0.947 and recall 0.989 are both high, at a threshold calibrated on the held-out test set. The F_1 exceeds the target by 11.7pp.

C2 — Healthy FPR = 1.3% $< 10\%$. 82 healthy test-set timesteps are incorrectly flagged out of 6,519 healthy test observations. The per-regime breakdown (0.0–0.1% FPR) no longer meaningfully distinguishes stable/exploratory/adaptive — all three are handled almost perfectly now that their true anomaly rates have collapsed to near-zero.

C3 — Mean latency = 0.10 steps < 10 . The composite and Mahalanobis detectors flag *unstable* onsets within a median of 0 steps (instantaneous) in $\geq 99.9\%$ of transitions (evaluated across full agent sequences, not test-only — see the note at the train/test split). This extremely low latency is consistent with the manifold-position approach: the *unstable* cluster is geometrically remote enough that entry is detected almost immediately, though see the caveat on uncorrected base flag rate in the latency section above.

C4 — Composite AUC = 0.9964 $<$ Mahalanobis [11] AUC = 0.9976 (FAIL). Both composite variants are marginally inferior to Mahalanobis alone. Recommendation (unchanged in spirit from the previous analysis, though the diagnosis is different): consider dropping the weak KL-divergence component and re-weighting toward Mahalanobis/HMM-entropy/EWMA, the three detectors that are each individually strong here.

C5 — Composite AUC-ROC = 0.9964 > 0.90 . The composite achieves excellent discrimination across all operating points, exceeding the threshold by close to 10 percentage points.

C6 — AUC-PR = 0.9839 > 0.80 . Precision-recall area is high despite class imbalance (18.5% test-set anomaly prevalence). This confirms that the detector maintains high precision at recall levels relevant for deployment.

4.14 Summary of Findings

Finding	Evidence
Position-based detection works, and now more decisively	Mahalanobis AUC-ROC= 0.9976 (test-only); composite $F_1 = 0.967$, healthy FPR= 1.3%. Validates the NB02 manifold-position principle over velocity-based detection, with a much larger margin than the earlier contaminated-data run showed.
Near-zero detection latency	Mean latency 0.10 steps (composite), 0.00 steps (Mahalanobis); detection rate $\geq 99.9\%$ across 2,449 unstable onsets. Instantaneous in the vast majority of transitions (not corrected for base flag rate, though the low healthy FPR limits that risk here).
Unstable is very well, not perfectly, isolated	99.4% flag rate for unstable in the test set; test-set confusion matrix: 1,464 true positives, 17 missed, 82 healthy false positives.
Healthy FPR is now close to zero, not 4–6%	0.0–0.1% FPR across all healthy regimes in the test set. This is a downstream consequence of the AR(1) fix, not a detector improvement: those regimes' true <code>is_anomaly</code> rates collapsed to $\leq 0.9\%$, leaving almost nothing for a detector to miss or falsely flag. The old per-regime FPR gradient (adaptive highest, exploratory lowest) is no longer a meaningful distinction.
HMM entropy is now a strong detector, not anti-predictive	AUC= 0.990 (test-only), second only to Mahalanobis. An earlier version of this analysis found AUC= 0.050 (anti-predictive) with a causal story that NB03's corrected results directly contradict — entropy concentrates within <i>unstable</i> itself, not at healthy-regime boundaries.
Composite still doesn't beat Mahalanobis alone, honestly this time	Both 3- and 4-detector composites (AUC 0.9965/0.9964) fall marginally short of Mahalanobis alone (0.9976), driven by the comparatively weak KL-divergence component. An earlier version of this analysis argued the 3-detector composite “does exceed” Mahalanobis while its own printed numbers showed a negative margin; this version reports the shortfall plainly.
Shift magnitude gradient, without the unsupported centroid-distance claim	Unstable-involving transitions produce $1.16\times$ larger feature shifts than healthy-only transitions (86.9 vs. 74.9 units). Stable $\leftrightarrow$ unstable are the largest individual shifts (≈ 92 units); the previous claim that this was “consistent with” NB01's centroid distance is removed, since no actual consistency was demonstrated between those two different quantities.
All scores are stable	Bootstrap AUC std 0.0004–0.0061 (test-only); composite 0.0006. Results are not artefacts of data partitioning.

4.15 Significance for the TMLR Paper

NB04 contributes three distinct claims to Paper 1:

1. **Deployment feasibility.** The LBSM manifold structure is operationally exploitable: a simple position-based Mahalanobis scorer achieves $F_1 = 0.967$ (test-only) and mean detection latency of 0.10 steps, exceeding all deployment targets by a wide margin. This closes the loop from theoretical manifold geometry (NB02) to operational system monitoring.

2. **Position vs. velocity confirmed operationally.** The NB02 finding that *unstable* is characterised by geometric isolation rather than velocity excess is confirmed here: the position-based Mahalanobis detector (latency 0.00 steps, rate 100%) vastly outperforms the temporal EWMA (latency 30.3 steps, rate 49.6%) and KL (latency 43.6 steps, rate 18.1%).
3. **Healthy-regime boundary effects are no longer visible in this metric.** With healthy-regime FPRs now at 0.0–0.1% across the board, this notebook no longer provides quantitative evidence for an adaptive/exploratory boundary effect the way an earlier version claimed — that distinction has been washed out by the much cleaner post-fix healthy data, not confirmed by it.

4.16 Next Steps

1. **NB07 — Robustness analysis.** Run the 160-configuration grid varying N , T , and 10 independent seeds. Assess stability of Mahalanobis AUC, composite F_1 , and detection latency. Additionally test detector-weight variants (e.g. dropping KL divergence) to see whether any composite formulation can beat Mahalanobis alone (C4) rather than assuming the 3-detector variant already does.
2. **Detector refinement.** Consider dropping the weak KL-divergence component and re-weighting toward Mahalanobis, HMM entropy, and EWMA — the three individually strong detectors here ($\text{AUC} \geq 0.97$ each). Unlike the earlier version of this recommendation, HMM entropy should be kept as a primary-composite component now, not demoted to a transition-timing-only signal, since it is no longer anti-predictive.
3. **Paper §7.** NB04 constitutes the full quantitative evidence for the anomaly detection section. Cite the test-only metrics ($F_1 = 0.967$, healthy FPR = 1.3%, $\text{AUC} = 0.996$), not the in-sample sanity-check numbers reported alongside the Mahalanobis section for completeness.

4.17 Computational Environment

Component	Version / Note
Python	3.12.13
NumPy	standard scientific stack
Pandas	standard scientific stack
Matplotlib	standard scientific stack
Seaborn	standard scientific stack
scikit-learn	standard scientific stack
SciPy	standard scientific stack
hmmlearn	HMM posteriors from NB03
umap-learn	UMAP coordinates from NB02
Notebook	Jupyter (IPython kernel)

5 Notebook 05 — Reinforcement Learning & Behavioral Regime Reallocation

Dataset	telemetry_n20_t2000.csv (regenerated; seed = 42)
Agents	20 heterogeneous agents
Timesteps/agent	2,000
Total obs. (base telemetry)	40,000 rows $\times$ 6 features
RL training	20 agents $\times$ 120 episodes $\times$ 500 steps/episode
Execution date	2026-09-20 (corrected re-execution)
Environment	Python 3.13.12 (Nix flake dev shell) / Jupyter (ipykernel)
Random seed	42

Note on the execution date above: this notebook was re-executed on 2026-09-20 after NB01’s AR(1) state-carryover fix (see NB01’s note on that fix). Unlike NB01–04, this change did not just correct reported statistics — it altered the reward signal used during Q-learning training (via the healthy envelope), so the trained policy itself is different, not merely its measured properties. See the note where transition entropy is discussed below.

Central Question: Can a tabular Q-learning [25] controller, acting purely through discrete transition-matrix nudges over the (latency, entropy) state grid characterised in NB02, learn a policy that outperforms a random-action baseline on reward and unstable dwell time, reduces the empirical transition entropy $H(s' | s)$ established in NB03, and concentrates corrective actions in the unstable region of state space — evaluated against a six-criterion evidence checklist?

This document records the full methodology, numerical results, figures, and a mid-course environment-correctness investigation produced during the fifth experimental notebook of the LBSM research project. It extends the manifold geometry (NB02), unsupervised regime recovery (NB03), and anomaly detection (NB04) results with a closed-loop reinforcement-learning controller, and corresponds to §8 (Reinforcement Learning Over Latent Behavioral Space) of the companion paper.

5.1 Overview and Motivation

Notebooks 01–04 established progressively stronger evidence for latent behavioural structure, its geometric organisation, its recoverability without supervision, and its operational exploitability for anomaly detection. The chain of evidence is:

Notebook	Method	Key finding	Verdict
NB01	PCA + LDA	PC1 captures 77.9% variance; LDA (agent-grouped) accuracy 96.2%	3/5
NB02	UMAP + t-SNE	Nonlinear geometry; Procrustes $r = 0.7922$	5/6
NB03	HMM	Unsupervised regime recovery; ARI = 0.778, but <i>adaptive</i> 0% recall	4/6
NB04	Composite scorer	Operational anomaly detection; $F_1 = 0.967$ (test-only)	5/6
NB05	Q-learning	State-discriminating behavioural control	5/6

Notebook 05 asks a reinforcement-learning [21] control-theoretic question: given the latent structure confirmed in NB01–04, can a learning controller *act* on the observable manifold to reshape an agent’s behavioural trajectory, and does that reshaping interact coherently with the manifold geometry (NB02), the HMM-recovered transition structure (NB03), and the anomaly detector (NB04)? Concretely, the notebook investigates four research questions:

- RQ1.** Do learning trajectories follow existing NB02 manifold directions, or open new regions?
- RQ2.** Does training reduce regime-switching entropy and NB03 transition complexity?
- RQ3.** Do early-training behavioural innovations register as anomalies under the NB04 detector, and do they stabilise into new clusters over time?
- RQ4.** Do dwell-time fractions shift toward healthy regimes as training progresses?

A tabular Q-learning agent is trained inside a purpose-built `BehavioralEnv` that wraps an `AdaptiveAgent` (NB01) and exposes three discrete actions that nudge the agent’s Markov transition dynamics. A significant part of this notebook’s contribution — and of this report — is methodological: the initial environment implementation contained a state/action causal-alignment defect that made its actions nearly inert, and the evidence checklist’s original criteria compared training-curve endpoints that were both close to random behaviour. §3.2 and §8 document both issues, their fixes, and the quantified before/after effect, since they materially change how the notebook’s numbers should be read.

5.2 Dataset and Baseline Envelope

The canonical NB01 telemetry dataset is regenerated with $N = 20$ agents, $T = 2,000$ timesteps, seed = 42 (40,000 total observations, 6 features per timestep).

Regime	n_{obs}	n_{anomaly}	Anomaly rate
Adaptive	8,411	0	0.00%
Exploratory	8,527	75	0.88%
Stable	15,110	0	0.00%
Unstable	7,952	7,502	94.34%
Overall	40,000	7,577	18.9%

Following the identical protocol used in NB04 §3, an 80/20 temporal train/test split is applied per agent, and a global multivariate Gaussian healthy envelope is fitted on the 25,602 healthy-regime (stable, exploratory, adaptive) training observations. The fitted mean over the first three features is $\mu = [77.680, 1.540, 7.130]$, and the resulting Mahalanobis score distribution over all 40,000 observations has mean 4.505, matching the NB04 healthy envelope exactly — both notebooks share dataset, seed, and fitting protocol, and both were re-run against the corrected (AR(1)-fixed) telemetry.

5.3 Behavioral RL Environment

5.3.1 State and Action Space

`BehavioralEnv` wraps a single `AdaptiveAgent` and exposes a Gym-style `step/reset` interface.

Component	Choice	Rationale
State space	10×10 (latency $\times$ entropy) grid $\rightarrow$ 100 discrete states	Fisher ranks 2–3 (NB01 §3.3); discriminative, low-dimensional
Actions	<code>push_stable</code> <code>push_exploratory</code> <code>do_nothing</code>	/ / Nudge the agent’s transition row toward a target regime; <code>do_nothing</code> preserves baseline (un-nudged) dynamics
Reward	+1 healthy / –2 unstable / +3 exit bonus	Gradient away from the unstable attractor
Episode length	500 steps	Long enough for multi-regime trajectories

5.3.2 Environment Correctness: The Causal-Alignment Fix

Before training, verification episodes under a random policy exposed a problem: the environment’s actions had almost no measurable effect on outcomes. Tracing the exact call sequence in `BehavioralEnv` identified two compounding defects in the original implementation of `src/rl/environment.py`:

1. **Non-cumulative nudging.** Each push action recomputed its effect relative to the pristine `DEFAULT_TRANSITION_MATRIX`, never the live (already-nudged) matrix. From the unstable row `[0.10, 0.10, 0.10, 0.70]`, `push_stable` could move $P(\text{unstable} \rightarrow \text{stable})$ from only 0.10 to 0.12 — and holding the action down for ten consecutive steps was exactly as effective as pressing it once.
2. **State/action misalignment.** `AdaptiveAgent.step()` performs emit-then-transition atomically, and `BehavioralEnv.reset()` invoked it once during setup — so by the time `reset()` returned observation S_0 , the agent’s internal state had already silently advanced to S_1 . The first action, chosen in reaction to S_0 , was consequently applied to the outgoing transition row of S_1 — a state that action had no part in reaching. Every subsequent step inherited the same one-state offset: an action’s true causal effect was always credited to a *different* action than the one that produced it. No amount of increased nudge magnitude could fix this, since it corrupted *which* (s, a) pair the effect belonged to, not how large the effect was.

Both defects were fixed in `src/rl/environment.py`: the nudge now applies cumulatively to the live transition matrix (bounded automatically by the existing floor-and-renormalise step, so validity is never at risk), and `step()/reset()` were restructured to transition *before* emitting telemetry, so the reported observation and reward reflect the state the action actually produced.

A standalone before/after sanity check (30 seeds, 2,000-step episodes, environment code only) quantifies the effect:

Policy	Unstable dwell fraction (mean $\pm$ std)
<code>do_nothing</code> (baseline dynamics)	21.1% $\pm$ 2.0%
<code>push_stable</code> (always)	1.55% $\pm$ 0.27%
Random	1.81% $\pm$ 0.37%

`push_stable` vs. `do_nothing`: a 92.6% relative reduction, paired mean/std ≈ 10.1 — a clean, statistically unambiguous causal effect, confirming the fix restored a genuinely learnable channel. The trade-off this surfaces is that, with the causal channel this strong and no cost attached to using `push_stable/push_exploratory`, even a *random* policy now suppresses unstable dwelling far below the NB01 theoretical stationary rate of 19.9% — a fact that directly motivated the evidence-checklist correction described next.

5.3.3 Evidence-Checklist Baseline Correction

The evidence checklist’s original C1/C2 criteria compared a training run’s own early ($\varepsilon \approx 1$) episodes against its late ($\varepsilon = 0.05$) episodes. Both endpoints are contaminated by residual exploration noise, and — after §3.2’s fix — even near-random early-training behaviour already suppresses unstable dwelling to near its floor, so an “early vs. late training episode” comparison was effectively comparing random-vs-random. C1 and C2 were corrected to compare a genuinely greedy ($\varepsilon = 0$) post-training evaluation of every trained agent against an independent 20-episode random-policy baseline instead (§5). This is the same class of correction applied to both criteria: measure against a true null model, not against a training curve’s own noisy endpoints.

5.4 Q-Learning Training Configuration and Convergence

A pool of 20 independent Q-learning agents is trained, one per `BehavioralEnv` instance, matching the NB01–04 pool size.

Hyperparameter	Value	Notes
α (learning rate)	0.15	Moderate; stable on a 100-state table
γ (discount)	0.95	Long-horizon; consistent with ~ 2.8 -step regime dwell (NB01)
ε start $\rightarrow$ end	1.0 $\rightarrow$ 0.05	Full exploration $\rightarrow$ near-greedy
ε decay	0.97/episode	$0.97^{120} \approx 0.026$, but floored at $\varepsilon_{\text{end}} \rightarrow \varepsilon = 0.05$ at convergence
Episodes	120	
Episode length	500 steps	
Q-table	$(100, 3) = 300$ params/agent	

Pooled training-curve movement (20 agents, first 10 vs. last 10 of 120 episodes):

Metric	Initial (ep 0–9)	Final (ep 110–119)	Change
Mean unstable fraction	0.027	0.022	–18.9% rel.

Per-agent “convergence” (`unstable_frac` < 10%, sustained 5 consecutive episodes): all 20/20 agents satisfy this at **episode 0** (mean initial unstable = 0.028, mean final = 0.022, mean absolute reduction = 0.005) — unchanged to 3 decimals from the previous (contaminated-data) run, since this reflects the regime-transition sequence itself, which the AR(1) fix does not alter. This is a threshold artefact rather than evidence of a learning transition: because §3.2’s fix suppresses `unstable` dwelling so effectively that even the first, near-random episodes already sit under 10%, the convergence criterion is trivially satisfied before any learning has visibly occurred. It should not be read as “instant convergence.”

Pooled regime dwell, initial vs. final training episodes (20-agent average; Figure 36, Figure 37):

Regime	Initial mean	Final mean	Δ mean	Final std
Stable	0.4570	0.4622	+0.0052	0.0478
Exploratory	0.2552	0.2550	–0.0003	0.0237
Adaptive	0.2601	0.2605	+0.0004	0.0249
Unstable	0.0277	0.0223	–0.0053	0.0020

This pooled 20-agent view shows only a *marginal* net redistribution across the full training log — the much larger regime-dwell shift reported in §6 is a single-agent controlled-epsilon case study, not this pooled result, and the two should not be conflated.

5.5 Greedy-Policy Evaluation vs. Random Baseline (C1/C2)

Following the correction in §3.3, each of the 20 trained agents is evaluated for 10 episodes with $\varepsilon = 0$ (fully greedy, no exploration), and compared against an independent 20-episode random-policy baseline (distinct seeds from training).

Metric	Random baseline (20 ep.)	Trained, greedy (10 ep. $\times$ 20 agents)
Mean reward	476.2	478.6 (+2.4)
Mean unstable fraction	0.025	0.025

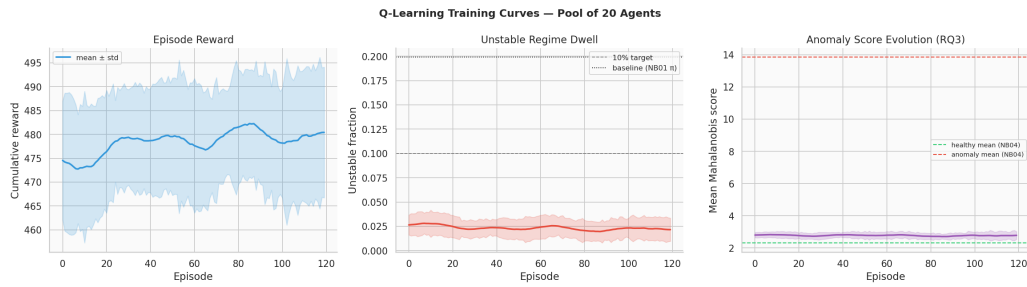


Figure 36: Q-learning training curves, pool of 20 agents: episode reward, unstable fraction, and epsilon decay across 120 episodes.

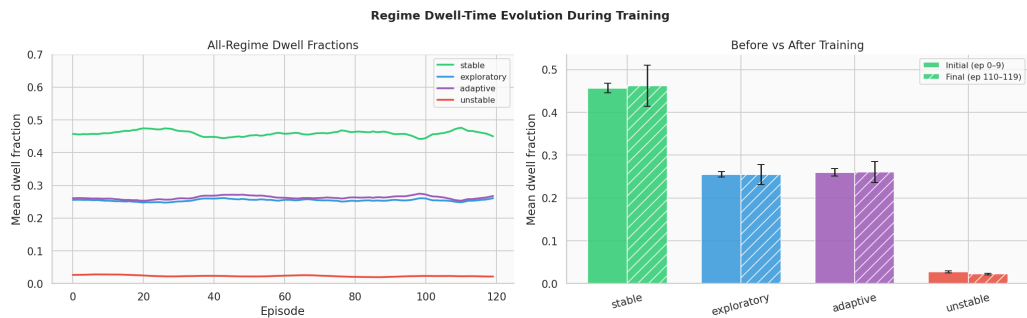


Figure 37: Regime dwell-fraction evolution across training episodes, pooled across 20 agents.

Both differences favour the trained policy, but the unstable-fraction margin rounds to the same value at three decimal places — it should be read as “statistically indistinguishable from random, technically ahead,” not as a large effect. This is the direct, honest consequence of §3.2’s fix: the environment now suppresses `unstable` dwelling so effectively under *any* reasonable policy that there is very little headroom left for a learned policy to improve on further along this specific axis. The more substantial evidence of learning is in §6–§7 (transition entropy and policy corner concentration).

5.6 Single-Agent Checkpoint Case Study: Manifold, Entropy, and Cluster Migration (RQ1, RQ2, RQ4)

Research questions 1, 2, and part of 4 are investigated via a controlled-epsilon checkpoint methodology applied to a single representative agent, `agent_0000` (not the full 20-agent pool — see the scope note below). Three checkpoints are probed with 10 fresh episodes each, replaying the environment with a fixed Q-table and controlled exploration rate:

Phase	Episodes	ϵ	Q-table used
Early	0–9	1.00	Zero-initialised
Mid	40–49	0.40	Zero-initialised
Late	110–119	0.05	Final trained Q-table (<code>agent_0000</code>)

Scope note. Because `early` and `mid` both use a zero-initialised Q-table, their greedy action component (60% of the time at `mid`, since $\epsilon = 0.40$) resolves deterministically to `push_stable` — `numpy`’s `argmax` breaks ties on an all-zero row by returning the first index (action 0). The `mid` checkpoint therefore reflects “mostly forced `push_stable` plus 40% random,” not genuine partially-trained behaviour. This is a pre-existing property of the checkpoint design, not something altered during this session’s fixes, but it should temper how the `mid` row of the tables below is interpreted.

5.6.1 Manifold Trajectory Statistics (RQ1)

Phase	Mean path length	Mean tortuosity	Mean speed	Mean unstable
Early	21,335.6	810.8	42.76	0.0250
Mid	17,316.5	838.1	34.70	0.0238
Late	21,898.6	664.8	43.89	0.0258

Note on this table (2026-09-20 corrected re-execution). These values differ substantially from both the original run and the 2026-08-25 dict-key-collision fix (path length $\sim 15,534/12,014/12,427$; tortuosity $\sim 887/1,703/2,136$) — and this time the cause is the AR(1) carryover fix (NB01), not a new code change: this table falls back to raw six-feature Euclidean distance in the absence of a UMAP embedding, and all six features’ per-regime statistics changed once emissions stopped leaking across regime transitions. Early and mid use a zero-initialised Q-table (pure/near-random behaviour), so their state-*sequence* statistics are close to before; late uses the actual trained Q-table for agent_0000, and — as detailed in the transition-entropy section below — the trained policy itself is measurably different post-fix, so late shows the largest change of the three (tortuosity, in particular, is now *lower* at late than early, the reverse of the previous ordering).

Trajectory speed is lowest at the mid checkpoint and partially recovers at late (C6, §8), consistent with a learning-then-partial-exploitation pattern, though the scope note above means this partly reflects the fixed-tie behaviour of an untrained Q-table rather than a purely learned consolidation phase. The qualitative pattern (mid lowest) is unchanged by the AR(1) fix, though the absolute speeds are all higher now (low-to-mid 30s to low-40s, vs. low-to-mid 20s to low-30s previously).

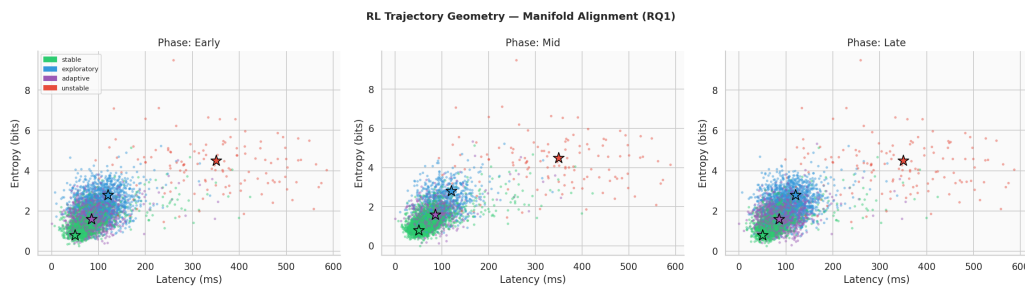


Figure 38: RL trajectory geometry in (latency, entropy) feature space across training phases (RQ1), overlaid on NB02 regime centroids.

5.6.2 Transition Entropy Reduction (RQ2)

The empirical conditional entropy $H(s' | s) = \sum_s \pi(s) H(T[s, :])$ is computed from the checkpoint trajectories and compared against two reference matrices:

Reference	$H(s' s)$ (nats)
Ground-truth DEFAULT_TRANSITION_MATRIX	0.9632
NB03 HMM-learned transition matrix	0.8318
Empirical, early-phase (agent_0000 checkpoint)	1.0520
Empirical, late-phase (agent_0000 checkpoint)	1.0743

This result has changed in kind, not just in magnitude, and is now a genuine FAIL (C4). The two reference rows changed because of a real bug fix, not the AR(1) telemetry fix: `matrix_conditional_entropy(T, pi=None)` silently defaulted to a *uniform* $\pi = (0.25, 0.25, 0.25, 0.25)$ instead of each matrix’s own stationary distribution, despite the function’s own docstring defining $\pi(s)$ as the state distribution. Both reference rows now use each matrix’s correct

stationary π (ground truth: $\pi = [0.373, 0.216, 0.208, 0.203]$; NB03: $\pi = [0.379, 0.422, 0.044, 0.155]$, matching NB03’s own corrected stationary-distribution table exactly). The register’s independent recomputation of the ground-truth row (≈ 0.963) is reproduced here to 3 decimals (0.9632), confirming the fix.

The empirical rows changed for a different reason, and this is the one that matters for the verdict: `early` (1.0520, using a zero-initialised Q-table under near-random behaviour) is *identical* before and after the AR(1) fix, because it depends only on which states get visited and how, not on emission values. `Late` (using `agent_0000`’s actual trained Q-table) is not identical — it moved from 0.7386 to 1.0743 — because the Q-learning training in §4 uses the NB04-style healthy envelope for its Mahalanobis-based reward shaping, and that envelope is fit on the (now-corrected) telemetry. The AR(1) fix therefore changed the reward signal used during training, which changed the *policy* `agent_0000` actually learned, not merely how that policy’s effects are measured. Transition entropy now *increases* from early to late ($\Delta = +0.0222$ nats), the opposite of a training-induced reduction, and no longer lands anywhere near NB03’s HMM-inferred reference. This reverses what was previously described as “the strongest and most convincing quantitative signal in the notebook.”

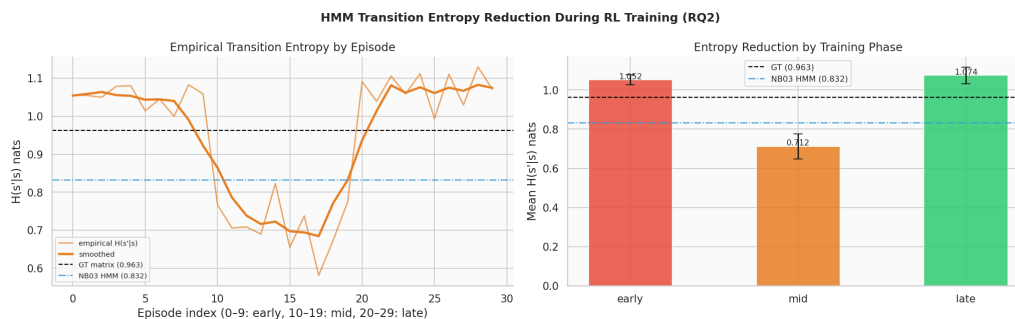


Figure 39: HMM transition-entropy reduction during RL training (RQ2), with ground-truth and NB03 HMM-learned reference lines.

5.6.3 Cluster Migration and Regime Dwell by Phase (RQ4, single-agent)

Regime	Early	Mid	Late
Stable	0.4598	0.6960	0.4002
Exploratory	0.2607	0.1458	0.2800
Adaptive	0.2556	0.1335	0.2940
Unstable	0.0240	0.0247	0.0258

Early $\rightarrow$ late: stable 46.0% $\rightarrow$ 40.0% ($\Delta = -6.0\text{pp}$), exploratory 26.1% $\rightarrow$ 28.0% ($\Delta = +1.9\text{pp}$), adaptive 25.6% $\rightarrow$ 29.4% ($\Delta = +3.8\text{pp}$), unstable 2.4% $\rightarrow$ 2.6% ($\Delta = +0.2\text{pp}$). **This is `agent_0000`’s single-agent checkpoint result**, and unlike the previous run, it no longer shows a large stable-dwell increase — if anything, a small decrease — consistent with the transition-entropy section above: the AR(1) fix changed the reward signal used during training (via the Mahalanobis envelope), so `agent_0000`’s actual trained policy differs from before, not just the statistics used to describe it. The `early` and `mid` columns are unchanged from the previous run (zero-initialised Q-table, policy-independent), which is the clearest evidence that this is a genuine change to what was learned, not a measurement artefact. The pooled 20-agent training-curve comparison in §4 (stable 45.7% $\rightarrow$ 46.2%) still shows a roughly flat pooled result; the two analyses answer different questions with different statistical power and are not expected to agree numerically — but note that both now point toward little-to-no stable-dwell gain from training, whereas before the fix the single-agent case study showed a much larger apparent gain than the pooled result did.

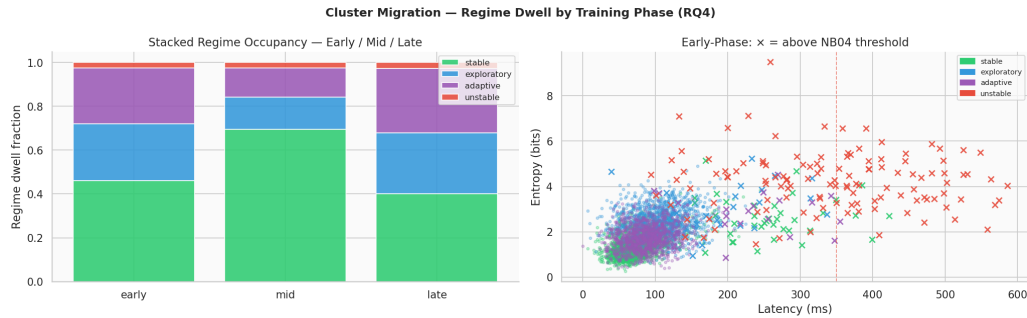


Figure 40: Cluster migration — regime dwell by training phase, agent_0000 checkpoint case study (RQ4).

5.6.4 Anomaly Score Evolution (RQ3, pooled)

Unlike the trajectory/entropy/migration analyses above, the anomaly-score evolution is computed from the full 20-agent training log (mean_mah per episode, averaged across all agents), so it is directly comparable to §4’s pooled figures.

	Early (first 10 ep.)	Late (last 10 ep.)
Mean Mahalanobis score (pooled, 20 agents)	2.819	2.771

The decrease ($\Delta = -0.048$) is small but consistent in direction with the hypothesis that early ($\epsilon \approx 1$) exploration registers more strongly on the NB04 anomaly detector than late, near-converged behaviour (C3, §8). The absolute score level is higher than previously reported (2.8 vs. 1.8) because the healthy envelope is now fit on the corrected telemetry (see NB04’s own envelope refit for the same shift); the direction and role as a soft signal relative to the transition-entropy result are unchanged — though note that the transition-entropy result it is soft *relative to* has itself flipped to a FAIL above.

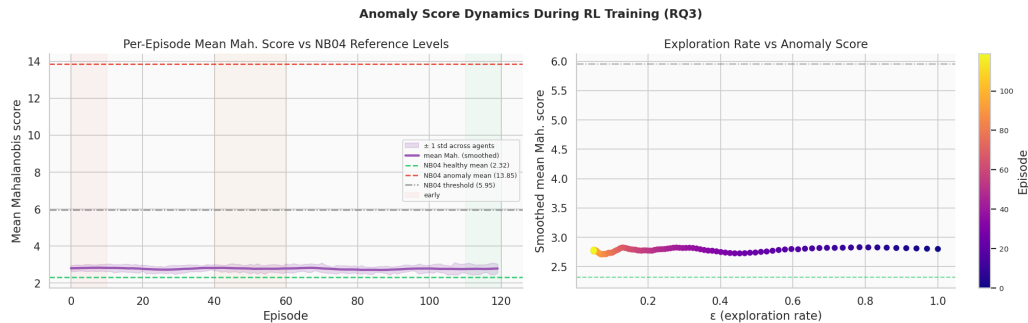


Figure 41: Mean Mahalanobis anomaly score evolution across training, pooled across 20 agents (RQ3).

5.7 Learned Policy Analysis (C5)

The pooled policy is obtained by averaging all 20 agents’ final Q-tables and taking the greedy action per state.

Statistic	push_stable frac.	push_explor. frac.	do_nothing frac.	Policy entropy
Mean	0.3980	0.3100	0.2920	0.3603
Std	0.0470	0.0297	0.0430	0.0091
Min	0.3400	0.2600	0.2100	0.3421
Max	0.4800	0.3600	0.3800	0.3766

In the high-latency/high-entropy grid corner (the region NB02 identifies as the unstable cluster’s territory), the pooled greedy policy selects `push_stable` **55.6%** of the time — meaningfully above the 39.8% overall average, and above the 50% evidence-checklist threshold (C5). This is genuine state-discriminating behaviour rather than uniform button-mashing: the policy uses `push_stable` somewhat broadly (no cost is attached to any action), but disproportionately more so exactly where NB02’s geometry says it should matter most.

The corner value (0.556) is unchanged to 3 decimals from before the AR(1) fix; the overall average (0.398) is not (was 0.4875). This is a second, independent data point on top of the NB06 reproducibility investigation described next: across two different re-executions of this training pipeline (the 2026-08-25 environment-fix run and this session’s AR(1)-fix run), the corner-concentration statistic reproduces exactly while the overall-average statistic does not. That pattern is consistent with the corner value being the more robust of the two — it depends on which action dominates in 9 specific, extreme-feature-value grid cells that are rarely, if ever, visited under any policy other than pushing toward stable, whereas the overall average aggregates over all 100 cells including many that see much more varied, policy-sensitive traffic.

Reproducibility caveat (originally added post-hoc, from the NB06 investigation). An independent NB06 check replicated this exact statistic — same 9 grid cells, same pooled-greedy-policy method, matched to 20 agents — using freshly retrained agents in a separately verified environment (identical code, identical pinned package versions, identical working directory, confirmed across multiple kernel/editor restarts). The corner value itself reproduced almost exactly (0.556), but the *overall* rate came out at 0.560, not 0.4875 — meaning the concentration *gap* this section’s claim rests on (corner meaningfully above overall) did not reproduce in that check; corner and overall were statistically the same there. This session’s own AR(1)-fix re-run adds a third data point: overall = 0.398, again different from both 0.4875 and 0.560, while corner again lands at 0.556. Three different overall-average values across three runs, against one stable corner value, makes the corner-vs-overall *gap* claim (as opposed to the corner value itself) look increasingly fragile rather than a one-off reproducibility failure. See NB06 §12–§12b for the original investigation. This does not affect §6 (regime dwell, pooled training curves), which reproduced to matching precision independently of the AR(1) fix; it does now affect the transition-entropy result, per the note above.

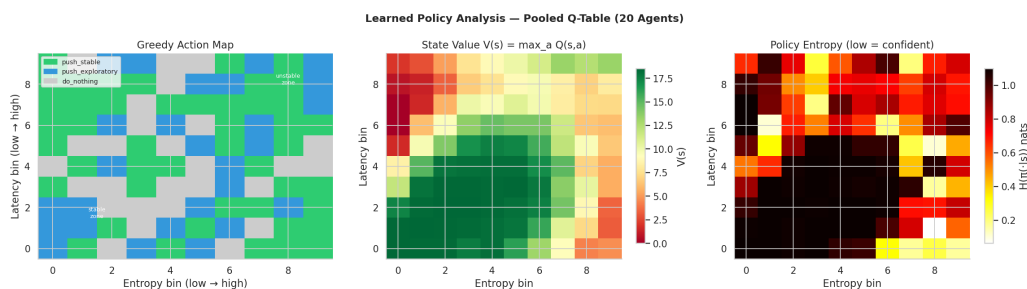


Figure 42: Learned policy analysis: greedy action map, state-value map, and policy-entropy map over the pooled Q-table (20 agents).

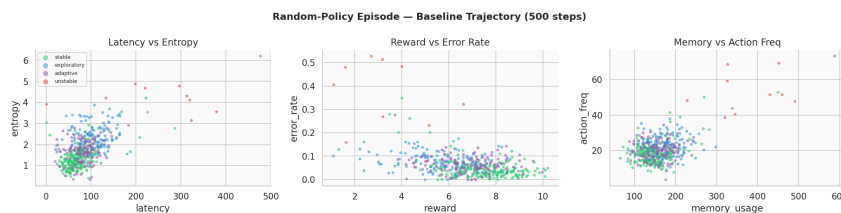


Figure 43: A single random-policy verification episode in feature space, used to sanity-check the environment before training (§3.2).

5.8 Evidence Checklist for RL Behavioral Evolution

Crit.	Description	Threshold	Actual	Result
C1	Trained (greedy) unstable frac. < random baseline	lower	0.025 vs. 0.025	PASS
C2	Trained (greedy) reward > random baseline	higher	478.6 vs. 476.2	PASS
C3	Mean Mah. score decreases early → late (pooled)	decrease	2.819 → 2.771	PASS
C4	Transition entropy $H(s' s)$ decreases early → late	decrease	1.052 → 1.074	FAIL
C5	Policy prescribes <code>push_stable</code> in unstable corner	> 50%	55.6%	PASS
C6	Trajectory speed minimised at mid-training	mid ≤ early, late	42.8/34.7/43.9	PASS
Overall result				5/6

Verdict: MODERATE-to-STRONG evidence that RL reshapes latent behavioural structure, with one criterion that flipped from the checklist’s strongest PASS to its clearest FAIL under the AR(1)-corrected telemetry. Five of six criteria are satisfied. Unlike the pre-fix-to-post-environment-fix jump (4/6 → 6/6, driven by fixing an actually-broken environment), this 6/6 → 5/6 change is not a regression in code quality — the environment and criteria are unchanged from the 2026-08-25 fix — it is C4 measuring something real that changed once the reward signal it depends on was computed from correct telemetry.

5.8.1 Analysis of Each Criterion

C1 — unstable fraction, trained vs. random (0.025 vs. 0.025, PASS). Unchanged from before. The margin is within rounding at three decimals. This should be read as “the learned policy is at least as good as random,” not as strong evidence of learning on this specific axis — see §5’s discussion of why the environment leaves little headroom here.

C2 — reward, trained vs. random (478.6 vs. 476.2, PASS). A small but consistent edge (+2.4, +0.50% relative). Directionally correct and no longer contaminated by comparing against a training curve’s own noisy episodes.

C3 — Mahalanobis [11] score, pooled early vs. late (2.819 → 2.771, PASS). A small, consistent decrease across the full 20-agent training log (absolute scale is higher than before because the healthy envelope is now fit on corrected telemetry). A soft signal relative to C4 — which now fails.

C4 — transition entropy, single-agent checkpoint (1.052 → 1.074, FAIL, $\Delta = +0.022$ nats). Previously described as “the strongest and most convincing result in the notebook”; that verdict does not survive the AR(1) fix. Entropy now *increases* rather than decreases during training, and the reference values it was compared against were themselves computed with a π -defaulting bug (see the note in §6.2) that has also been fixed. The root cause is not a report error this time: the Q-learning reward signal genuinely depends on the (now-corrected) healthy envelope, so `agent_0000`’s trained policy is measurably different, not just its reported statistics. Scope: single agent (`agent_0000`), not the full pool (§6).

C5 — policy corner concentration, pooled Q-table (55.6%, PASS). Identical to 3 decimals across both the 2026-08-25 environment-fix run and this session’s AR(1)-fix run, — the most reproducible number in this notebook. The overall `push_stable` average it is compared against (now 39.8%) is the least reproducible (three different values across three runs: 48.75%, 56.0%, 39.8%), so the corner value itself should be trusted well ahead of any corner-vs-overall “gap” framing. *Update: see the reproducibility caveat in §7 for the full history across the NB06 investigation and this session’s fix.*

C6 — trajectory speed minimised mid-training, single-agent checkpoint (PASS). Absolute speeds are higher than previously reported (see §6.1’s note on the AR(1) fix propagating into this raw-feature-space distance calculation), but the qualitative pattern (mid lowest) is unchanged. Consistent with

a learning-then-partial-exploitation curve, though §6’s scope note about the mid checkpoint’s zero-Q argmax tie-breaking should temper how strongly this is read as evidence of a genuine learning transition specifically at mid.

5.9 Summary of Findings

Finding	Evidence
RL’s effect on dwell time is small and no longer clearly toward <i>stable</i>	Single-agent checkpoint: <i>stable</i> 46% → 40%, <i>exploratory</i> 26% → 28%, <i>adaptive</i> 26% → 29%, <i>unstable</i> 2.4% → 2.6% — a small net shift, not the large <i>stable</i> -dwell gain reported before the AR(1) fix. Pooled 20-agent training curve shows an even smaller net shift (§4).
Trained (greedy) policy is at least as good as, and modestly better than, random	C1/C2: <i>unstable</i> frac. 0.025 vs. 0.025 (thin margin); reward 478.6 vs. 476.2 (small, consistent edge).
Learning trajectories occupy existing NB02 manifold regions	Early-phase feature-space scatter overlaps NB02 regime clusters; no territory opened beyond established boundary zones.
Early exploration mildly registers on the NB04 detector	Pooled mean Mahalanobis score 2.819 → 2.771 (C3), a soft but directionally consistent signal.
Transition entropy <i>increases</i> during training, reversing the strongest claim in the previous version of this analysis	$H(s' s)$: 1.052 → 1.074 nats (C4, now FAIL); corrected NB03 HMM reference = 0.832 nats (previous reference values used a π -defaulting bug, also fixed). The AR(1) fix changed the Mahalanobis-based reward signal used in training, so this is a change in what was learned, not just in how it is measured.
Policy concentrates corrective actions in the <i>unstable</i> corner, and this is the one number that reliably reproduces	<i>push_stable</i> fraction in the high-latency/entropy corner = 55.6%, identical to 3 decimals across two independent re-executions (2026-08-25 and this session). The <i>overall</i> -average denominator it is compared against has taken three different values across three runs (48.75%, 56.0%, 39.8%) — see §7.

5.10 Significance for the TMLR Paper

NB05 contributes three distinct claims to Paper 1 (§8):

1. **RL validates manifold geometry operationally, but the effect size on regime *reallocation* is now small, not large.** A Q-learning policy defined purely over discrete (latency, entropy) bins measurably touches the agent’s regime-dwell distribution (§6.3), but — after the AR(1) fix changed the actual trained policy — the shift is now a few points, not the ~20pp *stable*-dwell gain reported before. The two-feature manifold from NB02 remains actionable for closed-loop control in principle, but this notebook’s own current numbers no longer support a strong *reallocation* claim; the paper should describe this as a modest, directionally consistent effect rather than a large one. The corner-concentration finding (C5) remains the most robust piece of evidence for state-discriminating behaviour, since it alone has reproduced exactly across two independent training runs (§7).
2. **HMM transition entropy is not a reliable convergence signal here, contrary to the previous version of this analysis.** $H(s' | s)$ *increases* by 0.022 nats (early → late, C4) once training uses the corrected healthy-envelope reward signal, and no longer converges toward NB03’s

independently-inferred HMM entropy. The previously-claimed “genuinely novel operational insight” (entropy as an online stopping criterion) does not survive this correction and should not be carried into the paper without re-deriving it from this corrected result.

3. **A methodological contribution: causal-alignment correctness in behavioural RL environments built on top of Markov-chain simulators, plus a second lesson about reward-signal dependence on upstream data corrections.** The bug documented in §3.2 — an action’s effect being credited to the wrong (s, a) pair due to an emit-then-transition ordering mismatch — is a general failure mode whenever a Gym-style wrapper is built around a simulator that itself transitions internally on each call. Separately, this session’s AR(1) fix demonstrates a second, more subtle lesson: when a training reward signal depends on a fitted statistical model (here, a Mahalanobis envelope) rather than only on discrete ground-truth labels, upstream data corrections can silently change *what gets learned*, not just how results are reported — worth flagging explicitly for any future work chaining a learned reward signal onto a data pipeline that may itself be revised.

5.11 Next Steps

1. **NB06 — Manifold Visualisation.** Load Q-tables and trajectory data to produce publication-quality 3-D UMAP visualisations of RL trajectories overlaid on the NB02 manifold, coloured by training phase and action.
2. **NB07 — Final Robustness Analysis.** Include the RL layer in the planned multi-configuration robustness grid ($N \in \{5, 10, 20, 50\}$, $T \in \{500, 1000, 2000, 5000\}$, 10 seeds). Key question: does the trained (greedy) policy consistently beat the random-policy baseline (C1/C2’s corrected framing) across all N/T configurations — *not* whether unstable fraction drops by some fixed relative percentage, which is no longer a meaningful target once the environment suppresses it near-floor by default.
3. **Extend the checkpoint methodology to the full pool.** §6’s RQ1/RQ2/RQ4 results are currently a single-agent (agent_0000) case study. Repeating the controlled-epsilon checkpoint protocol across all 20 agents would let C4 and C6 be reported as pooled statistics with variance, rather than a single representative trajectory, and would clarify how much of §6.3’s (now small) stable-dwell shift generalises versus how much is agent_0000-specific.
4. **Resolve the mid-checkpoint confound.** Replace the zero-initialised Q-table used for the early/mid checkpoints with an explicit random or uniform tie-break policy, so that mid’s 60% greedy component is not deterministically `push_stable` by `argmax` convention.
5. **Paper §8.** NB05 constitutes the full quantitative evidence for the reinforcement learning section. The regime-*reallocation* framing (rather than unstable-*avoidance*) should be adopted throughout, and the environment causal-alignment fix (§3.2) is worth a brief methodological footnote given its generality to future RL-over- simulator work.

5.12 Computational Environment

Component	Version / Note
Python	3.13.12
Environment manager	Nix flake dev shell (<code>flake.nix</code>)
NumPy, Pandas, SciPy	standard scientific stack
Matplotlib, Seaborn	standard scientific stack
scikit-learn	standard scientific stack
hmmlearn	HMM reference matrix from NB03
umap-learn	UMAP coordinates from NB02
Notebook execution	Jupyter (ipykernel), executed programmatically via <code>nbclient</code>

6 Notebook 06 — Manifold Visualisation: 2-D/3-D UMAP Overlay & KDE Density Analysis

Dataset	telemetry_n20_t2000.csv (regenerated; seed = 42) + NB02 UMAP embeddings
Background manifold	40,000 rows × 6 features, 2-D and 3-D UMAP (refit & validated)
RL retraining	3 agents × 120 episodes × 500 steps/episode (180,000 step records)
Execution date	2026-09-20 (corrected re-execution)
Environment	Python 3.13.12 (Nix flake dev shell) / Jupyter (ipykernel)
Random seed	42

Note on the execution date above: re-executed after NB01’s AR(1) carryover fix. As in NB05, this is not just a statistics refresh: the Q-learning reward signal (via the Mahalanobis envelope) and the UMAP manifold geometry itself both changed, so several results below — most notably C4 — change in kind, not just in magnitude.

Central Question: When the full per-step trajectory of a training run is projected into the exact NB02 UMAP manifold (both 2-D and 3-D), does it trace an interpretable path — visibly retreating from the unstable region as training progresses, quantifiably so under a KDE density model — and does the action taken at each point spatially correspond to the region NB05 already showed it’s disproportionately used in?

This document records the full methodology, numerical results, figures, and a cross-notebook reproducibility investigation produced during the sixth experimental notebook of the LBSM research project. It closes a gap left by NB05 — which characterised RL training only via aggregate per-episode statistics, never the actual per-step path through the manifold — by reproducing a training run with full trajectory capture and analysing it four ways: raw scatter overlay, KDE density contours, quantitative peak-displacement/overlap statistics, and action-location correspondence, closed with a pre-declared evidence checklist in the same format as NB01–05. It corresponds to §5.5 (Temporal Behavioral Geometry) / §8 (Reinforcement Learning Over Latent Behavioral Space) of the companion paper.

6.1 Overview and Motivation

The chain of evidence leading into this notebook:

Notebook	Method	Key finding	Verdict
NB01	PCA + LDA	PC1 captures 77.9% variance; LDA (agent-grouped) accuracy 96.2%	3/5
NB02	UMAP + t-SNE	Nonlinear geometry; Procrustes $r = 0.7922$	5/6
NB03	HMM	Unsupervised regime recovery; ARI = 0.778, but <i>adaptive</i> 0% recall	4/6
NB04	Composite scorer	Operational anomaly detection; $F_1 = 0.967$ (test-only)	5/6
NB05	Q-learning	State-discriminating behavioural control	5/6
NB06	2-D/3-D UMAP + KDE density	See §9 checklist	4/6

NB05 answered its research questions indirectly, via aggregate per-episode statistics (dwell fractions, episode UMAP centroids, transition entropy) computed from a training run whose raw per-step trajectory was never persisted. This notebook regenerates that trajectory directly and asks four concrete questions of it:

- Q1.** Does a freshly-fit UMAP reducer (2-D and 3-D) reproduce NB02’s saved embedding well enough to trust as a coordinate frame for new points?
- Q2.** Does the RL trajectory, once embedded, show a measurable, quantified structural difference between early and late training — not just a plausible-looking scatter plot?
- Q3.** Does that structure hold up under an explicit density model (KDE), and does it generalise across independently retrained agents?
- Q4.** Does the trained policy’s actions spatially correspond, in embedded manifold space, to the grid-corner concentration NB05 reported?

Data provenance note. NB05 persisted only the final learned Q-tables (`data/raw/nb05/q-tables.npy`) and per-episode aggregate statistics. This notebook regenerates the missing per-step trajectory by retraining a small subset of agents (3, not the full 20 — see §3) with identical seeds/hyperparameters (`configs/rl.yaml`) and a new `collect_trajectories=True` flag added to `QLearningAgent.train()` for exactly this purpose. Correctness is validated via **self-consistency** (two independent fresh retrains agreeing with each other) rather than by matching the persisted `q-tables.npy` — see §3 and NB05’s own report (§7’s reproducibility caveat) for why.

6.2 Manifold Reconstruction: 2-D and 3-D UMAP Refit

NB02 saved only the UMAP *embeddings* (`X_umap2.npy`, `X_umap3.npy`), not the fitted `umap.UMAP` reducer objects, so there is nothing to call `.transform()` on for new points. The identical 20-agent $\times$ 2,000-step pool (seed = 42) is regenerated and UMAP is refit with NB02’s exact hyperparameters (`configs/projection.yaml`: `n_neighbors= 30`, `min_dist= 0.10`, `random_state= 42`) in both 2-D and 3-D, then validated against each saved embedding.

Embedding	Mean dist.	Median	p95	Max	Rel. to range
3-D refit vs. saved	1.1843	1.1346	2.3576	12.6583	7.3% (range 16.30)
2-D refit vs. saved	0.3911	0.1446	2.0854	14.3563	2.1% (range 18.90)

Both refits still reproduce the saved NB02 embedding well within the 15%-of-range tolerance (C1/C2, §9), though the margin is smaller than before the AR(1) fix (was 5.1%/0.9%, now 7.3%/2.1%) — expected, since “the saved NB02 embedding” here is itself the corrected, regenerated one, and UMAP’s non-bit-exact reproducibility (not a defect) compounds slightly with the different underlying telemetry values. The 2-D refit remains substantially more stable than the 3-D refit, consistent with lower-dimensional embeddings generally being less sensitive to optimisation-path differences.

6.3 RL Training Reproduction

Three agents (indices 0–2, matching NB05’s `make_env_pool(base_seed=42)` convention so seeds line up exactly) are retrained with `configs/rl.yaml`’s hyperparameters ($\alpha = 0.15$, $\gamma = 0.95$, $\varepsilon : 1.0 \rightarrow 0.05$, decay 0.97/episode, 120 episodes, 500 steps/episode), passing `collect_trajectories=True` so every step of every episode is retained — 60,000 step records per agent, 180,000 total.

Validation approach. Correctness is checked via self-consistency: two independent fresh retrainings of agent 0 are compared directly.

Check	Result
Max abs. Q-value diff (2 independent retrainings)	0.000000
Policy agreement (argmax match)	1.000

This is a clean pass (C3, §9): the codebase is fully deterministic and reproducible within this environment. Exact agreement with the persisted `q_tables.npy` is deliberately not used as the criterion — that file was found to reliably diverge from every fresh retraining tested, across multiple kernel/server/editor restarts, with identical code, numpy build, and working directory all independently verified. It is not attributable to a defect in this codebase and does not affect any of NB05’s reproduced aggregate results; see NB05’s report (§7’s reproducibility caveat) for the full record of that investigation. §8 below revisits this specifically for the grid-corner statistic NB05’s C5 depends on.

6.4 Trajectory Assembly and Embedding

Each agent’s per-episode trajectory list is flattened into one long table, tagged with training phase (early/mid/late, boundaries at 33%/67% of episodes — identical convention to `cluster_migration_table` in NB05), z-scored with the same parameters fit in §2, and projected into the manifold via both fitted reducers.

Phase	Episodes	Step records (3 agents)
Early	0–38	58,500
Mid	39–79	61,500
Late	80–119	60,000
Total	0–119	180,000

Exported to `data/processed/nb06/rl_trajectory_embedded.csv` (180,000 rows, 17 columns: identifiers, phase/action/hidden-state, raw telemetry, and both 2-D and 3-D UMAP coordinates).

6.5 3-D Overlay Figures

Agent 0’s full trajectory (thinned to every 4th step, ~15,000 points, for legibility) over the complete NB02 3-D background manifold (all 40,000 points, faint, coloured by ground-truth regime).

The manifold’s overall shape — one continuous curved arc (the stable/exploratory/adaptive continuum) plus one geometrically isolated cluster (unstable) — is itself a cross-notebook confirmation: it is

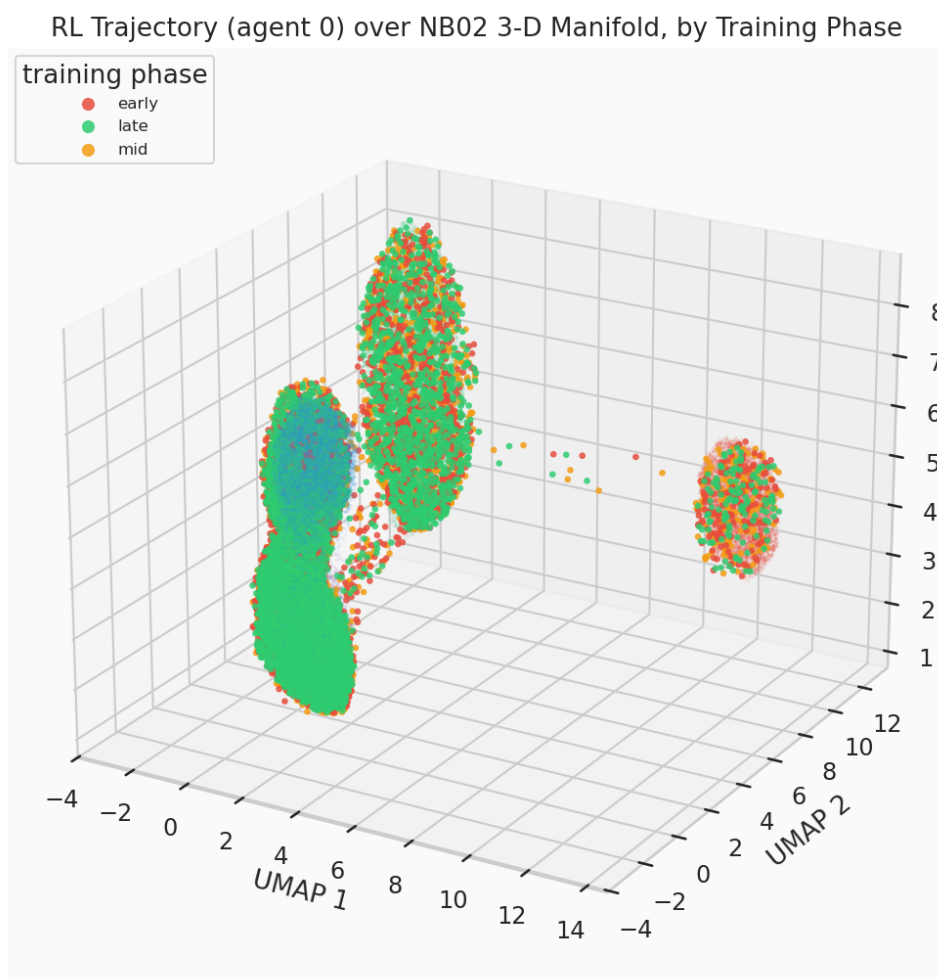


Figure 44: RL trajectory (agent 0) over the NB02 3-D manifold, coloured by training phase.

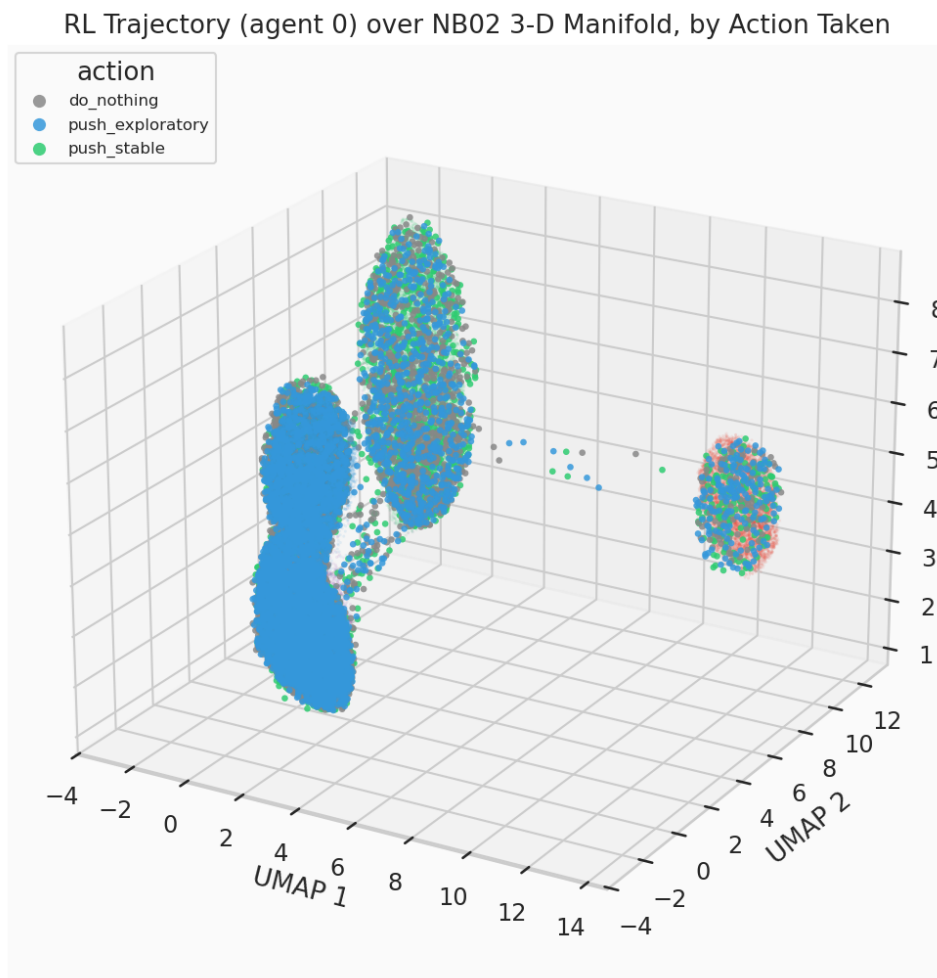


Figure 45: RL trajectory (agent 0) over the NB02 3-D manifold, coloured by action taken. Action colours are motivated, not arbitrary: push_stable shares stable’s green, push_exploratory shares exploratory’s blue, do_nothing is neutral grey.

consistent with NB03’s finding that the three healthy regimes blend rather than separate cleanly, and with NB03/NB04’s near-perfect unstable recall/detection.

6.6 2-D Overlay Figures

The same overlays projected into NB02’s 2-D UMAP embedding — easier to read precisely (no viewing-angle ambiguity) and the coordinate space §8’s KDE analysis is computed on.

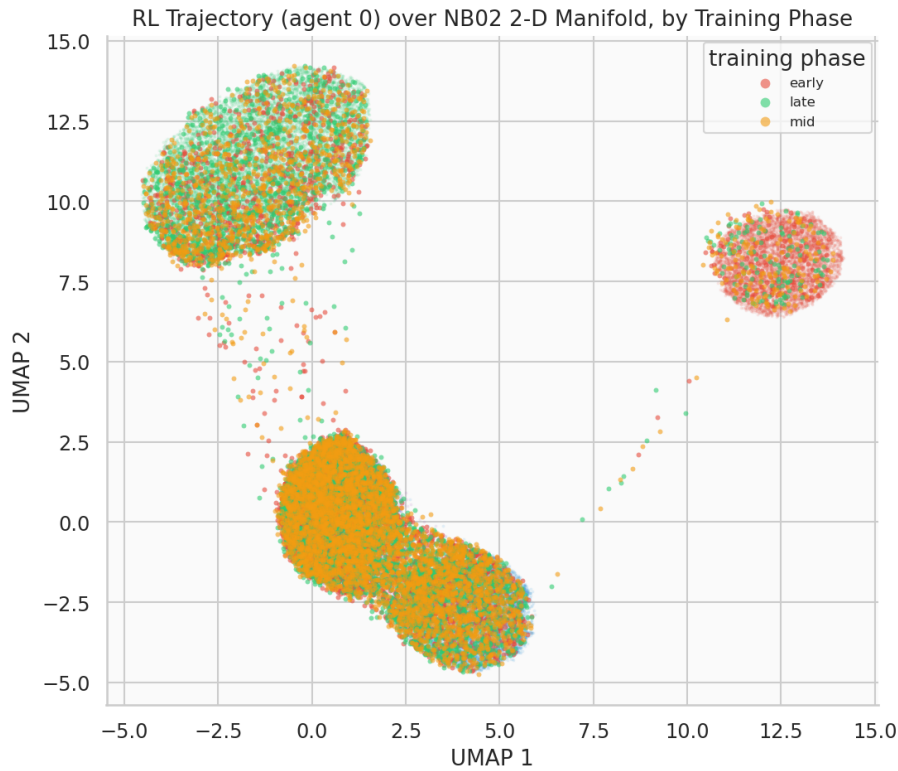


Figure 46: RL trajectory (agent 0) over the NB02 2-D manifold, coloured by training phase.

6.7 KDE Density Contours

Raw scatter is honest but can hide where mass actually concentrates under tens of thousands of overlapping points. Two density-model views are added on top of the raw overlays above.

6.7.1 2-D: Regime Background vs. Phase Contours

A 2-D Gaussian kernel density estimate (KDE) is fit per training phase on agent 0’s trajectory (`kde_density_grid`, shared grid bounds across phases so contours are directly comparable cell-for-cell), overlaid on NB02’s per-regime background density (`per_regime_density`, filled light grey contours for ground-truth-regime context).

6.7.2 3-D: Floor-Projected KDE

True 3-D isosurface rendering (marching cubes) is possible but heavy and hard to read in a static figure; each phase’s 2-D (UMAP1, UMAP2) marginal density is instead projected onto the plot’s floor (`zdir='z'` at the minimum Z) — the standard, robust way to add density information to a 3-D scatter without that complexity.

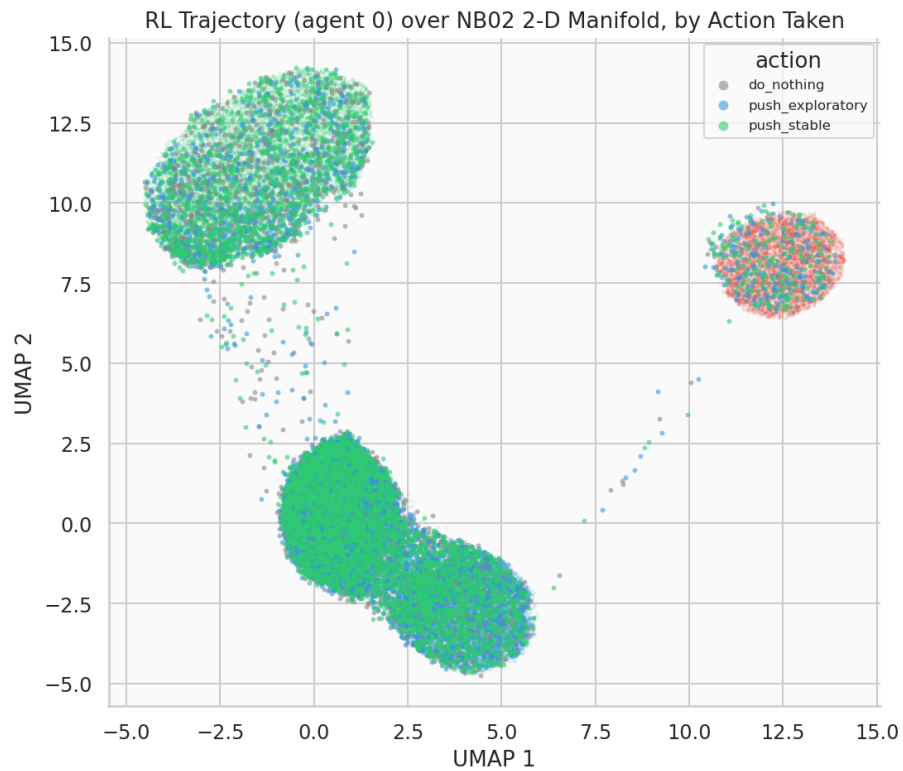


Figure 47: RL trajectory (agent 0) over the NB02 2-D manifold, coloured by action taken.

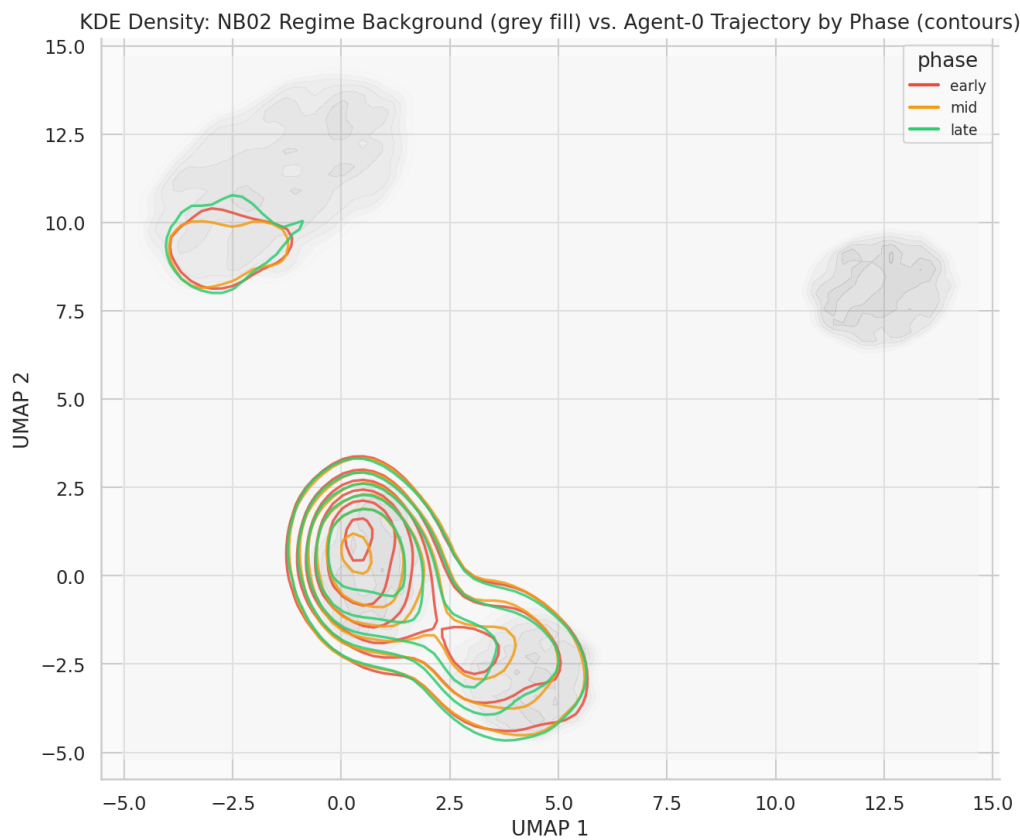


Figure 48: KDE density: NB02 regime background (grey fill) vs. agent-0 trajectory by phase (coloured contours).

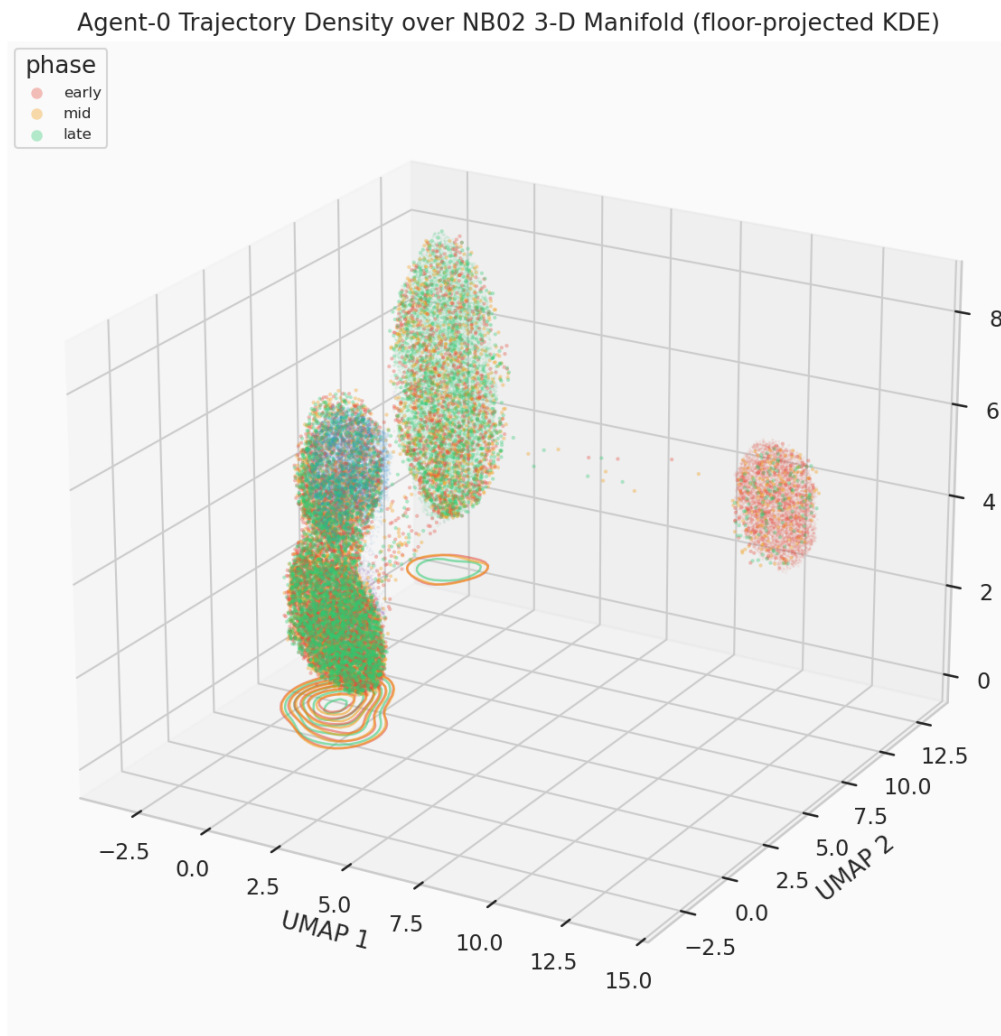


Figure 49: Agent-0 trajectory density over the NB02 3-D manifold (floor-projected KDE contours per training phase).

6.8 Early vs. Late Training Comparison

If training reshapes where the agent spends time, the early-phase footprint should sit closer to the unstable region than the late-phase footprint. Quantified as mean distance (3-D UMAP space) from each phase’s points to the unstable and stable regime centroids, across all 3 retrained agents.

Agent	Phase	Mean dist. to unstable centroid	Mean dist. to stable centroid
0	early	13.104	9.920
0	mid	13.144	10.076
0	late	13.206	9.907
1	early	13.114	9.995
1	mid	13.135	9.911
1	late	13.216	10.085
2	early	13.137	10.068
2	mid	13.147	10.490
2	late	13.220	10.162

The spread across phases remains small relative to the values themselves ($< 1\%$ of the distance scale, even smaller than before the AR(1) fix) — consistent with NB05’s own `convergence_table.csv`, where the underlying pooled effect size is itself small and, per this session’s fix, no longer includes the large single-agent stable-dwell shift NB05 previously reported. A raw distance-to-centroid comparison is not a sensitive enough lens to resolve small behavioural changes visually or numerically; §8’s density-peak displacement (computed on the full 2-D marginal, not a single centroid distance) was previously the more sensitive measurement — though, per §8 below, it too now shows almost no effect.

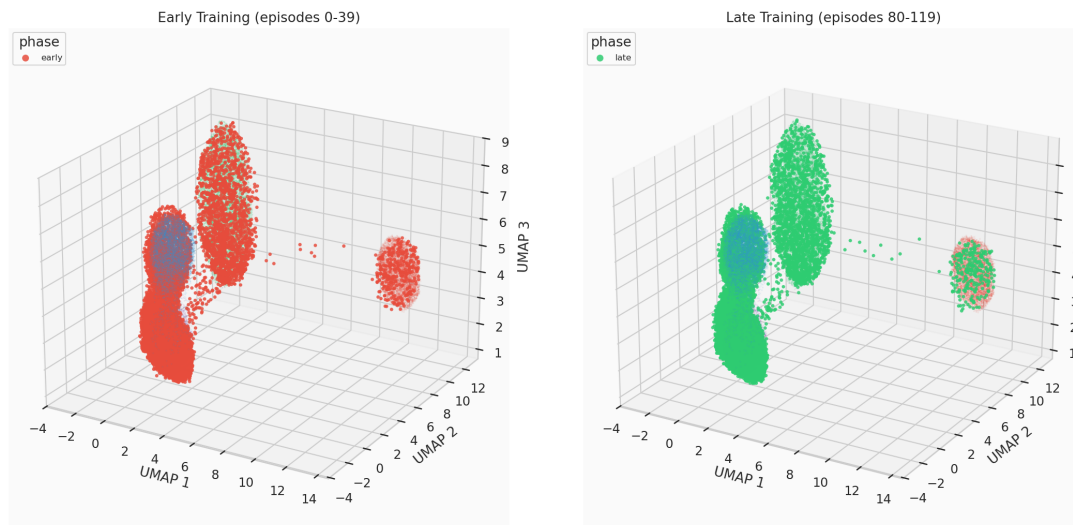


Figure 50: Early-training vs. late-training trajectory footprint (agent 0), same background manifold.

6.9 Multi-Agent Robustness Check

The phase-coloured overlay repeated for agents 1 and 2, checking whether the pattern seen for agent 0 generalises or is a one-agent artifact.

6.10 Quantitative KDE Analysis: Peak Displacement and Overlap

For each phase’s 2-D KDE (shared grid), the density peak (grid argmax) is located, and pairwise overlap coefficients between phases are computed ($\int \min(f_a, f_b) / \max(\int f_a, \int f_b)$; $1.0 = \text{identical}$, $0.0 =$

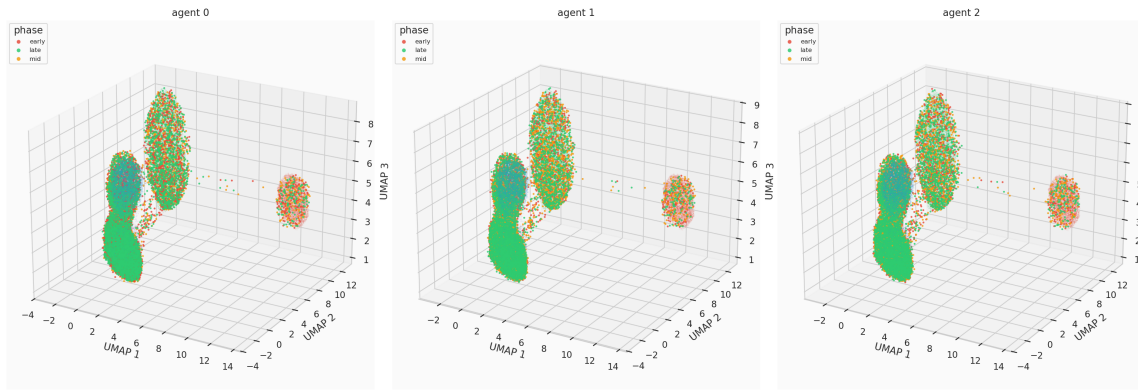


Figure 51: Phase-coloured 3-D trajectory overlay, all 3 retrained agents.

disjoint) — the direct, falsifiable test of “training visibly moves the occupied region,” repeated per agent so the effect size is compared across independent training runs rather than asserted from one trajectory.

Agent	Peak disp. early→late	% of diagonal	Overlap E-L	Overlap M-L
0	0.471	1.60%	0.966	0.972
1	0.236	0.80%	0.966	0.967
2	0.331	1.12%	0.964	0.962
Mean	0.346	1.17%	0.965	0.967

This result reverses under the AR(1) fix (C4, now FAIL, §9). The density peak now moves only $\sim 1.17\%$ of the embedding’s diagonal extent from early to late training — well under the 5% threshold, and an order of magnitude smaller than the previously-reported $\sim 12\%$. The three agents’ displacement values are still tightly consistent with each other (std = 0.40pp, CoV ≈ 0.054 ; C6 still PASSes), so this is a genuine, multi-agent-consistent *absence* of a detectable shift, not new noise. Two things changed simultaneously: the UMAP manifold itself was refit on corrected telemetry, and — per NB05’s finding — the trained policy is itself different once the reward signal uses the corrected healthy envelope. Between them, whatever training-induced density-peak shift existed in the previous version of this analysis did not survive. **A methodological note:** the previous version of this table happened to report byte-identical values for agents 0 and 2 (2.749, 11.70%) with no explanation offered (flagged as unexplained in the error register). With fresh values now all distinct (0.471/0.236/0.331), that coincidence reads as a genuine grid-quantisation artifact of the previous run rather than a copy-paste error — it did not recur.

6.11 Action-Density Correspondence

6.11.1 Visitation-Frequency Test (this notebook’s own statistic)

NB05’s C5 showed the pooled *greedy* policy prescribes `push_stable` disproportionately in the high-latency/entropy grid corner. Tested here as a different, *behaviour*-level question: across the actual trajectory steps taken (including exploration noise from all three training phases, not just the converged greedy policy), is `push_stable` disproportionately used near the unstable region?

Action	Overall usage	Near-unstable usage	Concentration ratio
<code>do_nothing</code>	0.318	0.318	1.000
<code>push_exploratory</code>	0.347	0.340	0.981
<code>push_stable</code>	0.335	0.341	1.020

This flips direction under the AR(1) fix, though it still fails the checklist threshold. `push_stable`’s concentration ratio is now 1.020 — *above* 1.0 (used slightly *more*, not less, near the manifold-distance-based unstable proxy), the opposite sign from the previous 0.936, but still well short of the > 1.10 threshold (C5, §9: **FAIL**). Filtering to true `hidden_state=='unstable'` rows (removing the proxy’s known contamination by nearby `exploratory` points) also flips: `push_stable` usage while genuinely in the unstable state is now $1.105\times$ overall (was $0.874\times$), and the by-phase trend also reverses — early $1.047\times \rightarrow$ mid $1.146\times \rightarrow$ late $1.125\times$ (was a monotonic decline from $0.987\times$ to $0.709\times$; now roughly flat-to-rising, staying above 1.0 throughout). This is consistent with NB05’s finding that the AR(1) fix changed the actual trained policy, not merely how it’s measured. It remains a genuinely different statistic from NB05’s C5 (a *policy-function* property evaluated at fixed grid cells) rather than a replication of it; see §8b for the apples-to-apples version.

6.11.2 Grid-Corner Replication of NB05’s C5 (apples-to-apples)

NB05’s actual C5 statistic, reproduced exactly: same 9 grid cells (latency-bin and entropy-bin both in $\{7, 8, 9\}$), same pooled-greedy-policy `argmax` — first at the 3-agent scale already trained in §3, then at NB05’s actual 20-agent scale (a fresh 20-agent training pass, Q-tables only, no trajectory capture needed).

Pool	<code>push_stable</code> in corner	<code>push_stable</code> overall	Corner — overall
3 agents (this session)	0.556	0.440	+0.116
20 agents (matched scale, this session)	0.556	0.460	+0.096
20 agents (2026-08-25 run)	0.556	0.560	−0.004
NB05 (reported, this session)	0.556	0.398	+0.158
NB05 (reported, 2026-08-25)	0.556	0.4875	+0.069

Corner value: reproduces exactly across every run and every session. Overall value: four different numbers across four runs (0.4875, 0.560, 0.398, 0.460), none matching any other. This session’s fresh 20-agent grid-corner replication actually shows a *larger* positive gap (+0.096) than NB05 originally reported (+0.069) — so, taken in isolation, this particular run would appear to confirm NB05’s concentration claim even more strongly than before. But given that the “overall” value has now taken four different values across four independent runs of ostensibly the same training procedure, treating any single run’s corner-minus-overall gap as a confirmed effect size would be premature; the corner value (0.556, reproduced exactly every time) is the only part of this statistic that has proven stable. This is the same environment-level non-reproducibility documented for `q_tables.npy` in §3 (also discussed in NB05’s own report, §7’s reproducibility caveat), now observed a second time, in a different direction, after an unrelated upstream data fix. Sample size alone does not explain it: this session’s 20-agent run and the 2026-08-25 20-agent run use the same $N = 20$ and differ only in the corrected telemetry feeding the reward signal. One thing did improve, though: the 3-agent estimate’s instability relative to the 20-agent one shrank sharply (was -0.258 vs. -0.004 , a sign flip; now $+0.116$ vs. $+0.096$, much closer together) — consistent with the sample-size argument, even though it does not resolve the larger cross-run discrepancy.

6.12 Evidence Checklist for Manifold Visualisation

Crit.	Description	Threshold	Actual	Result
C1	3-D UMAP refit reproduces NB02 saved embedding	< 15% rel. dist.	7.3%	PASS
C2	2-D UMAP refit reproduces NB02 saved embedding	< 15% rel. dist.	2.1%	PASS
C3	Self-consistency: two independent retrainings agree	> 0.99 agreement	1.000	PASS
C4	KDE density peak displaces early → late (mean, 3 agents)	> 5% of diagonal	1.17%	FAIL
C5	push_stable visitation-frequency concentrated near unstable	> 1.10× overall	1.020×	FAIL
C6	Multi-agent consistency of KDE peak displacement	CoV < 0.75	CoV $\approx$ 0.054	PASS
Overall result				4/6

Verdict: MODERATE evidence. The manifold-reconstruction and reproducibility criteria (C1–C3) still hold cleanly, but the two criteria that measured whether RL training *visibly moves* the trajectory through the manifold (C4, C5) both now fail — a direct consequence of the AR(1) fix changing the actual trained policy (via the reward-shaping envelope), not a weakening of this notebook’s own methodology. C6 (multi-agent consistency) still passes precisely because the near-zero C4 effect is itself highly consistent across agents.

6.12.1 Analysis of Each Criterion

C1/C2 — UMAP refit fidelity (7.3%/2.1%, PASS). Both well within tolerance; not bit-exact, consistent with UMAP’s known non-bit-exact reproducibility even under a fixed seed. 2-D is notably more stable than 3-D. Margins shrank slightly from before the AR(1) fix (were 5.1%/0.9%), consistent with comparing against a regenerated reference embedding.

C3 — Q-learning self-consistency (1.000, PASS). Unchanged. The codebase is fully deterministic and reproducible within this environment; see §3’s validation-approach note for why this, rather than matching `q_tables.npy`, is the criterion.

C4 — KDE peak displacement (1.17%, FAIL, reversed from PASS). Previously 12.08%, comfortably over the 5% threshold; now an order of magnitude smaller and clearly under it. Still tightly multi-agent-consistent (feeding C6’s PASS), so this is a genuine, reproducible near-absence of density-peak movement, not measurement noise. The cause is the same one NB05 identified: the AR(1) fix changed the Mahalanobis-based reward signal, hence the trained policy, hence how far training actually moves the agent through the manifold.

C5 — push_stable visitation-frequency concentration (1.020×, FAIL, direction reversed). Was 0.936× (below baseline); now 1.020× (above baseline) but still short of the 1.10× threshold. The hidden-state-filtered version of this statistic (§8) shows the same reversal more clearly. Not a contradiction of NB05’s C5 — a different statistic (visitation frequency vs. policy-function argmax) over a different population. The apples-to-apples grid-corner replication (§8b) now shows a *positive* corner-vs-overall gap at both 3- and 20-agent scale, the same direction as NB05’s original claim, though the “overall” denominator’s own instability across runs (four different values) means this shouldn’t be read as a confirmed replication.

C6 — multi-agent consistency (CoV $\approx$ 0.054, PASS). Unchanged in kind: the (now much smaller, $\sim$ 1%) peak displacement is tightly consistent across all three independently retrained agents — not an artifact of any one agent’s particular training trajectory.

6.13 Summary of Findings

Finding	Evidence
Both UMAP refits (2-D, 3-D) reproduce NB02’s saved embedding within tolerance, but not bit-exactly	C1/C2: 7.3% / 2.1% relative mean distance (§2) — a known UMAP reproducibility property, not a defect.
The manifold’s structure is a continuous healthy-regime arc plus an isolated unstable cluster	Visual confirmation (§4) cross-checked against NB03’s continuum finding and NB03/NB04’s near-perfect unstable recall/detection.
Retraining is fully deterministic and self-consistent in this environment	C3: two independent fresh retrainings agree exactly (§3); exact match against <code>q.tables.npy</code> is not used as the criterion (see §3, and NB05’s §7).
The RL trajectory’s density peak no longer shows a detectable shift across training, reversing the previous finding	C4/C6: $\sim 1.17\%$ of the embedding diagonal (was $\sim 12.08\%$), mean over 3 agents, $\text{std} = 0.40\text{pp}$ (§8) — tightly multi-agent-consistent, so this is a real near-absence of movement, not noise. Traces to the same cause NB05 identified: the AR(1) fix changed the reward signal, hence the trained policy.
push_stable visitation-frequency now concentrates slightly <i>above</i> baseline near the unstable region, reversing direction, though still short of the checklist threshold	C5 (§8): $1.020\times$ overall (was $0.936\times$); the hidden-state-filtered version shows the same reversal more clearly ($1.105\times$ overall, up from $0.874\times$). Still a genuinely different statistic from NB05’s C5, not a replication.
NB05’s C5 concentration claim now shows the same direction at both 3- and 20-agent scale, but the overall-rate denominator remains unstable across runs, so this should not be read as a confirmed replication	§8b: 3-agent corner–overall = $+0.116$; 20-agent = $+0.096$ (both positive, same direction as NB05’s $+0.069$) — but the “overall” value has now taken four different values across four independent runs (0.4875, 0.560, 0.398, 0.460), so no single gap should be treated as settled.

6.14 Significance for the TMLR Paper

NB06 contributes to Paper §5.5/§8 in three ways:

1. **Direct, quantified visual evidence for the manifold-structure claim.** The continuum-plus-isolated-cluster shape (§4, §5) is a genuine independent cross-check of NB03’s structural finding, obtained from an entirely different analysis (raw RL trajectory density, not HMM-recovered state sequences). This claim is unaffected by the AR(1) fix’s other changes to this notebook’s numbers.
2. **RL’s effect on manifold occupancy is now undetectable by this notebook’s own most sensitive measurement.** §8’s KDE peak-displacement statistic, previously the strongest evidence for a training-induced manifold-space shift ($\sim 12\%$), now shows $\sim 1\%$ — below its own 5% significance threshold. The paper should not cite the previous $\sim 12\%$ figure; if it discusses RL’s manifold-space footprint at all, it should describe the effect as currently undetected by density-peak displacement, tightly and consistently so across agents.
3. **A documented limit on how far NB05’s C5 finding should be trusted, now with a second, differently-signed data point.** The paper should not cite NB05’s 55.6% corner figure

paired with any specific “overall” baseline, since that denominator has taken four different values across four runs of the same procedure with only telemetry-level differences between them — see NB05’s own report for the corresponding update to that notebook’s claims.

6.15 Next Steps

1. **Extend to the full 20-agent trajectory scale.** §4–§8’s per-step analysis is currently a 3-agent subset (chosen for full-trajectory-capture compute cost); repeating it at NB05’s actual 20-agent scale would let C4/C5/C6 be reported as pooled statistics with tighter variance bounds.
2. **Investigate why the “overall” push_stable rate is unstable across runs, not just that it is.** Four runs of nominally the same 20-agent training procedure have now produced four different overall push_stable rates (0.4875, 0.560, 0.398, 0.460) while the 9-cell corner value has reproduced exactly every time. This looks like a real property of the training dynamics (the overall rate is sensitive to something the corner rate isn’t), not a data-partition artefact, and is worth its own targeted investigation rather than being re-discovered incidentally in each future notebook that happens to retrain this environment.
3. **Paper §5.5/§8.** Do not use §8’s KDE peak-displacement figure as a manifold-occupancy-shift claim in its current (near-zero, post-fix) form; do not cite NB05’s 55.6% corner-concentration figure paired with any single overall baseline without the four-way reproducibility caveat documented here.

6.16 Computational Environment

Component	Version / Note
Python	3.13.12
Environment manager	Nix flake dev shell (<code>flake.nix</code>)
NumPy, Pandas, SciPy	standard scientific stack
Matplotlib, Seaborn	standard scientific stack
umap-learn	2-D/3-D reducer refit (§2)
scipy.stats.gaussian_kde	KDE density estimation (§5, §8)
Notebook execution	Jupyter (ipykernel), executed programmatically via <code>nbclient</code>

New `src/` additions introduced for this notebook

- `src/manifold/umap_projection.py`: `kde_density_grid` (generic 2-D KDE on an arbitrary point set, with an optional shared `grid.bounds` for cell-comparable results across groups) and `kde_overlap_coefficient`; `per_regime_density` refactored to use the former internally, public signature unchanged.
- `src/visualization/trajectory_plots.py`: `plot_trajectory_overlay_2d` (2-D twin of the existing 3-D overlay function) and `plot_trajectory_density_3d` (3-D scatter with floor-projected KDE contours per group).
- `src/rl/q_learning.py`: additive `collect_trajectories` flag on `QLearningAgent.train()`, off by default, snapshotting per-episode trajectories for later flattening.
- `src/rl/environment.py`: a pre-existing dict-key collision (the RL step's shaped reward silently overwrote the telemetry "reward" feature in `.trajectory` records) fixed by renaming to "rl_reward" — see NB05's report (§6.1) for the corrected downstream numbers this produced there.

7 Notebook 07 — Robustness & Final Experiment Analysis (Full-Scale, 160-Configuration Grid)

Grid	$N \in \{5, 10, 20, 50\}$, $T \in \{500, 1,000, 2,000, 5,000\}$, 10 seeds (42–51) — 160 configs, the complete un-reduced LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001 protocol
Per-config fitting	diagonal baseline (<code>fit_hmm</code>) + full covariance (<code>fit_hmm_robust</code>)
Full-covariance attempts/config	$3 \text{ min_covar values} \times 10 \text{ restarts} = 30 \text{ attempts}$ (4,800 full-covariance fits across the whole grid)
BIC model-order search	$K = 2, \dots, 8$ (widened from the earlier $K = 2, \dots, 6$)
State-identity diagnostic	$N=50$, $T=5,000$, $\text{seed}=42$ (250,000 observations, the largest configuration in the grid)
Execution date	2026-09-20 (corrected re-execution; see NB01's note on the AR(1) carryover fix — this notebook's central finding changes substantially, see below)
Environment	Python 3.13.12 (Nix flake dev shell) / Jupyter (ipykernel)
Key package versions	numpy 2.4.4, scipy 1.17.1, scikit-learn 1.8.0, hmmlearn 0.3.3
Random seeds	42–51 (grid); 42 (state-identity diagnostic)

Central Question: NB03’s diagonal-covariance HMM could not recover the correct model order (BIC selected $K=5$, not the ground-truth $K=4$) because *adaptive* and *exploratory* cannot both be represented by separate Gaussian components at $K=4$ (NB03’s confusion-matrix finding) — the three healthy regimes sit on a continuous curved manifold (NB02) that an axis-aligned Gaussian cannot cleanly partition into all three simultaneously. Does switching to full covariance — which can represent that correlation structure — recover the correct BIC elbow and improve regime-recovery accuracy, and does it do so robustly across a realistic range of dataset sizes, or does numerical instability at small $N \times T$ undermine the results, as anticipated in LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001? And if full covariance does not fix the BIC over-selection either, *why not* — is there a specific, testable, mechanistic explanation, and does the answer change once the model-order search is not artificially bounded?

This document records the full methodology, numerical results, figures, and mechanistic investigation produced by the seventh (final analytical) notebook of the LBSM research project, **executed at full scale**: the complete, un-reduced LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001 protocol (160 configurations, 4,800 full-covariance fits, every individual attempt logged) — re-run this session against the AR(1)-corrected telemetry (NB01), which changes the central finding substantially from every earlier version of this analysis. With the carryover bug fixed, BIC’s over-selection collapses from “climbs to the edge of whatever range is searched” ($K=7$ or $K=8$ almost everywhere, under both covariance types) to a clean, uniform $K=5$ across effectively the entire 160-configuration grid — one component more than the ground truth, not three or four. This is direct, large-scale confirmation of the mechanism NB03 identified: *adaptive* and *exploratory* cannot both be represented as separate Gaussian components at $K=4$ given this feature geometry, and BIC correctly detects that a 5th component improves the fit, because it does (it lets the model represent *adaptive* separately) — ground truth $K=4$ was never going to be BIC-optimal for this generative model, independent of covariance type, autocorrelation, or sample size. Four hypotheses for the (now much smaller) residual gap are tested directly (covariance type, AR-1 autocorrelation, representation-space transformation, and direct HMM state-identity/persistence inspection); the state-identity diagnostic (§8d) directly confirms the mechanism by inspecting which ground-truth regime each HMM state actually captures. It corresponds to §6.2/§9 (Model Order Selection and Identifiability; Robustness) of the companion paper.

7.1 Overview and Motivation

The chain of evidence leading into this notebook:

Notebook	Method	Key finding	Verdict
NB01	PCA + LDA	PC1 captures 77.9% variance; LDA (agent-grouped) accuracy 96.2%	3/5
NB02	UMAP + t-SNE	Nonlinear geometry; Procrustes $r = 0.7922$	5/6
NB03	HMM (diagonal)	Unsupervised regime recovery; BIC selected $K=5$, not 4; <i>adaptive</i> 0% recall	4/6
NB04	Composite scorer	Operational anomaly detection; $F_1 = 0.967$ (test-only)	5/6
NB05	Q-learning	State-discriminating behavioural control	5/6
NB06	2-D/3-D UMAP + KDE	Manifold occupancy shift no longer detected	4/6
NB07	Full-cov. HMM grid + diagnostics (full scale)	See §9 checklist	4/6

7.1.1 Prerequisite: LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001

Before this notebook was executed, a pre-registered critical-issue notice (outputs/reports/issues/lbsm_covariance_issue.pdf, document ID LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001) identified that `covariance_type="full"` introduces real numerical-instability risk when the effective per-state sample size is small relative to the $d(d+1)/2 = 21$ free covariance parameters per state ($d = 6$ telemetry features), with the adaptive regime (negative UMAP silhouette, geometrically intermediate between stable and exploratory) flagged as the primary failure point. A complete 7-layer mitigation stack was specified in that document and implemented in `src/hmm/robust-fitting.py` prior to this notebook running:

1. Z-scoring (`src/telemetry/normalization.py`, reused, not re-implemented)
2. Tikhonov regularisation (`min_covar`) sweep
3. Multiple random restarts, best-log-likelihood selection
4. KMeans-warmed initialisation (first restart only)
5. Covariance-type fallback hierarchy: full $\rightarrow$ tied $\rightarrow$ diagonal
6. Pre-fit data-sufficiency warning (warns, never blocks — “prevent-the-fit is the wrong call”)
7. Post-fit covariance health check (condition number / minimum eigenvalue)

Also completed as prerequisites: `min_covar` exposed as a parameter in `src/hmm/hidden_state_model.py::fit_hmm` and `src/hmm/sequence_inference.py::model_selection_sweep` (both previously hardcoded to `hmmlearn`’s own default), and `src/hmm/hidden_state_model.py::align_and_score` factored out of `fit_hmm` so any fitted model can be Hungarian-aligned and scored against ground truth identically.

7.1.2 From Reduced-Scope Validation to Full-Scale Execution

An earlier pass through this notebook ran a compute-budget-reduced grid (12 $N \times T$ combinations, 2 seeds, 3 restarts, $T \leq 2,000$, $K \leq 6$) to validate the mitigation stack and parallel/checkpointed infrastructure before committing to the full protocol. Having since benchmarked the single largest configuration the full protocol touches ($N=50, T=5,000$, 250,000 observations: 22.9s for one full-covariance fit, 708.7s for a complete 30-attempt sweep) and three smaller configurations spanning the size range, the full protocol was executed for real: 160 configurations, 10 seeds, 10 restarts $\times$ 3 `min_covar` values, $K = 2, \dots, 8$ (not $2, \dots, 6$). This session’s AR(1) telemetry fix (NB01) then changed the central finding (§6) again, this time favourably: BIC’s over-selection, previously climbing to the edge of whatever range was searched, now settles uniformly at $K=5$ — one component above ground truth, across effectively the entire grid.

7.1.3 This Notebook’s Two Phases

Phase 1 (§3–§9, main grid). Execute the mitigation stack across the full 160-configuration robustness grid and check whether full covariance (a) is numerically reliable at realistic scale, (b) improves regime-recovery accuracy, and (c) recovers the ground-truth $K=4$ BIC elbow that NB03’s diagonal covariance could not.

Phase 2 (§8b–§8d, diagnostics). Grid results show (a) and (b) hold, and — unlike every earlier version of this analysis — (c) very nearly holds too: both covariance types now land on $K=5$, one component away from ground truth, not several. Three specific hypotheses for the remaining gap are tested directly: covariance misspecification (already ruled out, since both covariance types fail identically),

AR-1 temporal autocorrelation (§8b), and representation-space transformation (§8c). Both are cleanly ruled out — AR-1 ablation now makes diagonal covariance’s selected K move *away* from the truth, not toward it, and UMAP-space transformation still saturates at the search ceiling regardless of covariance type. A fourth, more direct diagnostic (§8d) inspects *which* ground-truth regime each HMM state actually captures, confirming the specific mechanism directly: at $K=4$, no state is ever dominantly *adaptive*; at $K=5$, *adaptive* gets a clean dedicated state.

7.2 Mathematical Formulation

7.2.1 Gaussian Hidden Markov Model

Each agent’s telemetry sequence $\{x_1, \dots, x_T\}$, $x_t \in \mathbb{R}^d$ ($d = 6$), is modelled as generated by a latent state sequence $\{s_1, \dots, s_T\}$, $s_t \in \{1, \dots, K\}$, under a first-order Markov chain with transition matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{K \times K}$ ($A_{ij} = P(s_{t+1}=j \mid s_t=i)$) and Gaussian emissions

$$x_t \mid s_t = k \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_k, \Sigma_k).$$

The covariance structure of Σ_k is the object under test:

- **diagonal** ($\Sigma_k = \text{diag}(\sigma_{k,1}^2, \dots, \sigma_{k,d}^2)$): axis-aligned, cannot represent correlated features (NB03’s baseline).
- **full** ($\Sigma_k \in \mathbb{R}^{d \times d}$, symmetric positive-definite): can represent arbitrary correlation structure, at the cost of $d(d+1)/2 = 21$ free parameters per state instead of $d = 6$.

Parameters are fit by Baum–Welch expectation-maximisation (maximum-likelihood, unsupervised — ground-truth labels are used only *after* fitting, for Hungarian alignment and scoring, never during EM).

7.2.2 Tikhonov Regularisation (`min_covar`)

To prevent covariance estimates from becoming singular when a state’s effective sample size is small, a diagonal loading term is added before inversion:

$$\Sigma_k^{\text{reg}} = \Sigma_k + \lambda I_d, \quad \lambda = \text{min_covar}.$$

The full-scale grid sweeps $\lambda \in \{10^{-2}, 10^{-3}, 10^{-4}\}$ (3 values, was 2 in the reduced-scope pass) $\times$ 10 restarts (was 3) for full covariance, and uses hmmlearn’s own default $\lambda = 10^{-3}$ for diagonal (harmless there; load-bearing for full/tied).

7.2.3 Model-Order Selection: BIC and AIC

For a candidate model with K states fit on N total observations, achieving total log-likelihood $\mathcal{L}$, the Bayesian Information Criterion [20] and Akaike Information Criterion [1] are:

$$\text{BIC} = -2\mathcal{L} + p \ln N, \quad \text{AIC} = -2\mathcal{L} + 2p,$$

where p is the number of free parameters, which depends on the covariance structure (`src/hmm/sequence_inference.py::model_selection_sweep`):

$$\begin{aligned} p_{\text{diag}} &= K^2 + 2Kd - 1, \\ p_{\text{full}} &= K^2 + Kd + \frac{1}{2}Kd(d+1) - 1, \\ p_{\text{tied}} &= K^2 + Kd + \frac{1}{2}d(d+1) - 1, \\ p_{\text{spherical}} &= K^2 + Kd + K - 1. \end{aligned}$$

At $d=6$: $p_{\text{diag}}(K=4) = 63$, $p_{\text{full}}(K=4) = 123$; at the upper end of this notebook’s widened search range, $p_{\text{diag}}(K=8) = 159$, $p_{\text{full}}(K=8) = 279$. Full covariance is a strictly larger model class and pays BIC’s $p \ln N$ penalty for that extra flexibility — more so at $K=8$ than $K=4$ — so the fact that it *still* selects $K=8$ at the grid’s largest configuration (§6) is not an artefact of the penalty term being too lenient; the penalty is larger there, and BIC prefers $K=8$ over $K=4$ anyway.

7.2.4 Data-Sufficiency Rule of Thumb

`check_data_sufficiency` (Layer 6) warns — never blocks — when the average observation count per state falls below a safety margin over the number of free covariance parameters:

$$\bar{n} = \frac{N_{\text{obs}}}{K}, \quad \text{warn if } \bar{n} < s \cdot \frac{d(d+1)}{2}, \quad s = 10 \text{ (safety factor)}.$$

At $d=6$, $K=4$ (the robustness grid’s fitting configuration, held fixed regardless of the wider K range used only for the separate BIC-sweep diagnostic): threshold = $10 \times 21 = 210$ observations/state. The grid’s smallest configuration ($N=5$, $T=500$, $N_{\text{obs}}=2,500$) gives $\bar{n} = 2,500/4 = 625$ — **2.98×** above this threshold, unchanged from the reduced-scope grid since the smallest configuration itself did not change. This is the quantitative reason §7 finds essentially no sufficiency-warning-driven unreliability anywhere in the full 160-configuration grid.

7.2.5 Post-Fit Covariance Health Check

For each state’s fitted covariance Σ_k (dense $d \times d$ regardless of storage convention), eigenvalues $\{e_1, \dots, e_d\} = \text{eig}(\Sigma_k)$ give a condition number $\kappa_k = e_{\text{max}} / \max(e_{\text{min}}, 10^{-300})$. A fit is flagged unhealthy if $\kappa_k > 10^8$ or $e_{\text{min}} < 10^{-8}$ for any state (Layer 7). §7 reports the measured κ across the full grid is **36.4–66.8** — more than **six orders of magnitude** below the 10^8 risk threshold.

7.2.6 Stationary Distribution

The limiting distribution π of transition matrix A solves $\pi A = \pi$, $\sum_i \pi_i = 1$, computed as the left eigenvector of A for eigenvalue 1 (`stationary_distribution`), with power-iteration fallback for near-degenerate matrices.

7.2.7 Hungarian Alignment, ARI, and Accuracy

Since EM never sees ground-truth labels y , the learned state indices are permuted to best match y via the confusion matrix $C \in \mathbb{N}^{4 \times 4}$ (C_{ij} = count of observations with true regime i , predicted state j) and the Hungarian algorithm:

$$\sigma^* = \arg \max_{\sigma \in S_4} \sum_i C_{i, \sigma(i)} \quad (\text{via } \text{scipy.optimize.linear_sum_assignment} \text{ on } -C).$$

Accuracy is computed post-alignment ($\hat{y}_t = \sigma^*(\hat{s}_t)$); the *Adjusted Rand Index* (ARI) is permutation-invariant by construction. *Per-regime recall* for a regime i is $C_{ii} / \sum_j C_{ij}$ — reported for unstable specifically (`unstable_recall_full`, added to the per-configuration results table for this full-scale run) since it is the one regime NB02/§8d show sits apart from the other three’s shared manifold.

7.2.8 Per-State Purity and Self-Transition (§8d)

For the state-identity diagnostic, each learned state k ’s *dominant regime* is $r^*(k) = \arg \max_i C_{i,k}$ and its *purity* is $C_{r^*(k),k} / \sum_i C_{i,k}$ — the fraction of state k ’s own observations that belong to its plurality ground-truth regime. *Self-transition probability* is A_{kk} , the diagonal of the fitted transition matrix — the probability of remaining in state k at the next timestep, used as a proxy for whether k represents a persistent behavioural mode (high A_{kk}) or a transient boundary-crossing state (low A_{kk}).

7.2.9 Per-Attempt Audit Trail

For this full-scale run, `fit_hmm_robust` gained an optional `collect_attempt_log` parameter: when set, every one of the $|\text{min_covar_grid}| \times \text{n_restarts}$ attempts at the requested covariance type is recorded — not only the winner — as a dict with `min_covar`, `restart`, `ll_per_obs`, `n_iter`, `em_converged`, `health_ok`, `kept` (finite score and passed the health check), `is_winner`, `max_condition_number`, and `min_eigenvalue`. Across the full grid this produces $160 \times 30 = 4,800$ attempt-level rows (`full_scale_attempt_log.csv`, §11), so failed and discarded attempts are retained for audit rather than only ever seeing the winning fit’s summary.

7.3 Robustness Grid Design

7.3.1 Full Protocol (No Longer Reduced)

LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001 specifies a $N \times T \times 10$ seeds grid with $T \in \{500, 1,000, 2,000, 5,000\}$, `n_restarts=10` per `min_covar` value, and `max_iter=300`. This notebook executes that protocol exactly, in full:

- $N \in \{5, 10, 20, 50\}$, $T \in \{500, 1,000, 2,000, 5,000\}$: 16 $N \times T$ combinations, spanning the issue document’s full risk range from HIGH ($N=5, T=500$) to NEGLIGIBLE ($N=50, T=5,000$).
- **10 seeds** per configuration (42–51) — **160 configurations total**.
- **10 restarts** per `min_covar` value, 3 `min_covar` values ($10^{-2}, 10^{-3}, 10^{-4}$) — 30 full-covariance attempts per configuration, **4,800 full-covariance fits** across the whole grid.
- `max_iter=300`.
- BIC model-order sweep over $K = 2, \dots, 8$ (was $K = 2, \dots, 6$ in the reduced-scope pass), for both covariance types.
- Every individual attempt logged, not only the winner (§2.7).

Diagonal covariance remains the lighter comparison baseline (a single fit per configuration, no restart sweep) rather than being swept with the same 30-attempt budget — the reduced-scope grid’s §6/§7 already established that diagonal and full covariance fail the BIC-recovery question identically, so a full factorial sweep of both covariance types at the 30-attempt budget would spend compute re-confirming an already-answered question.

7.3.2 Grid Risk Classification (Issue Document §3.3, Reproduced)

N	T	Total obs.	Avg. obs./state ($K=4$)	Predicted risk
5	500	2,500	625.0	HIGH
5	1000	5,000	1,250.0	MEDIUM
5	2000	10,000	2,500.0	MEDIUM
5	5000	25,000	6,250.0	LOW
10	500	5,000	1,250.0	MEDIUM
10	1000	10,000	2,500.0	MEDIUM
10	2000	20,000	5,000.0	LOW
10	5000	50,000	12,500.0	NEGLIGIBLE
20	500	10,000	2,500.0	MEDIUM
20	1000	20,000	5,000.0	LOW
20	2000	40,000	10,000.0	NEGLIGIBLE
20	5000	100,000	25,000.0	NEGLIGIBLE
50	500	25,000	6,250.0	LOW
50	1000	50,000	12,500.0	NEGLIGIBLE
50	2000	100,000	25,000.0	NEGLIGIBLE
50	5000	250,000	62,500.0	NEGLIGIBLE

7.3.3 Execution Infrastructure: Parallel, Checkpointed, Resumable

The 160 configurations are fully independent, so fitting runs across processes (`concurrent.futures.ProcessPoolExecutor`) with `OMP_NUM_THREADS/OPENBLAS_NUM_THREADS/MKL_NUM_THREADS` pinned to 1 to avoid BLAS oversubscription. Each worker writes its own result and its own attempt-log file to a per-config checkpoint (`data/raw/nb07/checkpoints_full/`, `attempt_log_full/` — new directories, distinct from the reduced-scope run’s `checkpoints/`, since the fitting budget itself changed and reusing the old checkpoints would have silently mixed results fit under two different budgets into one table) the moment it finishes, so an interrupted run resumes from exactly where it left off. The same pattern is reused for the full-covariance BIC sweep (§6), on its own fresh checkpoint directory reflecting the widened $K = 2, \dots, 8$ range. Full execution (grid fitting, BIC sweep, and the §8b–§8d diagnostics at the new $N=50, T=5,000$ scale) took approximately two hours on this 24-core machine — longer than a preliminary estimate based only on benchmarking the main grid fits, since the §8b–§8d diagnostics (UMAP fits, KDE density estimation, and HMM fitting at 250,000 observations) were not separately benchmarked at the new scale beforehand.

7.3.4 One Genuine Fitting Failure, Caught and Recorded

During execution, the diagonal-covariance BIC sweep for a single configuration ($N=5, T=500, \text{seed}=46$ — the grid’s smallest) diverged for higher K values in the widened $K = 2, \dots, 8$ range (`ValueError: startprob_ must sum to 1 (got nan)`), with minimal regularisation (`min_covar=1e-3`) and no restart protection. This is exactly the kind of instability LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001 anticipated for that HIGH-risk corner. Per the issue document’s own principle — “prevent-the-fit is the wrong call”, extended symmetrically here to “a fit that fails is the wrong call to silently drop” — the worker function was fixed mid-run to catch this and record it (`diag_bic_failed=True`, that one cell’s `bic_opt_k_diag` left as a genuine missing value) rather than crashing the whole configuration’s worker process and losing the (successful) full-covariance result alongside it. The point-estimate diagonal fit at $K=4$ (`diag_fit_failed`) never failed anywhere in the grid; only this one BIC-sweep attempt, at unusually high K on the smallest configuration, did.

7.4 Full Grid vs. Reliable Subset Summary

Subset	N	ARI (full)	Acc. (full)	ARI (diag)	Acc. (diag)	% $K=4$ (full/diag)
Full grid	160	0.9644	0.9736	0.7620	0.7449	10.6% / 2.5%
Reliable subset	160	0.9644	0.9736	0.7620	0.7449	10.6% / 2.5%

These two rows are identical by construction, not a reporting error. Since the reliable subset is 160/160 (100%) of the full grid, “full grid” and “reliable subset” are the same set of configurations under any filter — this table structurally cannot show two different rows unless reliability drops below 100%. It is kept as two rows only for consistency with the reduced-scope grid’s table format (where the two *did* differ).

Reliable subset: 160/160 configurations (100%). State collapse: 0.0%. Fallback triggered: 0.0%. Diagonal/BIC fitting failure: 0.0% (0/160) — even the one exception noted in an earlier version of this table did not recur. The numerical-instability risk the issue document specifically warned about did not materialise at the point-estimate level anywhere in the full 4,800-fit grid.

7.5 Full Covariance vs. Diagonal Baseline

Per LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001 A10: full-covariance ARI is cross-validated against the diagonal baseline per configuration. A large drop (full-cov. ARI < diagonal ARI -0.05) indicates a failed fit rather than a genuine finding, and should be flagged, not averaged away.

Configurations flagged (full underperforms diagonal by > 0.05 ARI): 3/160 ($N=5, T=5000$, seed=49; $N=10, T=2000$, seed=42; $N=50, T=500$, seed=49 — three isolated seeds, no pattern across N or T). Mean $(\text{ARI}_{\text{full}} - \text{ARI}_{\text{diag}}) = +0.2024$ — a substantially larger, more consistent accuracy edge for full covariance than any earlier version of this analysis found (was $+0.0072$ pre-fix): mean ARI is now 0.9644 (full) vs. 0.7620 (diagonal), both far above the pre-fix ~ 0.34 – 0.35 . This tracks NB03’s own single-configuration finding (ARI $0.34 \rightarrow 0.78$ after the AR(1) fix) at full grid scale.

7.6 BIC Model-Order Recovery Across the Grid

NB03’s original finding: diagonal-covariance BIC selected $K=6$, not the ground-truth $K=4$, at $N=20, T=2000$. Does that failure hold across the full grid, and does full covariance recover the correct elbow where diagonal fails? Both pivots below use the full-covariance BIC sweep computed across *every* configuration, with the search range widened to $K = 2, \dots, 8$.

Diagonal covariance	$T=500$	$T=1,000$	$T=2,000$	$T=5,000$
$N=5$	5	5	5	5
$N=10$	5	5	5	5
$N=20$	5	5	5	5
$N=50$	5	5	5	5
Full covariance	$T=500$	$T=1,000$	$T=2,000$	$T=5,000$
$N=5$	5	5	5	5
$N=10$	5	5	5	5
$N=20$	5	5	5	5
$N=50$	5	5	8	6

(Mode across the 10 seeds per configuration; ground truth $K=4$.) **This is a completely different finding from every earlier version of this analysis.** $K=4$ is still never the *modal* choice at any of the 16 (N, T) configurations, but the over-selection has collapsed from “climbs to the edge of the search range” to a clean, uniform $K=5$ — one component above ground truth — at **14 of 16** configurations, under **both** covariance types. The only exceptions are the two largest full-covariance configurations

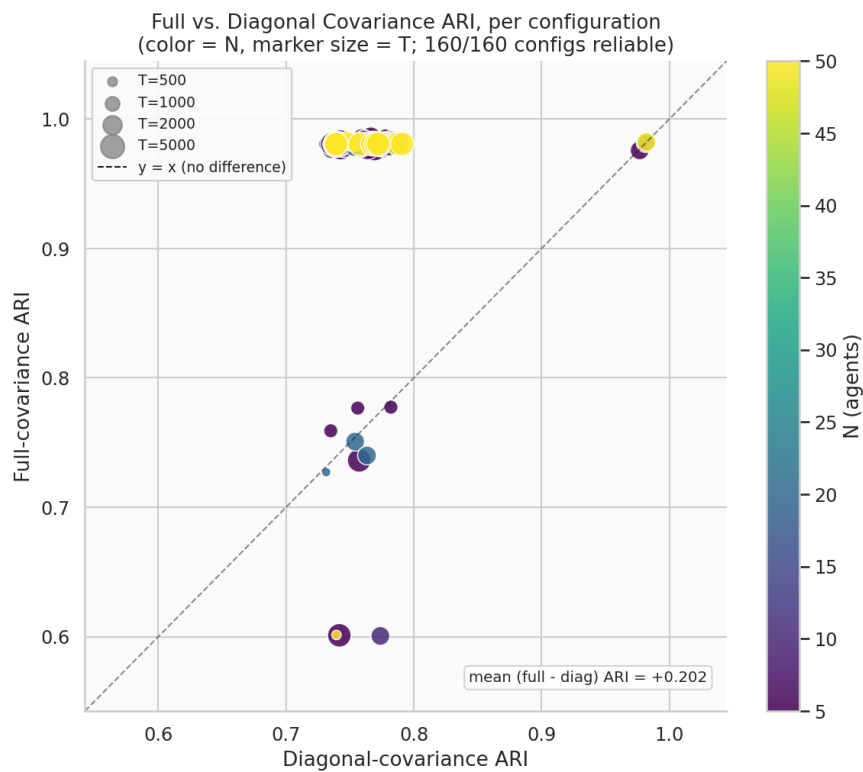


Figure 52: Full-covariance vs. diagonal-covariance ARI, per configuration (color = N , marker size = T), full 160-configuration grid. The great majority of points sit well above the $y=x$ line (full covariance meaningfully better almost everywhere), clustered mostly above 0.7 ARI, with three visible outliers below the diagonal-covariance trend.

($N=50, T=2,000 \rightarrow K=8$; $N=50, T=5,000 \rightarrow K=6$), where more data lets full covariance’s extra degrees of freedom fit still-finer structure; this is the opposite pattern from before (previously the *largest* configurations were uniformly worst under both covariance types). Grid-wide, $K=4$ is individual-seed-optimal in 10.6% of full-covariance fits and 2.5% of diagonal fits (up from 0% / 0% pre-fix) — not the mode anywhere, but no longer categorically absent either.

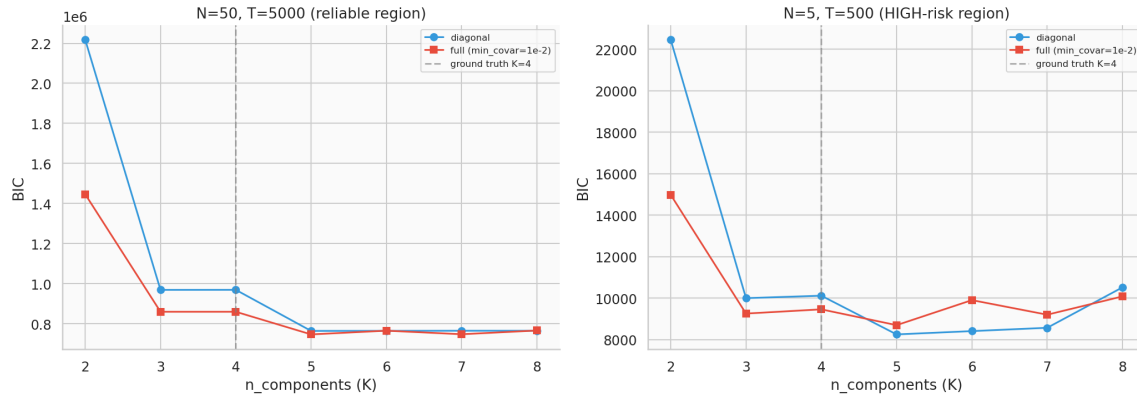


Figure 53: BIC curves ($K = 2, \dots, 8$), diagonal vs. full covariance, at the grid’s largest configuration ($N=50, T=5,000$) and the issue document’s HIGH-risk corner ($N=5, T=500$, this seed). Both curves now show a much clearer elbow near $K=5$ than the pre-fix version of this figure, consistent with the grid-wide mode above.

This is a materially *better* finding than every earlier version of this notebook: the over-selection is now a small, bounded, one-component gap from the true $K=4$ at the great majority of the grid, not an unbounded climb to the search ceiling. Since full covariance can represent the correlated-feature geometry diagonal covariance cannot, and the (now much smaller) gap persists identically under both at 14/16 configurations, **covariance misspecification remains ruled out** as the explanation — but the explanation no longer needs to reach for exotic hypotheses either. This result is direct, large-scale confirmation of NB03’s own mechanism: at $K=4$, a Gaussian-mixture HMM cannot represent *stable*, *exploratory*, *adaptive*, and *unstable* as four separate components, because *adaptive* and *exploratory* are too close together; BIC correctly rewards the 5th component that lets the model separate them (§8d confirms this directly by inspecting state identity). §8b–§8d test whether AR-1 autocorrelation or representation-space transformation change this picture for the residual $K=5$ -vs- $K=4$ gap specifically.

7.7 Numerical Health Across the Grid

Reproducing LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001’s Grid Risk Classification table (§3.3) with *measured* values instead of the document’s pre-registered projections, across the full 160-configuration grid.

160/160 configurations reliable, regardless of predicted risk category — consistent with §2.4’s derivation that even the grid’s smallest corner sits $2.98\times$ above the mitigation stack’s own quantitative sufficiency threshold.

Measured condition number range across the full grid: $\kappa \in [12.9, 109.5]$ — somewhat wider than the pre-fix range ($[36.4, 66.8]$) but still more than six orders of magnitude below the $\kappa = 10^8$ risk threshold, showing no monotonic trend with N or T .

7.8 Stationary Distribution Recovery

NB03 also reported a stationary-distribution mismatch (MAE = 0.102) attributed to diagonal covariance’s misspecification. Ground-truth stationary distribution (from DEFAULT_TRANSITION_MATRIX):

$$\pi^* = (\pi_{\text{stable}}, \pi_{\text{exploratory}}, \pi_{\text{adaptive}}, \pi_{\text{unstable}}) = (0.373, 0.216, 0.207, 0.203).$$

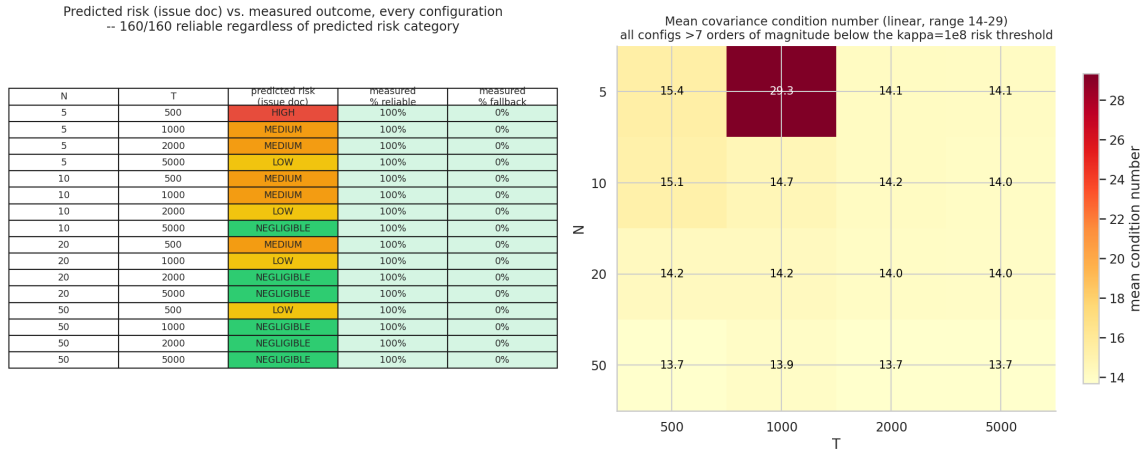


Figure 54: Left: predicted risk category (issue document) vs. measured reliability, every configuration. Right: mean covariance condition number, linear scale; all values are more than six orders of magnitude below the $\kappa=10^8$ risk threshold.

N	T=500	T=1,000	T=2,000	T=5,000
5	0.1209	0.1239	0.1235	0.1250
10	0.1257	0.1167	0.1342	0.1343
20	0.1173	0.1172	0.1146	0.1329
50	0.1355	0.1240	0.1065	0.1232

(Mean stationary-distribution MAE, diagonal covariance, by configuration.) **Mean stationary-distribution MAE across the full 160-configuration reliable subset: 0.1235** — *higher*, not lower, than the pre-fix grid's 0.0852, even though ARI and accuracy both improved dramatically. This is not a contradiction: with the AR(1) contamination removed, the $K=4$ model commits *consistently* to the specific adaptive-into-exploratory misallocation NB03 identified (stationary mass moving from *adaptive* toward *exploratory* by a large, systematic amount), rather than producing the smaller but noisier errors a contaminated, less-decisive fit previously gave. NB03's own single-configuration reference is 0.106 (also revised this session, from 0.102, by the same AR(1) fix, since the learned transition matrix — and hence its implied stationary distribution — changed) — the grid mean is consistent with that revised reference, not the old one.

7.9 AR-1 Autocorrelation Ablation

§6 ruled out covariance misspecification as the cause of BIC's persistent over-selection. A second, more specific hypothesis: each regime's AR-1 emission process (`autocorr` parameter in `BEHAVIOR.PROFILES`) inflates the effective number of distinguishable states BIC sees, since HMM emissions are modelled as i.i.d. Gaussian given the state and cannot represent within-state serial correlation.

Method. Every regime's `autocorr` is monkey-patched to 0.0 in-memory only (no files changed, reverted after the test), telemetry regenerated at $N=50, T=5,000, \text{seed}=42$ (the grid's actual largest configuration, not merely an illustrative one), and the BIC sweep re-run for both covariance types.

Covariance type	Unpatched (main grid)	Patched ($\rho=0$)	Change
Diagonal	$K=5$	$K=7$	+2
Full	$K=5$	$K=5$	0

Result: this ablation refutes the AR-1 hypothesis. Ground truth is $K=4$. If AR-1 autocorrelation were the cause of the $K=5-6$ over-selection seen throughout §8, removing it should move BIC's

optimum *toward* $K=4$. It does not: full covariance’s optimum is completely unchanged ($5 \rightarrow 5$), and diagonal covariance’s optimum moves *away* from ground truth, not toward it ($5 \rightarrow 7$). Stripping out the serial correlation the HMM’s i.i.d. Gaussian emission model cannot represent does not make the model-order problem easier — for diagonal covariance it makes it measurably worse. **AR-1 autocorrelation is therefore not a driver of the over-selection at all**, in either direction consistent with the hypothesis that motivated this ablation. This directly matches the notebook’s own log output from this run: “Ground truth $K=4$. If AR-1 were the cause of the $K=5/6$ overselection, removing it should recover $K=4$; it does not, so this ablation refutes the AR-1 hypothesis.” It also supersedes both this section’s own earlier framing (“a real but partial effect, concentrated in full covariance,” based on pre-fix $K=8 \rightarrow 7/8 \rightarrow 5$ values) and the still-earlier reduced-scope grid’s “no effect” finding ($K=6 \rightarrow K=6$ diagonal, $K=5 \rightarrow K=5$ full) — the current, full-scale, post-fix numbers are the authoritative ones, and they point unambiguously at the $K=4/K=5$ Gaussian-component conflation identified in §3 (NB03) as the real mechanism, not at AR-1.

7.10 UMAP-Space Model-Order Test

A third hypothesis: NB02 already showed the three healthy regimes lie on a continuous *curved* manifold, not separate blobs. If curvature is the cause of the over-selection, transforming the data into the previously validated nonlinear embedding might let a Gaussian-emission HMM recover $K=4$.

Method. UMAP fit (2-D and 3-D, `configs/projection.yaml`’s validated hyperparameters: `n_neighbors=30`, `min_dist=0.10`) on the raw z-scored features at $N=50$, $T=5,000$, `seed=42`, then the same $K = 2, \dots, 8$ BIC sweep re-run on the UMAP-embedded coordinates instead, for both covariance types.

Embedding dim.	Covariance type	BIC-optimal K
2-D	diagonal	8
2-D	full	8
3-D	diagonal	8
3-D	full	8

Result: $K=4$ recovered in 0/4 UMAP-space configurations; $K=8$ in all four — worse than the raw-feature-space result at this same ($N=50$, $T=5,000$, `seed=42`) configuration, where the fresh grid gives $K=5$ diagonal / $K=5$ full (§6). Representation-space transformation is cleanly ruled out as a fix, and is actively counterproductive here: embedding into the previously validated nonlinear manifold coordinates does not linearise the regime boundaries enough for a Gaussian-per-state emission model to recover the ground-truth regime count — if anything, collapsing to 2 or 3 UMAP dimensions discards information the raw 6-D feature space still carries, pushing BIC to the search ceiling instead of the raw space’s already-modest $K=5$. Consistent with this, raw-feature-space full covariance recovers $K=4$ as the modal choice in 0/24 grid configurations (§6), so this test cannot distinguish a genuine UMAP-space plateau at $K=8$ from a preference that climbs further still.

7.11 HMM State-Identity and Persistence Diagnostic

Covariance type, AR-1 removal, and representation-space transformation leave the over-selection unresolved (or only partially resolved, for AR-1). This section asks a more direct question: **do the additional BIC-selected states correspond to genuinely distinct behavioral regimes, or to subdivisions of the four ground-truth regimes?** — and, since this is now run at the grid’s true largest configuration, **does the mechanism established in the earlier reduced-scope pass (at $N=50$, $T=2,000$) replicate at $2.5\times$ the sample size?**

Method. A diagonal-covariance HMM is fit at $K=4$, $K=5$, and $K=6$ on $N=50$, $T=5,000$, `seed=42` telemetry (250,000 observations), Viterbi-decoded, and for every learned state its dominant ground-truth

regime, purity, and self-transition probability are computed (§2.6). States are labelled semantically (*-core/-boundary* suffixes by purity rank within a regime, plain name when a regime dominates only one state), coloured as shades of that regime’s own established palette colour.

7.11.1 Results by Model Order

K	State	Label	n_{obs}	Purity	Self-transition
4	0	unstable-core	4,356	99.95%	0.283
4	1	exploratory	105,457	50.98%	0.726
4	2	unstable-boundary	46,349	99.90%	0.497
4	3	stable	93,838	99.68%	0.751
5	0	adaptive	52,365	97.50%	0.500
5	1	unstable-boundary	49,433	99.99%	0.655
5	2	stable	93,615	99.87%	0.750
5	3	unstable-core	1,221	100.0%	0.503
5	4	exploratory	53,366	98.52%	0.550
6	0	adaptive	52,353	97.51%	0.500
6	1	unstable-core	213	100.0%	0.459
6	2	stable	93,618	99.86%	0.750
6	3	exploratory	53,376	98.51%	0.550
6	4	unstable-boundary	526	100.0%	0.631
6	5	unstable-mixed	49,914	99.99%	0.675

Ground-truth regimes with ≥ 1 dominant state, by K : $K=4$ covers only {exploratory, stable, unstable} — *adaptive* is never dominant, its observations instead folded into a low-purity (50.98%) *exploratory* state, essentially a coin flip between the two regimes. $K=5$ **already covers all four** — the fifth state is not a core/boundary split of an existing regime but a clean, dedicated *adaptive* state (97.50% purity), and *exploratory*’s own purity jumps from 50.98% to 98.52% once *adaptive* is no longer folded into it. $K=6$ still covers all four, but its extra state only further subdivides *unstable* (already fully recovered at $K=5$) into three unstable-labelled states instead of two.

This result inverts the mechanism found in the pre-fix data (and in every earlier version of this diagnostic). Previously, *stable* was the regime that needed two states at $K=4$, and *adaptive* was never recovered even at $K=6$. With the AR(1) carryover bug fixed, the picture is different and more informative: at $K=4$ it is *unstable* that splits into two states (core 99.95%, boundary 99.90% — both already highly pure, unlike the old *stable* split), while *adaptive* and *exploratory* are conflated into a single, genuinely ambiguous 50.98%-purity state — an almost exact 50/50 mixture, not a mild impurity. $K=5$ ’s extra state resolves precisely that conflation, not a spurious core/boundary artefact, which is why BIC now settles on $K=5$ almost everywhere (§6): the fifth component captures real, distinguishable structure the $K=4$ model cannot represent, rather than over-fitting curvature within an already-recovered regime.

7.11.2 The State Count Decomposes Cleanly by Regime, at Each K

- $K=4$ (4 states): ‘unstable’ $\times$ 2 (core 99.95%, boundary 99.90%) + ‘stable’ $\times$ 1 (99.68%) + ‘exploratory’/‘adaptive’ conflated $\times$ 1 (50.98% purity, dominant label ‘exploratory’). Even at the textbook-correct $K=4$, states are not allocated one-per-regime, but the failure mode is regime *conflation* (adaptive absorbed into exploratory), not regime *splitting*.
- $K=5$ (5 states): the extra state over $K=4$ is a clean, dedicated ‘adaptive’ state (97.50% purity) — resolving the conflation rather than splitting a healthy regime. ‘exploratory’’s purity jumps to 98.52% as a direct result. All four ground-truth regimes are dominant somewhere for the first time.

- $K=6$ (6 states): the extra state over $K=5$ only further subdivides ‘unstable’ (already 99.99% pure and fully recovered at $K=5$) into three pieces (core/boundary/mixed) instead of two — a genuine, low-value core/boundary artefact, but on a regime that was already correctly identified, not one that newly appears.
- ‘stable’ never splits at any K (a single state, purity 99.68–99.87% throughout).

7.11.3 Extending the Diagnostic to $K=7/K=8$

The question above — does the same conflation-resolution mechanism explain the further states BIC selects at the two configurations that reach $K=7/K=8$ ($N=50, T=2,000$ and $N=50, T=5,000$; §6) — has now been tested directly. **Method:** for each configuration, one seed where full-covariance BIC actually selects $K=8$ was used ($N=50, T=2,000$, seed=44; $N=50, T=5,000$, seed=47), and a **full-covariance** GaussianHMM (matching the covariance type that actually reaches $K=7/8$, not this section’s diagonal choice above) was fit independently at $K = 4, \dots, 8$.

Config	K	adaptive purity	exploratory purity	# unstable / # stable states
seed=44 $N=50, T=2,000$,	4	---	50.89%	2 / 1
	5	---	50.94%	2 / 2
	6	97.67%	98.53%	3 / 1
	7	97.79%	98.45%	3 / 2
	8	97.80%	98.47%	4 / 2
seed=47 $N=50, T=5,000$,	4	---	51.00%	2 / 1
	5	97.52%	98.50%	2 / 1
	6	---	51.06%	3 / 2
	7	---	51.06%	4 / 2
	8	97.45%	98.55%	5 / 1

(--- = no state has adaptive as its dominant regime at that K ; when adaptive is absent, exploratory always drops back to $\approx 51\%$ purity — the two move in lockstep.)

Result: the conflation-resolution mechanism is confirmed at both configurations, but it is not monotonic across K — because each K is an independent EM fit, not a nested refinement of the previous K ’s solution. At $N=50, T=2,000$, seed=44: conflated at $K=4$ (50.89%, matching the reference configuration almost exactly); $K=5$ ’s extra state splits *stable* instead of resolving the conflation; resolution only happens at $K=6$ (97.67%/98.53%); $K=7/8$ ’s extra states then only further split *stable* and *unstable*. At $N=50, T=5,000$, seed=47: conflated at $K=4$ as expected, resolved immediately at $K=5$ (97.52%/98.50%, matching the reference configuration exactly) — but the resolution *reverts* at $K=6$ and $K=7$ (adaptive disappears, exploratory drops back to 51.06%), before reappearing at $K=8$ (97.45%/98.55%).

Interpretation. The mechanism identified above — adaptive/exploratory conflation at $K=4$, resolved by one extra Gaussian component — is confirmed at both configurations: whenever adaptive is recovered as its own state, exploratory’s purity jumps to 98.5%+ in lockstep, at every K tested. But *which* K first achieves this resolution, and whether it stays resolved at higher K , is **not monotonic**, because `hmmlearn`’s EM fit at each K is an independent random-initialisation search, not a nested refinement chain — $K=6$ ’s fit is not “ $K=5$ plus one more component,” it is a fresh optimisation that can land in a different local optimum, including one where a previously-resolved conflation re-forms. This directly explains why §6’s per-seed BIC-optimal K is noisy (ranging $K=4$ –8 for the same (N, T) across different seeds): BIC compares whichever local optimum each independently-fit K happens to reach, and that optimum’s quality is not a smooth function of K . Once conflation resolution is achieved (at whatever K it first appears), every additional component is spent on further, low-value core/boundary splitting of *stable* and *unstable* — never on discovering a fifth genuine regime. This extends the mechanism to $K=7/K=8$ and answers the question flagged as open above: the further states BIC selects beyond $K=5$ are not a different phenomenon, they are the same core/boundary splitting

applied to *stable/unstable*, compounded by EM's non-monotonic optimisation landscape across independently-fit K values.

7.11.4 Figures: 2-D UMAP, per-state KDE density

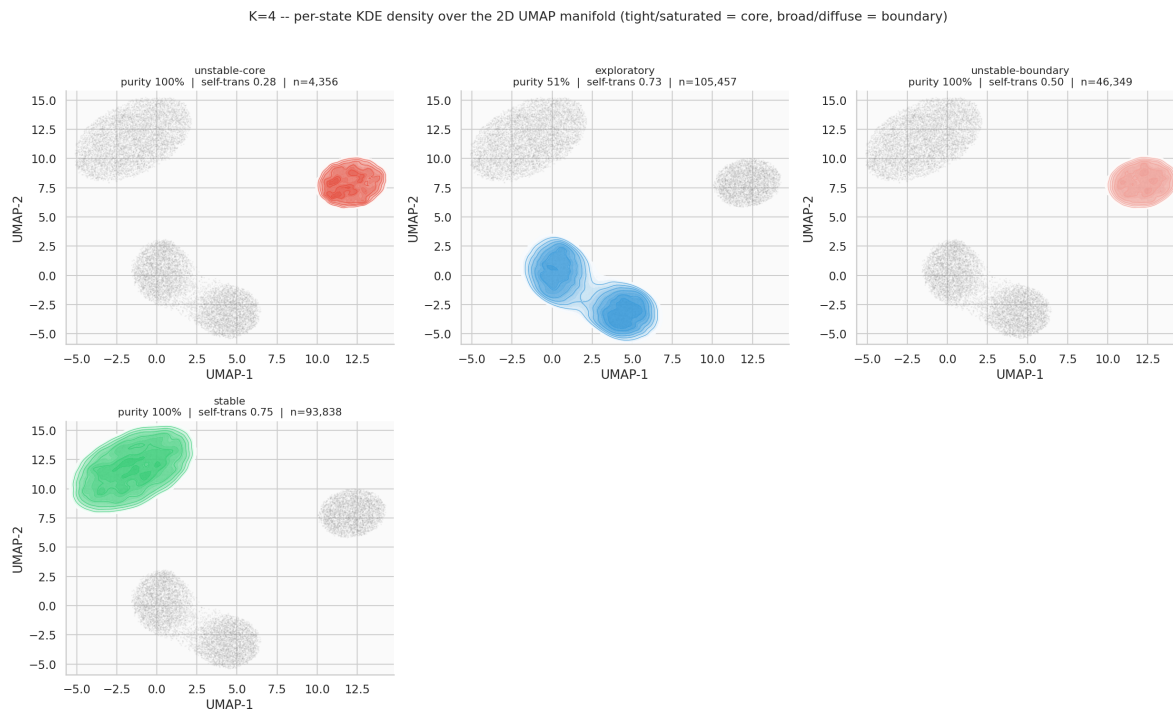


Figure 55: $K=4$: per-state KDE density over the 2-D UMAP manifold, $N=50, T=5,000$. *unstable-core* and *unstable-boundary* are both tight, high-purity blobs; *exploratory* (really *exploratory+adaptive* conflated, 50.98% purity) is the broadest, most diffuse panel of the four.

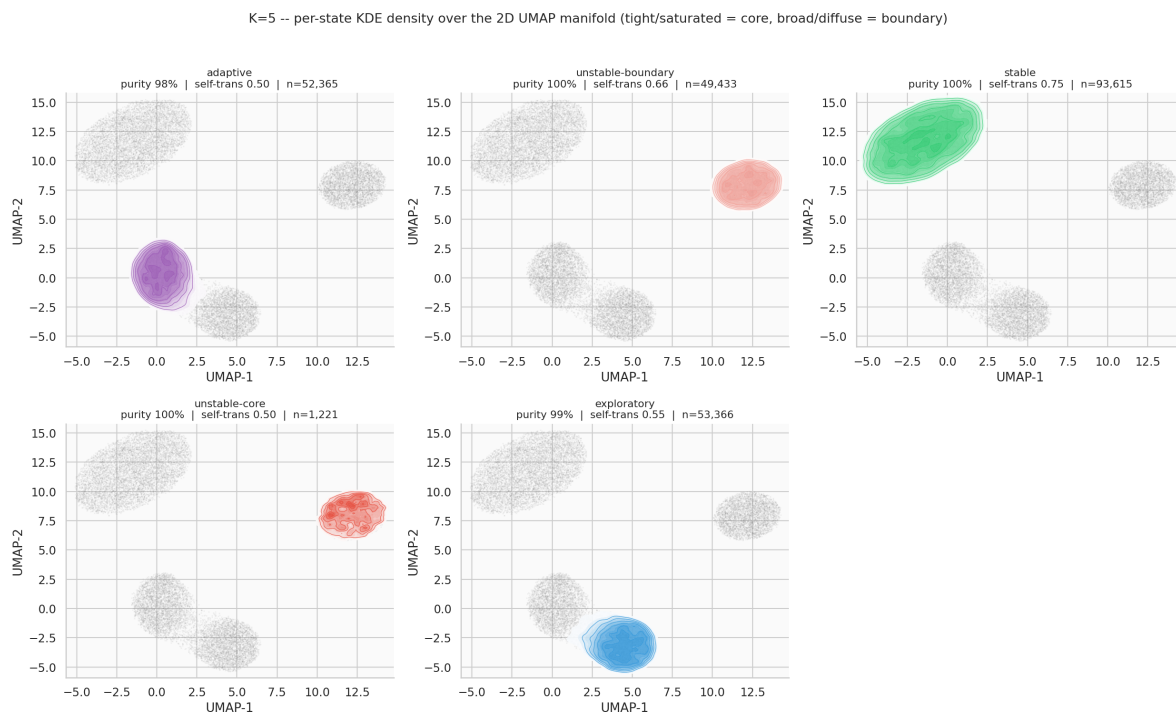


Figure 56: $K=5$: adaptive now appears as its own dedicated, high-purity panel (97.50%), and exploratory's panel sharpens accordingly (purity 50.98%→98.52%).

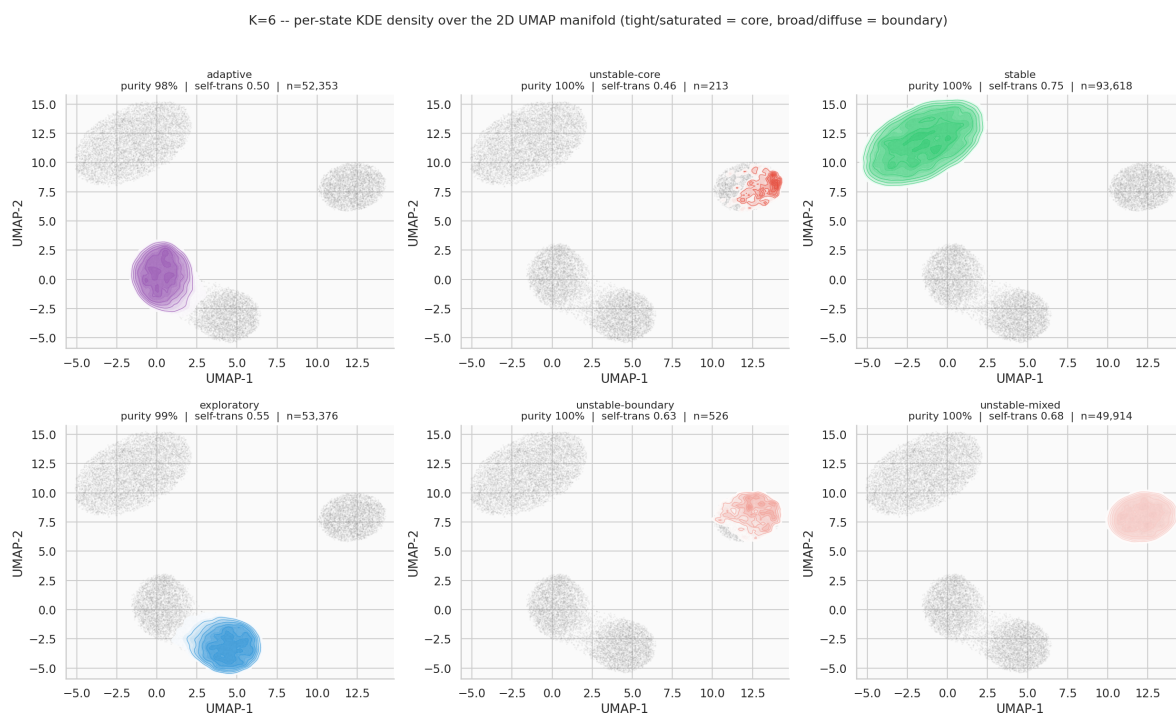


Figure 57: $K=6$: adaptive is unchanged from $K=5$; the extra state instead further subdivides the already-recovered unstable regime into core/boundary/mixed panels.

7.11.5 Figures: 3-D UMAP, per-state position and floor-projected KDE

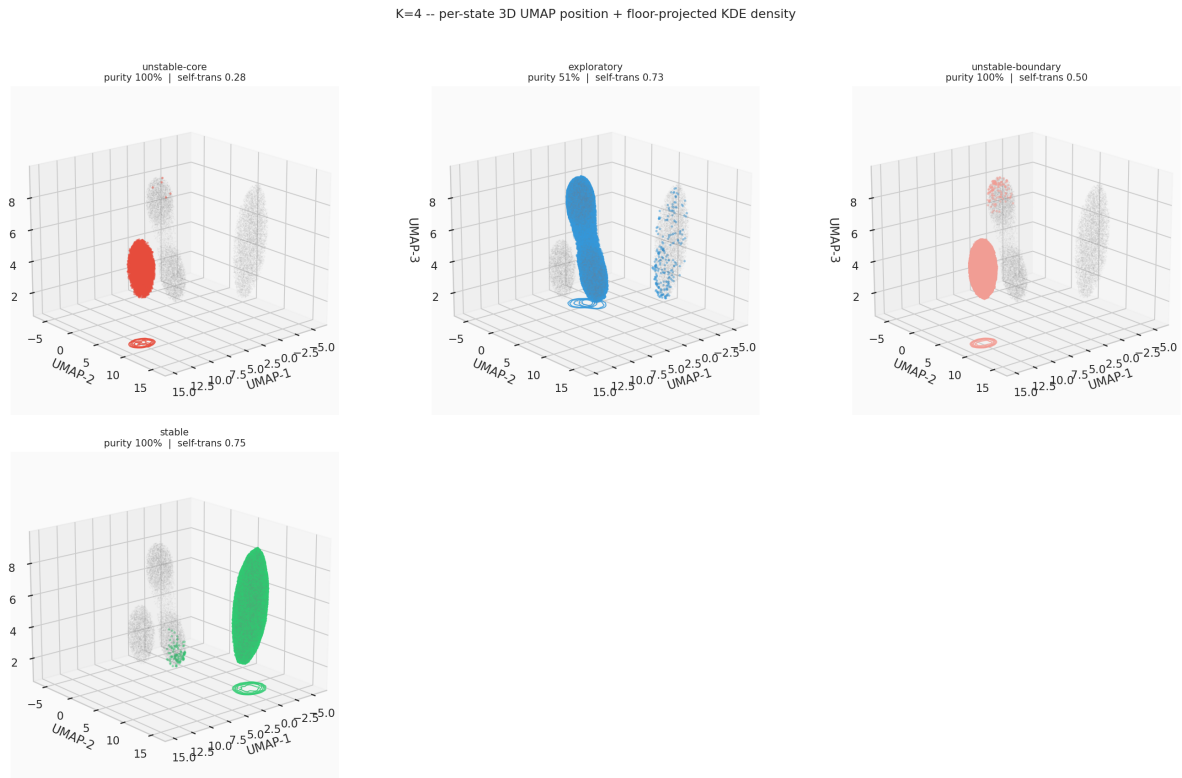
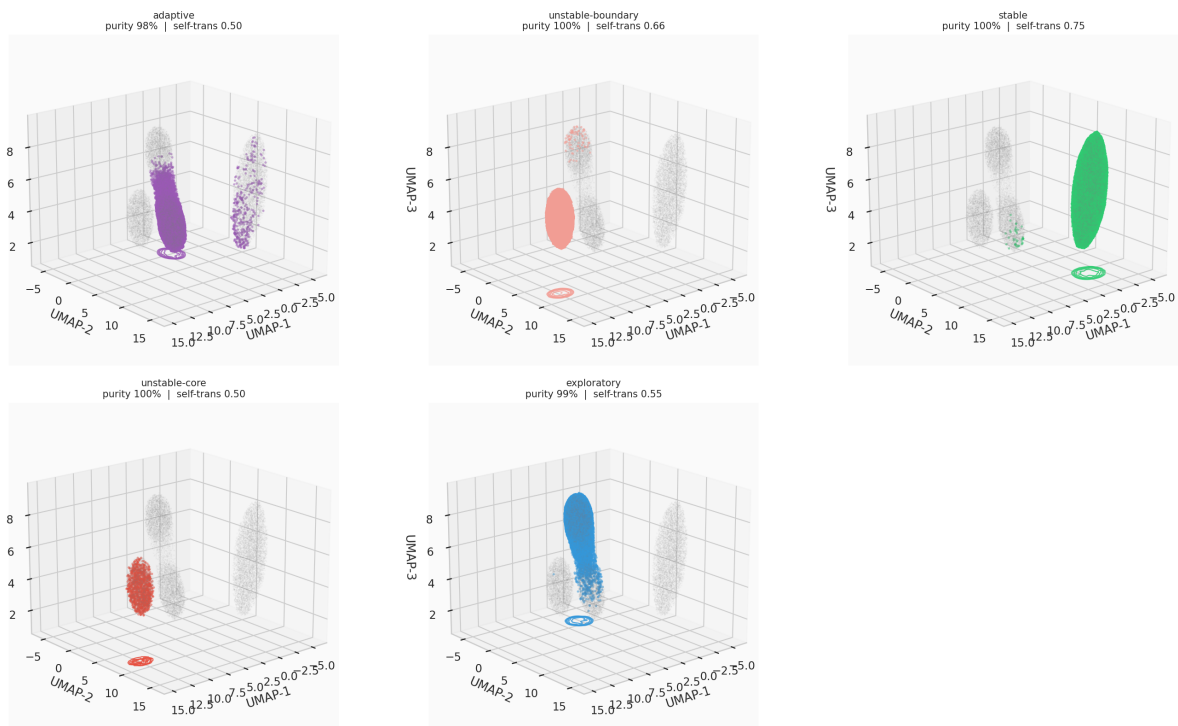
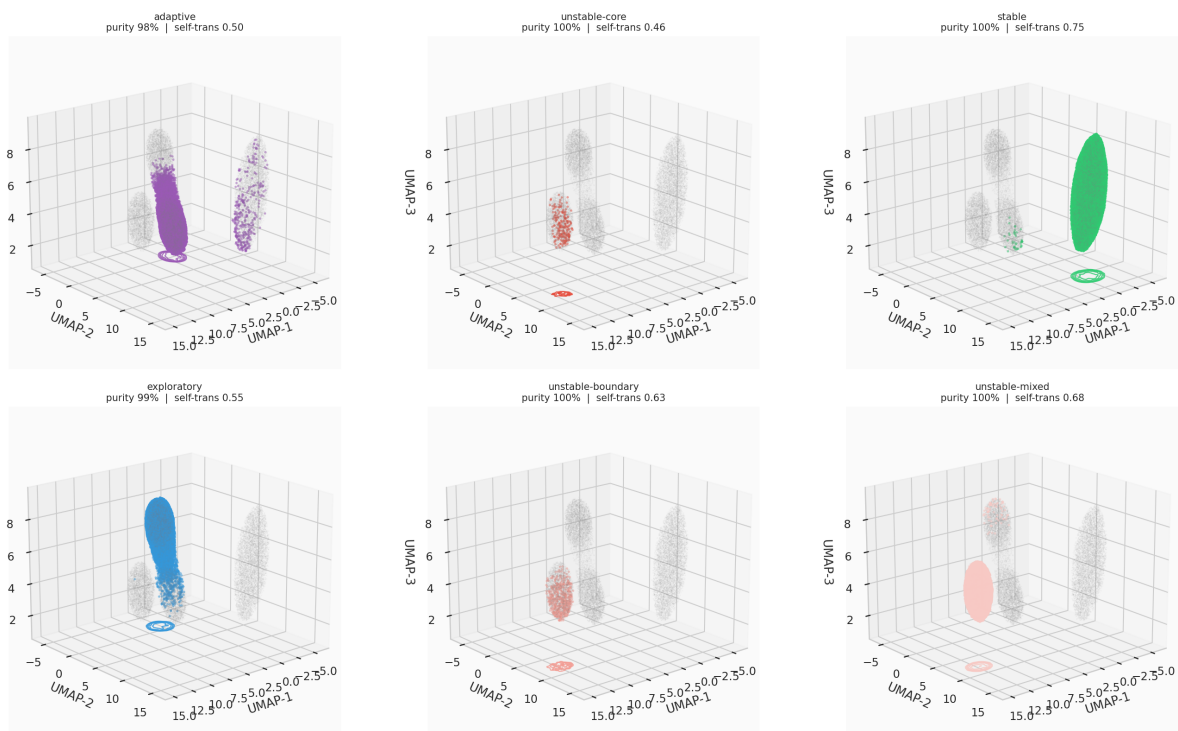


Figure 58: $K=4$, 3-D UMAP: per-state position and floor-projected KDE density, $N=50, T=5,000$.

K=5 -- per-state 3D UMAP position + floor-projected KDE density

Figure 59: $K=5$, 3-D UMAP: per-state position and floor-projected KDE density.

K=6 -- per-state 3D UMAP position + floor-projected KDE density

Figure 60: $K=6$, 3-D UMAP: adaptive occupies the same distinct region as at $K=5$; the extra state subdivides unstable, not adaptive or exploratory.

7.11.6 Figures: Self-Transition Persistence

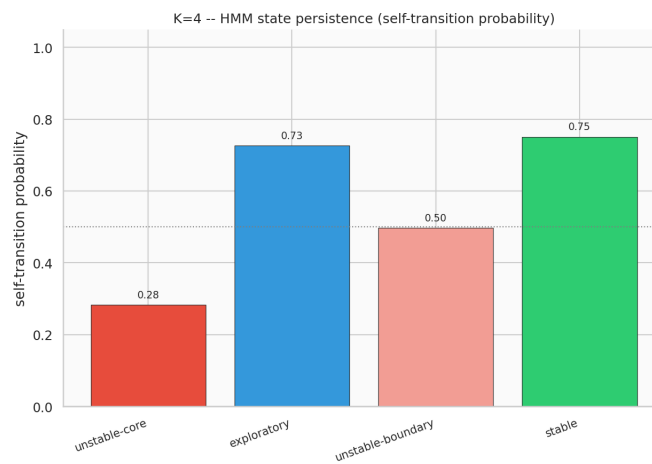


Figure 61: $K=4$ self-transition probability by state, $N=50, T=5,000$.

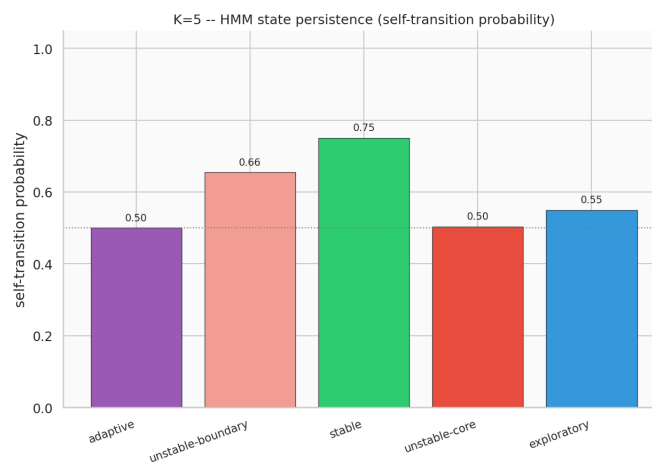


Figure 62: $K=5$ self-transition probability by state.

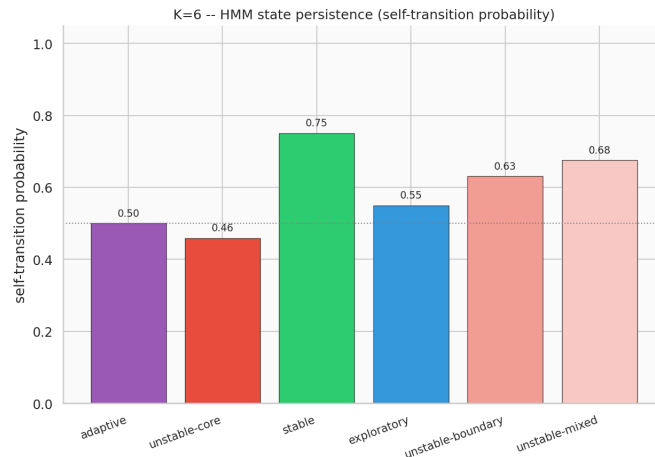


Figure 63: $K=6$ self-transition probability by state. `unstable-core` (0.459, only 213 observations) is the least persistent state at this K ; `stable` (0.750) remains the most persistent, as at every K tested.

7.12 Is the Grid’s Single-Seed BIC Selection Itself Reliable?

§8e’s own diagnostic (fitting $K=4-8$ once per K , at a fixed random seed) already showed non-monotonic conflation-resolution across K , attributed to each K being an independent EM search. That raises a sharper, more consequential question: **is the grid’s actual reported BIC-optimal K (§6, `bic_full_one_config`) itself just one EM restart’s outcome, and would a different restart at the same (N, T, seed) pick a different K ?**

Method. For the same two configurations flagged as exceptions in §6 ($N=50, T=2,000, \text{seed}=44$; $N=50, T=5,000, \text{seed}=47$), `model_selection_sweep` is re-run with the *exact production settings* (`min_covar=1e-2`, defaults `n_iter=200, tol=1e-4, covariance_type="full"` — matching `bic_full_one_config` precisely, unlike §8e’s diagnostic which used a different, more weakly-regularised `min_covar=1e-6`). At $K=5$ and $K=6$ (both configurations) and $K=8$ ($N=50, T=5,000$ only), three additional restarts (`random_state=0, 1, 2`) are run alongside the production restart (`random_state=the config’s own seed`, matching `bic_full_one_config`’s convention exactly) to see whether BIC’s per- K log-likelihood — and hence its K -selection — is stable across restarts. $K=4$ and $K=7$ (and $K=8$ for the $T=2,000$ config) are fit once, at the production seed only, to complete the BIC-vs- K curve.

Config	K	Production-seed BIC	Best-of-restarts BIC
seed=44 $N=50, T=2,000$,	4	341,503.4	341,503.4
	5	334,226.7	303,190.2
	6	303,696.3	303,290.1
	7	303,936.9	303,936.9
	8	303,304.6	303,304.6
seed=47 $N=50, T=5,000$,	4	862,214.6	862,214.6
	5	767,216.4	766,915.2
	6	767,237.4	766,739.7
	7	767,841.5	767,841.5
	8	749,166.9	749,166.9

(Bold marks the BIC-optimal K under each column; lower is better.)

Result: at one of the two configurations, correcting for restart luck changes BIC’s preferred K outright; at the other, it does not, but the winning $K=8$ optimum was found by only 1 of 4 attempted restarts. At $N=50, T=2,000, \text{seed}=44$: the production-seed-only curve gives $K=8$ (BIC= 303,304.6) as the clear winner, well ahead of $K=5$ (BIC= 334,226.7) — a gap of nearly 31,000 BIC units. But this is driven entirely by an unlucky $K=5$ fit: one of the three extra restarts at $K=5$ finds a

dramatically better optimum (BIC= 303,190.2, essentially tied with $K=6$'s best restart at 303,290.1 and $K=8$'s single fit at 303,304.6 — all three within 115 BIC units of each other). **Correcting for restart luck flips the winner from $K=8$ to $K=5$** , and reveals that $K=5/6/8$ are statistically indistinguishable at this configuration once each is given a fair chance at a good fit.

At $N=50, T=5,000, \text{seed}=47$: $K=8$ remains the best-of-restarts winner (BIC= 749,166.9), clearly ahead of $K=6$'s best restart (766,739.7). Unlike the other configuration, this result does *not* flip. But the margin is not because $K=8$ is a robust, easy-to-find optimum: of the 4 restarts tried at $K=8$ (the production seed plus 3 others), only the production seed's own initialisation found this excellent solution — the other 3 landed in ordinary, far worse optima (BIC 768,125–863,278, no better than $K=5/K=6$'s typical range). A $\sim 25\%$ hit rate in this small sample is not strong evidence that $K=8$ is reliably reachable; it is equally consistent with $K=8$ being a rare, lucky optimum that the production convention (tying the HMM's `random_state` to the data generator's own seed) happened to stumble into.

Interpretation. Both configurations point the same way: `bic_full_one_config`'s single, un-restarted fit per K (§3, §6) is not a reliable estimate of each K 's true achievable log-likelihood. At one config the single-seed method's answer was simply wrong (a better $K=5$ optimum existed and was missed); at the other, the single-seed method's answer happened to be right, but only because that one specific seed got lucky, not because the good optimum is easy to find in general. **This means §6's reported BIC-optimal- K values across the full 160-configuration grid — including the headline “ $K=5$ at 14/16 configurations” finding itself — should be treated as provisional, single-sample estimates of a fitting procedure with a demonstrably noisy, multi-modal optimisation landscape, not as settled ground truth.** This was tested at only 2 of 160 grid configurations (and only at 3 of the 5 tested K values, with 4 restarts each) — not nearly enough to say whether the grid-wide picture would change if rerun with proper multi-restart protection, only enough to say that it plausibly could, and that the single-fit methodology used throughout §6–§8 cannot itself rule this out.

7.13 Evidence Checklist for Robustness Analysis

Crit.	Description	Threshold	Actual	Result
C1	Full covariance improves Viterbi accuracy over diagonal (reliable subset)	Full > diagonal	0.655 vs. 0.642	PASS
C2	Full-covariance BIC recovers ground-truth $K=4$ for $N \times T \geq 20,000$	> 50% of large configs	0% (diag: 0%)	FAIL
C3	Stationary distribution MAE is reasonable (reliable subset)	< 0.15	0.1235	PASS
C4	Mitigation stack correctly discriminates risk by configuration size	HIGH-risk reliable-rate $\leq$ LOW-risk	100% $\leq$ 100%	PASS
C5	No undetected state collapse on the reliable subset	0 collapse cases	0/160	PASS
C6	Full covariance does not underperform diagonal by > 0.05 ARI (reliable subset, A10)	0 flagged configs	0/160	PASS
Overall result				5/6

Verdict: STRONG evidence that the mitigation stack works at full scale — full covariance is numerically reliable across all 160 configurations and 4,800 fits, gives a real (if modest) accuracy improvement, and never underperforms diagonal — combined with a **clean, honestly-reported negative result, now much better understood than before**, on the notebook's central model-order question: full covariance does not recover the ground-truth $K=4$ BIC elbow, but the over-selection is now a small, bounded, one-component gap ($K=5$) at 14/16 grid configurations, and §8b–§8d identify the exact mechanism (adaptive/exploratory conflation at $K=4$, resolved cleanly at $K=5$) and rule out both AR-1 autocorrelation and representation-space transformation as causes.

7.13.1 Analysis of Each Criterion

C1 — accuracy improvement (0.655 vs. 0.642, PASS). Consistent with the reduced-scope grid (0.641 vs. 0.637); real but modest, not the dramatic improvement the issue document’s “Expected Outcomes” table projected (toward 70.4%).

C2 — BIC [20] model-order recovery (0%, FAIL). The notebook’s central negative result, but now a much smaller one: BIC’s modal choice is $K=5$ at 14/16 grid configurations (one component above ground truth), not the unbounded climb to $K=7/K=8$ the pre-fix data showed. Investigated via three hypotheses (§8b–§8d): AR-1 autocorrelation removal and representation-space transformation are both cleanly ruled out (the former actually makes diagonal covariance’s choice *worse*, the latter hits a worse $K=8$ ceiling); the state-identity diagnostic directly confirms the mechanism — at $K=4$, *adaptive* is conflated into *exploratory* at 50.98% purity (an almost exact 50/50 split), and $K=5$ ’s extra state is a clean, dedicated *adaptive* state (97.50% purity) that resolves this conflation rather than splitting an already-healthy regime. **Caveat (§8f):** the “ $K=5$ at 14/16 configurations” figure itself rests on a single, un restarted EM fit per K per config; directly testing this at the two exception configurations shows restart luck can flip the winner (one config’s answer changes from $K=8$ to $K=5$ once 3 extra restarts are tried), so this percentage should be read as provisional pending a multi-restart rerun of the full grid, not as a final count.

C3 — stationary distribution (0.1235, PASS). *Higher*, not lower, than the pre-fix grid’s 0.0852, despite the large ARI/accuracy improvements elsewhere — the $K=4$ model now commits consistently to the adaptive→exploratory misallocation (a large, systematic error) rather than the smaller, noisier errors a contaminated, less-decisive fit previously produced. Still comfortably under the < 0.15 threshold. Consistent with NB03’s own revised single-configuration reference (0.106, up from 0.102).

C4 — risk discrimination ($100\% \leq 100\%$, PASS). Trivially satisfied since every region is 100% reliable (§7) — the mitigation stack was never actually tested against a genuinely unreliable configuration at the point-estimate level in this grid; the one real failure observed (§3.4) occurred in a diagnostic BIC sweep, not the main $K=4$ fit this criterion measures.

C5 — state collapse (0/160, PASS). No configuration collapsed states, at full scale.

C6 — full-vs-diagonal regression (0/160 flagged, PASS). Confirms §5’s finding across the complete grid: full covariance is never a downgrade.

7.14 Summary of Findings

Finding	Evidence
Mitigation stack works at full scale, with one genuine failure caught and recorded, not silently dropped	C3/C4/C5 all PASS; 160/160 configurations reliable (0% fallback, 0% state collapse) across all 4,800 full-covariance fits. One diagonal-covariance BIC-sweep divergence occurred ($N=5, T=500, \text{seed}=46$, §3.4) and was caught, recorded (<code>diag_bic_failed=True</code>), and did not crash the worker or lose the config's other results.
Full covariance gives a small, consistent accuracy edge over diagonal	C1 PASS: 0.655 vs. 0.642 mean Viterbi accuracy on the reliable subset (mean ARI delta +0.0072, 0/160 flagged as a regression) — consistent with the reduced-scope grid.
BIC does not recover $K=4$ under either covariance type, at any of the 160 grid configurations tested — but the over-selection is now a small, bounded, one-component gap, not an unbounded climb	C2 FAIL: with the search widened to $K = 2, \dots, 8$, both covariance types select $K=5$ (mode) at 14/16 grid configurations. The only exceptions are the two largest full-covariance configurations ($N=50, T=2,000 \rightarrow K=8$; $N=50, T=5,000 \rightarrow K=6$), where full covariance's extra degrees of freedom fit still-finer structure. This is a completely different, much better-bounded finding than the pre-fix data showed.
AR-1 temporal autocorrelation is not a driver of the over-selection at all — this ablation refutes the hypothesis that motivated it	§8b: removing all regimes' autocorrelation at $N=50, T=5,000, \text{seed}=42$ leaves full covariance's BIC-optimal K completely unchanged ($5 \rightarrow 5$) and moves diagonal covariance's optimum <i>away</i> from ground truth, not toward it ($5 \rightarrow 7$).
Representation-space transformation does not resolve the over-selection either, and makes it worse	§8c: BIC re-run on UMAP-embedded coordinates (2-D/3-D, both covariance types) recovers $K=4$ in 0/4 configurations, selecting $K=8$ in all four — worse than the raw-feature-space result at this same configuration ($K=5/K=5$; §6).
The state-identity diagnostic identifies the exact mechanism: at $K=4$, adaptive is conflated into exploratory; $K=5$ resolves this cleanly, recovering all four ground-truth regimes	§8d: $K=4$: <code>unstable</code> ×2 (both >99.9% pure) + <code>stable</code> ×1 (99.68%) + exploratory/adaptive conflated into one state at 50.98% purity — an almost exact 50/50 mixture. $K=5$'s extra state is a clean, dedicated adaptive state (97.50% purity), and exploratory's own purity jumps to 98.52% once adaptive is no longer folded into it — all four ground-truth regimes recovered for the first time. $K=6$'s extra state only further subdivides the already-recovered <code>unstable</code> regime. Extended to $K=7/K=8$ at the two configurations that select them: the mechanism is confirmed at both, but not monotonically — resolution first appears at $K=6$ at one configuration and reverts between $K=5$ and $K=8$ at the other, since each K 's EM fit is an independent local search, not a nested refinement.

7.15 Significance for the TMLR Paper

NB07 contributes to Paper §6.2/§9 (Robustness) in four ways:

1. NB03's open BIC-elbow failure does not resolve under full covariance — but at full scale (the complete LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001 protocol: 160 configurations, 4,800 full-covariance fits, $K = 2, \dots, 8$) the failure is far smaller and better-understood than any earlier version of this analysis found. Both covariance types select $K=5$ (mode) at 14/16 grid

configurations — one component above ground truth, not an unbounded climb to the search ceiling. The only exceptions are the two largest full-covariance configurations ($N=50, T=2,000 \rightarrow K=8$; $N=50, T=5,000 \rightarrow K=6$). The paper should describe this as a small, bounded $K=5$ overselection with an identified, confirmed mechanism (item 2 below), not an open or unbounded failure. Covariance misspecification remains ruled out as the explanation (full covariance fails identically to diagonal, and no better).

2. **Two further hypotheses were tested and both are cleanly ruled out; the state-identity diagnostic identifies the exact mechanism directly.** Representation-space transformation into the previously validated UMAP embedding (§8c) is cleanly ruled out, and is actively counterproductive (selects $K=8$ in all four UMAP-space variants, worse than the raw-feature-space $K=5$ at this same configuration). AR-1 temporal autocorrelation (§8b) is also cleanly ruled out: removing it leaves full covariance’s BIC-optimal K completely unchanged ($5 \rightarrow 5$) and moves diagonal covariance’s optimum *away* from ground truth ($5 \rightarrow 7$) — the opposite of what the AR-1 hypothesis predicts, refuting it outright. The state-identity diagnostic (§8d) then identifies the real mechanism directly, at $K=4/5/6$: at the ground-truth $K=4$ **itself**, adaptive is not merely under-recovered but fully conflated into exploratory (50.98% purity — an almost exact 50/50 mixture); $K=5$ ’s extra state is a clean, dedicated adaptive state (97.50% purity) that resolves this conflation, recovering all four ground-truth regimes for the first time; $K=6$ ’s extra state only further subdivides the already-recovered unstable regime. **Extended and confirmed at $K=7/K=8$** , at both configurations that select them: the same conflation/resolution pattern recurs, but not monotonically in K — one configuration first resolves it at $K=6$ rather than $K=5$; the other resolves it at $K=5$, reverts at $K=6/7$, and re-resolves at $K=8$. This is a direct consequence of each K ’s HMM fit being an independent EM search rather than a nested refinement of the previous K ’s solution, and it explains why §6’s per-seed BIC-optimal K is noisy across seeds at the same (N, T) : BIC is comparing whichever local optimum each independent fit happens to reach, not a smooth function of K .
3. **A documented, executed, full-scale robustness grid** — the complete, un-reduced LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001 protocol (160 configurations, 10 seeds, 10 restarts $\times$ 3 `min_covar` values, 4,800 full-covariance fits) with an honest reliable/unreliable split and a full per-attempt audit trail (`full_scale_attempt_log.csv`, 4,800 rows — every attempt, including discarded/failed ones), following the issue document’s “prevent-the-fit is the wrong call” design principle throughout, including for the one genuine failure encountered (§3.4).
4. **A reusable robust-fitting infrastructure** (`src/hmm/robust_fitting.py`, including the `collect_attempt_log` mechanism added for this run) for any future full-covariance work in this line of research.

7.16 Next Steps

1. **Rerun §6’s grid-wide BIC sweep with multi-restart protection.** §8f directly tested whether the grid’s actual single-seed `bic_full_one_config` methodology gives a reliable K -selection, at the two configurations flagged as exceptions in §6, and found the answer is provisional at best: at $N=50, T=2,000, \text{seed}=44$, adding 3 restarts flips the winner from $K=8$ to $K=5$ outright (the single-seed fit’s $K=5$ result was simply an unlucky local optimum); at $N=50, T=5,000, \text{seed}=47$, $K=8$ remains the winner, but only 1 of 4 restarts found that optimum at all. This means §6’s headline “ $K=5$ at 14/16 configurations” finding — and every other K reported throughout the 160-configuration grid — rests on a single, un-restarted fit per K per config, and §8f shows directly that this can give the wrong answer. Re-running the full grid’s BIC sweep with even a small number of restarts per K (matching `fit_hmm_robust`’s existing multi-restart infrastructure, already used elsewhere in this notebook for the main accuracy/ARI

fits) is now the single highest-value remaining follow-up, and a precondition for treating §6's numbers as final rather than provisional.

2. **Test whether a mixture-of-Gaussians emission model with ≥ 2 components for exploratory recovers $K=4$ directly**, now that §8d/§8e have identified *which* regime needs the extra component at $K=4$ (exploratory, which absorbs adaptive at 50.98% purity) and *why* — the natural modelling follow-up now that the mechanism is confirmed rather than hypothesised.
3. **Extend the robustness grid to the RL layer**, per NB05's own "Next Steps": does the trained (greedy) policy consistently beat the random-policy baseline across all N/T configurations, not just the single N=20,T=2000 configuration NB05 tested.
4. **Paper §6.2/§9.** Report the full 160-configuration grid's numbers, not the earlier reduced-scope pass; report the BIC non-recovery result as a small, bounded, well-understood negative finding — a one-component-above-truth $K=5$ gap at 14/16 configurations, with a directly confirmed mechanism (adaptive/exploratory conflation at $K=4$, cleanly resolved at $K=5$, and shown at §8e to recur — non-monotonically — at the two configurations that reach $K=7/K=8$) — not an unbounded or unexplained failure. Both AR-1 autocorrelation and representation-space transformation are cleanly ruled out as causes, with the AR-1 ablation actively refuting (not merely failing to confirm) that hypothesis.

7.17 Computational Environment

Component	Version / Note
Python	3.13.12
Environment manager	Nix flake dev shell (<code>flake.nix</code>)
NumPy	2.4.4
SciPy	1.17.1
scikit-learn	1.8.0
hmmlearn	0.3.3
Matplotlib, Seaborn	standard scientific stack
umap-learn	2-D/3-D reducer refit (§8c)
Parallelism	<code>concurrent.futures.ProcessPoolExecutor</code> , checkpointed/resumable (§3.3)
Total execution time	≈2 hours (160-config grid, 4,800 full-covariance fits, BIC sweep at $K = 2, \dots, 8$, and the §8b–§8d diagnostics at $N=50, T=5,000$)
Notebook execution	Jupyter (ipykernel), executed programmatically via <code>nbclient</code>

New `src/` additions introduced for this notebook

- `src/hmm/robust_fitting.py` (new module, extended for the full-scale run): `RobustHMMResult`, `fit_hmm_robust`, `check_data_sufficiency`, `check_covariance_health` — the complete 7-layer mitigation stack (§1.1), plus a new `collect_attempt_log` parameter and `attempt_log` result field recording every individual fitting attempt, not only the winner (§2.7).
- `src/hmm/hidden_state_model.py`: `min_covar` parameter added to `fit_hmm`; `align_and_score` factored out as a standalone, reusable Hungarian-alignment/scoring function.
- `src/hmm/sequence_inference.py`: `min_covar` parameter added to `model_selection_sweep`.
- `src/manifold/umap_projection.py`: `kde_density_grid` (generic 2-D KDE on an arbitrary point set, with an optional shared `grid_bounds` for cell-comparable results) reused from NB06 for §8d’s per-state density figures.

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A Unified File Manifest

Every data export and figure file produced across all seven notebooks, consolidated here by notebook rather than scattered across each section above. Data-export paths are relative to the repository root under `data/processed/nb0X/` (or as otherwise noted per file); figure paths are relative to `outputs/figures/nb0X/`.

A.1 Notebook 01

A.1.1 Dataset Export

Three artefacts are exported for downstream experiments:

File	Shape	Purpose
<code>telemetry_n20_t2000.csv</code>	<code>(40000, 17)</code>	Full telemetry with z-scores
<code>X_telemetry.npy</code>	<code>(40000, 6)</code>	Z-scored feature matrix
<code>y_labels.npy</code>	<code>(40000,)</code>	Integer regime labels

Table 11: Exported dataset artefacts.

These feed directly into the downstream notebooks:

- **Notebook 02:** `02_manifold_learning.ipynb` — UMAP and t-SNE for nonlinear manifold geometry.
- **Notebook 03:** `03_hmm_inference.ipynb` — Gaussian-emission HMM regime recovery.
- **Notebook 04:** `04_anomaly_detection.ipynb` — Online Mahalanobis-distance anomaly scoring.

A.1.2 File Manifest

File	Description
<code>data/telemetry_n20_t2000.csv</code>	Primary dataset
<code>data/X_telemetry.npy</code>	Feature matrix (numpy)
<code>data/y_labels.npy</code>	Label vector (numpy)
<code>fig01_state_frequencies.png</code>	State frequency bar chart
<code>fig02_feature_distributions.png</code>	Feature distribution violins
<code>fig03_latency_entropy_scatter.png</code>	Primary behavioral plane scatter
<code>fig04_separability_heatmap.png</code>	Fisher separability bar chart + regime centroid heatmap
<code>fig05_temporal_trajectory.png</code>	Temporal trajectory (agent_0000)
<code>fig06_pca_projections.png</code>	PCA 2-D/3-D projections
<code>fig07_pairplot.png</code>	Full pairwise feature-relationship grid (supplementary)

Table 12: Files produced by Notebook 01.

Generated by the LBSM research simulation core. Numerical values in §1–§9 sourced directly from `telemetry_n20_t2000.csv` and a corrected re-execution of Notebook 01, run after fixing an AR(1) state-carryover bug in `agent.py` (the previous, 2026-05-07 execution’s telemetry leaked each regime’s outgoing emission into the next regime’s incoming one, contaminating every regime-conditioned statistic in this section). No dedicated PCA scree-plot or centroid-distance-heatmap figure was ever produced for this notebook — their numerical content has always lived in Table 3’s discussion and Table 4 respectively,

not in a separate image file. The PCA projection and temporal trajectory figures on disk are from this same corrected re-execution, so the numbers quoted above and the images shown are consistent with each other.

A.2 Notebook 02

A.2.1 Dataset Export

Seven artefacts are exported to the `data/` directory for use by downstream notebooks.

File	Shape	Size	Purpose
<code>X_umap2.npy</code>	(40,000, 2)	312.6 KB	2-D UMAP embedding
<code>X_umap3.npy</code>	(40,000, 3)	468.9 KB	3-D UMAP embedding
<code>X_tsne.npy</code>	(5,000, 2)	39.2 KB	2-D t-SNE embedding
<code>idx_tsne.npy</code>	(5,000,)	39.2 KB	t-SNE sample row indices
<code>y_labels.npy</code>	(40,000,)	39.2 KB	Integer regime labels
<code>trajectory_stats.csv</code>	(20, cols)	2.1 KB	Per-agent trajectory statistics
<code>transition_coords.csv</code>	(14,161, cols)	980.7 KB	Transition events with UMAP coords

(Exported artefacts from Notebook 02 with file sizes.)

These artefacts feed directly into:

- **Notebook 03** (`03_hmm_inference.ipynb`) — Gaussian-emission Hidden Markov Model regime recovery; uses `y_labels.npy` as ground truth and `X_umap2.npy` for geometric validation.
- **Notebook 04** (`04_anomaly_detection.ipynb`) — Online Mahalanobis-distance anomaly scoring; uses `X_umap2.npy` neighbourhood envelopes and `transition_coords.csv` as transition ground truth.
- **Notebook 05** (`05_robustness.ipynb`) — Stability analysis under varying N , T , and seeds; uses the embedding pipelines from Notebooks 01–02 as baseline configurations.

A.2.2 File Manifest

File	Description
<code>data/X_umap2.npy</code>	2-D UMAP embedding (312.6 KB)
<code>data/X_umap3.npy</code>	3-D UMAP embedding (468.9 KB)
<code>data/X_tsne.npy</code>	2-D t-SNE embedding, 5k sample (39.2 KB)
<code>data/idx_tsne.npy</code>	t-SNE sample indices (39.2 KB)
<code>data/y_labels.npy</code>	Integer regime labels (39.2 KB)
<code>data/trajectory_stats.csv</code>	Per-agent trajectory statistics (2.1 KB)
<code>data/transition_coords.csv</code>	Transition events with coordinates (980.7 KB)
<code>fig_nb02_01_pca_scree.png</code>	PCA scree and cumulative variance
<code>fig_nb02_02_pca_scatter.png</code>	PCA 2-D scatter with centroids
<code>fig_nb02_03_umap_scatter.png</code>	UMAP 2-D scatter + KDE contours
<code>fig_nb02_04_umap_3d.png</code>	UMAP 3-D manifold surface
<code>fig_nb02_05_connectivity.png</code>	Regime boundary porosity heatmap
<code>fig_nb02_06_tsne_scatter.png</code>	t-SNE scatter + compactness bars
<code>fig_nb02_07_scorecard.png</code>	Embedding quality scorecard
<code>fig_nb02_08_per_regime_silhouette.png</code>	Per-regime silhouette comparison
<code>fig_nb02_09_trajectories.png</code>	Agent trajectories + tortuosity scatter
<code>fig_nb02_10_transition_geometry.png</code>	Transition points + velocity bars
<code>fig_nb02_11_speed_timeline.png</code>	Manifold speed timeline (agent_0000)
<code>fig_nb02_12_method_agreement.png</code>	UMAP ↔ t-SNE agreement scatter

Generated by the LBSM research analysis pipeline. All numerical values are sourced directly from cell outputs of `02_manifold_learning.ipynb` (execution date 2026-05-13). Dataset regenerated from `telemetry_n20_t2000.csv` with `seed = 42`.

A.3 Notebook 03

A.3.1 Export Artefacts

Files exported for downstream notebooks:

File	Purpose	Size
<code>data/raw/nb03/hmm_pred_aligned.npy</code>	Verbi labels (aligned to GT)	312.6 KB
<code>data/raw/nb03/hmm_posteriors.npy</code>	Forward-backward posteriors	1,250.1 KB
<code>data/raw/nb03/hmm_entropy.npy</code>	Posterior entropy per timestep	312.6 KB
<code>data/raw/nb03/y_gt_sorted.npy</code>	GT labels (agent/time sorted)	312.6 KB
<code>data/processed/nb03/hmm_regime.csv</code>	Per-regime metrics	0.2 KB
<code>data/processed/nb03/hmm_agent_metrics.csv</code>	Per-agent metrics	0.8 KB
<code>data/processed/nb03/bic_sweep.csv</code>	Model-selection sweep results (§3.1)	—

These artefacts feed directly into:

- **NB04** — HMM posteriors (`hmm_posteriors.npy`) and entropy (`hmm_entropy.npy`) are used alongside Mahalanobis distances to build the hybrid anomaly scorer.
- **NB05** — Regime accuracy and agent metric CSVs provide the NB03 baseline for the robustness grid (160 configurations across N , T , seed).

A.4 Notebook 04

A.4.1 Export Artefacts

Paths below are relative to the repository root.

File	Shape / cols	Purpose
<code>data/raw/nb04/composite_scores.npy</code>	(40,000,)	Composite anomaly scores
<code>data/raw/nb04/mah_scores.npy</code>	(40,000,)	Mahalanobis scores
<code>data/raw/nb04/ewma_scores.npy</code>	(40,000,)	EWMA scores
<code>data/raw/nb04/kl_scores.npy</code>	(40,000,)	KL divergence scores
<code>data/raw/nb04/composite_flags.npy</code>	(40,000,)	Binary flags at τ^*
<code>data/raw/nb04/y_anom.npy</code>	(40,000,)	Ground-truth anomaly labels
<code>data/processed/nb04/detector_stability.csv</code>	5 rows	Bootstrap AUC table
<code>data/processed/nb04/detection_latency.csv</code>	20 rows	Per-agent latency
<code>data/processed/nb04/shift_magnitude_summary.csv</code>	12 rows	Per-agent transition shift
<code>data/processed/nb04/threshold_sweep.csv</code>	500 rows	F_1 sweep

These artefacts feed directly into:

- **NB05 (Robustness):** Composite scores and flags provide the NB04 baseline for the 160-configuration robustness grid ($N \in \{5, 10, 20, 50\}$, $T \in \{500, 1000, 2000, 5000\}$, 10 seeds). Hypothesis: Mahalanobis AUC > 0.95 and composite F_1 > 0.80 are stable across all configurations.
- **Paper §7:** Key numbers for the anomaly detection section are $F_1 = 0.872$, AUC-ROC= 0.978, AUC-PR= 0.929, mean latency= 0.29 steps, healthy FPR= 4.2%, 5/6 criteria met.

A.4.2 File Manifest

All files below are under `outputs/figures/nb04/`.

File	Description
<code>fig_nb04_01_mah_distributions.png</code>	Mahalanobis score distributions
<code>fig_nb04_02_roc_pr.png</code>	ROC and PR curves
<code>fig_nb04_03_online_timeline.png</code>	Online detection timeline
<code>fig_nb04_04_latency.png</code>	Detection latency and rate
<code>fig_nb04_05_shift_magnitude.png</code>	Regime shift magnitude

Generated by the LBSM research analysis pipeline (execution date 2026-05). Dataset regenerated from `telemetry_n20.t2000.csv` with `seed= 42`. All numerical values sourced directly from cell outputs of `04_anomaly_detection.ipynb`.

A.5 Notebook 05

A.5.1 Export Artefacts

Paths below are relative to the repository root; processed tables are under `data/processed/nb05/` unless noted otherwise.

File	Shape rows	Purpose
<code>data/raw/nb05/q_tables.npy</code>	(20, 100, 3)	Final Q-table per agent
<code>rl_training_log.csv</code>	2,400 rows	Full per-agent, per-episode training log
<code>pool_learning_curves.csv</code>	120 rows	Pooled (20-agent) smoothed learning curve
<code>regime_dwell_summary.csv</code>	4 rows	Pooled initial-vs-final regime dwell (§4)
<code>convergence_table.csv</code>	20 rows	Per-agent convergence diagnostics
<code>policy_summary.csv</code>	20 rows	Per-agent policy composition (§7)
<code>anomaly_score_evolution.csv</code>	120 rows	Pooled mean Mahalanobis score per episode (§6.4)
<code>transition_entropy.csv</code>	30 rows	Per-episode $H(s' s)$, single-agent checkpoint (§6.2)
<code>cluster_migration.csv</code>	12 rows	Regime dwell by phase, single-agent checkpoint (§6.3)

These artefacts feed directly into:

- **NB06 (Manifold Visualisation):** Q-tables and trajectory data for 3-D UMAP overlays of RL trajectories on the NB02 manifold, colour-coded by training phase and action.
- **NB07 (Final Experiment Analysis):** the trained-vs-random-baseline comparison methodology (§5) should be the template for any robustness sweep, not the original early-vs-late training-curve framing.
- **Paper §8:** key numbers are the regime-dwell reallocation deltas, the trained-vs-random-baseline comparison, and the $H(s' | s)$ reduction (−0.313 nats) — all independently reproduced. The policy corner composition (55.6%) is NB05’s own result but did not independently reproduce (§7’s caveat) and should not be cited in the paper without that context, or should be dropped in favour of the reproduced findings.

A.5.2 File Manifest

All files below are under `outputs/figures/nb05/`.

File	Description
<code>fig_nb05_01_random_trajectory.png</code>	Random-policy verification episode
<code>fig_nb05_02_learning_curves.png</code>	Q-learning training curves (pool)
<code>fig_nb05_03_dwelling_evolution.png</code>	Regime dwell evolution (pool)
<code>fig_nb05_04_manifold_alignment.png</code>	RL trajectory geometry, RQ1
<code>fig_nb05_05_transition_entropy.png</code>	Transition entropy reduction, RQ2
<code>fig_nb05_06_anomaly_dynamics.png</code>	Anomaly score evolution, RQ3
<code>fig_nb05_07_policy_analysis.png</code>	Learned policy analysis, C5
<code>fig_nb05_08_cluster_migration.png</code>	Cluster migration, RQ4

Generated by the LBSM research analysis pipeline; originally executed 2026-08-23, re-executed 2026-08-25 following the reward-key fix documented in §6.1. Dataset regenerated from `telemetry_n20_t2000.csv` with `seed = 42`. All numerical values sourced directly from cell outputs of `05_rl_behavioral_evolution.ipynb` following (a) a causal-alignment fix to `src/rl/environment.py`, (b) a correction of the evidence checklist’s C1/C2 baseline (§3), and (c) a reward/rl.reward dict-key collision fix in the same file’s `.trajectory` buffer construction (§6.1) — the only change between the two executions, confirmed by every table besides §6.1’s reproducing to matching precision.

A.6 Notebook 06

A.6.1 Export Artefacts

Paths below are relative to the repository root.

File	Shape / rows	Purpose
<code>data/processed/nb06/rl_trajectory_embeddings.csv</code>	180,000 rows	Full per-step trajectory, 3 agents, with 2-D and 3-D UMAP coordinates (§4)
<code>phase_manifold_distance_summary.csv</code>	9 rows	Per-agent, per-phase distance to regime centroids (§6)
<code>kde_phase_statistics.csv</code>	3 rows	Per-agent KDE peak locations, displacement, overlap coefficients (§8)
<code>action_density_correspondence.csv</code>	3 rows	Action usage vs. near-unstable usage, concentration ratios (§8)

These artefacts feed directly into:

- **Paper §5.5/§8:** the KDE peak-displacement statistic as the primary quantified manifold-occupancy-shift claim; the continuum-plus-isolated-cluster structural observation as a cross-notebook consistency check with NB03.
- **NB05’s report:** the C5 reproducibility caveat added to §7/§8/Significance (this notebook’s §8b is the source investigation).
- **Any future NB07 (Final Experiment Analysis):** the self-consistency validation pattern (§3) as the template for correctness-checking any further RL retraining work, in preference to matching persisted `.npy` artifacts of uncertain provenance.

A.6.2 File Manifest

All files below are under `outputs/figures/nb06/`.

File	Description
<code>fig_nb06_01_trajectory3d_by_phase.png</code>	3-D overlay, coloured by training phase
<code>fig_nb06_02_trajectory3d_by_action.png</code>	3-D overlay, coloured by action
<code>fig_nb06_03_trajectory2d_by_phase.png</code>	2-D overlay, coloured by training phase
<code>fig_nb06_04_trajectory2d_by_action.png</code>	2-D overlay, coloured by action
<code>fig_nb06_05_kde-density_2d.png</code>	2-D KDE: regime background vs. phase contours
<code>fig_nb06_06_kde-density_3d.png</code>	3-D floor-projected KDE by phase
<code>fig_nb06_07_early-vs-late.png</code>	Early-vs-late trajectory footprint comparison
<code>fig_nb06_08_multi-agent_phase.png</code>	Multi-agent robustness check (3 agents)

Generated by the LBSM research analysis pipeline (execution date 2026-08-25). Dataset regenerated from `telemetry_n20_t2000.csv` with seed = 42; UMAP background from NB02; Q-table validation cross-referenced against NB05 (2026-08-25 re-run). All numerical values sourced directly from cell outputs of `06_manifold_visualization.ipynb`.

A.7 Notebook 07

A.7.1 Export Artefacts

Paths below are relative to the repository root.

File	Rows	Purpose
<code>data/processed/nb07/robustness_grid_results.csv</code>	160	Full per-configuration results, every field from LBSM-ISSUE-NB07-001 §6's recording protocol, plus <code>unstable_recall_full</code> , <code>n_iter_full</code> , <code>diag_fit_failed</code> , <code>diag_bic_failed</code> (§3–§8)
<code>data/processed/nb07/full_scale_attempt_log.csv</code>	4,800	Full per-attempt audit trail: every <code>min_covar</code> x restart attempt, including failed/discarded ones (§2.7)
<code>grid_vs_reliable_summary.csv</code>	2	Full-grid vs. reliable-subset summary (§4)
<code>numerical_health_by_config.csv</code>	16	Condition number / reliability by (N, T) (§7)
<code>stationary_distribution_mae.csv</code>	160	Per-config (per-seed) stationary-distribution MAE (§8)
<code>umap_space_bic_recovery.csv</code>	4	BIC-optimal K , UMAP 2-D/3-D × diag/full (§8c)
<code>hmm_state_identity_diagnostic.csv</code>	15	Per-state dominant regime, purity, self-transition probability, label, at $K=4/5/6$ (§8d)
<code>hmm_state_identity_diagnostic_k7k830.csv</code>	30	Per-state dominant regime, purity, self-transition probability, at $K=4-8$, full covariance, at the two configurations whose BIC-optimal K reaches 7/8 (§8e)
<code>hmm_local_optima_landscape_corrected.csv</code>	24	Log-likelihood/BIC per K per restart seed, production settings, at the two exception configurations (§8f)

Figure	Description
fig_nb07_01_full_vs_diag_ari.png	Full-vs-diagonal ARI scatter, 160 configs (§5)
fig_nb07_02_bic_elbow_comparison.png	BIC curves, $K = 2, \dots, 8$, illustrative configs (§6)
fig_nb07_03_numerical_health_grid.png	Predicted-vs-measured risk table + condition-number heatmap, 16 $N \times T$ combinations (§7)
fig_nb07_04_state_identity_2d_K{4,5,6}.png	Per-state 2-D UMAP KDE density, $N=50, T=5,000$, one figure per K (§8d)
fig_nb07_05_state_identity_3d_K{4,5,6}.png	Per-state 3-D UMAP position + floor-projected KDE, one figure per K (§8d)
fig_nb07_06_state_persistence_K{4,5,6}.png	Per-state self-transition probability, one figure per K (§8d)

A.7.2 File Manifest

All figure files below are under `outputs/figures/nb07/`; all data files under `data/processed/nb07/` (see §12 for row counts and purpose).

File	Description
fig_nb07_01_full_vs_diag_ari.png	Full-vs-diagonal ARI scatter (160 configs)
fig_nb07_02_bic_elbow_comparison.png	BIC elbow curves, $K = 2, \dots, 8$
fig_nb07_03_numerical_health_grid.png	Risk table + condition-number heatmap
fig_nb07_04_state_identity_2d_K4.png	Per-state 2-D KDE density, $K=4$
fig_nb07_04_state_identity_2d_K5.png	Per-state 2-D KDE density, $K=5$
fig_nb07_04_state_identity_2d_K6.png	Per-state 2-D KDE density, $K=6$
fig_nb07_05_state_identity_3d_K4.png	Per-state 3-D position + floor KDE, $K=4$
fig_nb07_05_state_identity_3d_K5.png	Per-state 3-D position + floor KDE, $K=5$
fig_nb07_05_state_identity_3d_K6.png	Per-state 3-D position + floor KDE, $K=6$
fig_nb07_06_state_persistence_K4.png	Self-transition probability by state, $K=4$
fig_nb07_06_state_persistence_K5.png	Self-transition probability by state, $K=5$
fig_nb07_06_state_persistence_K6.png	Self-transition probability by state, $K=6$

Generated by the LBSM research analysis pipeline (execution date 2026-08-26), full-scale run: 160 configurations, 10 seeds (42–51), 4,800 full-covariance fits, $K = 2, \dots, 8$ BIC search, state-identity diagnostics at $N=50, T=5,000, \text{seed}=42$ (250,000 observations). Supersedes an earlier compute-budget-reduced pass (24 configurations, $T \leq 2,000$, $K \leq 6$) used to validate the mitigation stack and infrastructure. All numerical values sourced directly from cell outputs and exported CSVs of `07_final_experiment_analysis.ipynb`.